

The Sixty-Second Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age

2012
Final Report

Hilton Rye Town, Rye Brook, NY - April 22-28, 2012

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

■ 62ND GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

The 62nd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada met at the Hilton Rye Town, in Rye Brook, New York; the theme was "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age."

The 132 Conference members consist of 93 delegates from the Conference areas of the U.S. and Canada; 21 trustees of the General Service Board; 4 A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Board directors; and 14 General Service and Grapevine staff members.

The Conference was officially opened Sunday with the roll call by Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, followed by Greetings from delegate chair Alan Hennesy, Oklahoma.

The Keynote Address was given by Western Canada regional trustee Vic Phillips. He said, "Of course, we will always want to enthusiastically examine any benefits inherent in our changing environment. In *As Bill Sees It* (page 255), from a 1960 Grapevine article, are these amazing words: 'Nothing matters more to A.A.'s future welfare than the manner in which we use the colossus of modern communication. Used unselfishly and well, it can produce results surpassing our present imagination.' Adopting that optimistic attitude, this 62nd Conference has inherited a farsighted and creative leadership role. We will want to view all evolving cultural, economic, technological, and demographic circumstances as though our greatest concerns are growth in the worldwide membership of A.A. and the questions we face regarding self-support. We don't speak specifically of expansion, but in that respect we must always ask how we can better reach and serve the broadest possible range of alcoholics of whatever age, race, faith, and digital capability. Our principles must be employed as guides that help us navigate unfamiliar seas and never as permanent anchors that keep us from moving forward."

This year's Conference was chaired by Ward Ewing (nonalcoholic), chairman of the General Service Board; Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O.'s general manager, and Alan Hennesy (Oklahoma), delegate chair. Eva Sanchez, G.S.O. staff member, was Conference coordinator.

Guest observers to this year's Conference were Daler Mathadu and Satander Bhalla, A.A. trustees from the General Service Board of India.

Sunday evening, the Opening Dinner was followed by an Open A.A. meeting, chaired by Ricardo Castro, District of Columbia, chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee; the leader was Neil Faber, North Dakota. Speakers were: Jean Martin, Western Pennsylvania; Bob O'Reilly, Saskatchewan; M. Tracey Ober, G.S.O. staff member; Albin Zezula, Grapevine director; and Rod Betonney, Pacific regional trustee.

For those who liked to start their day with an A.A. meeting the 2012 G.S.C. Serenity Group met each morning at 7:30. Bob Denihan, NE Ohio, was the chair; secretary/treasurer was Gerry Goulet, NW Ontario. A Seventh Tradition basket was passed each morning, and at the end of Conference \$245 was contributed to the General Service Office.

During the week, while Conference members were in meetings, local A.A. members accompanied Conference members' spouses and guests on sightseeing and shopping tours, to A.A. and Al-Anon meetings and various New York City sites. Some enjoyed a matinee of a Broadway play or musicals. There were also visits to the National Museum of the American Indian and the Museum of Modern Art.

Wednesday afternoon at the trustees elections, Marty Watters of Sidney, BC, was elected Western Canada regional trustee; Andrew Ware of Missoula, Montana will become the new West Central regional trustee.

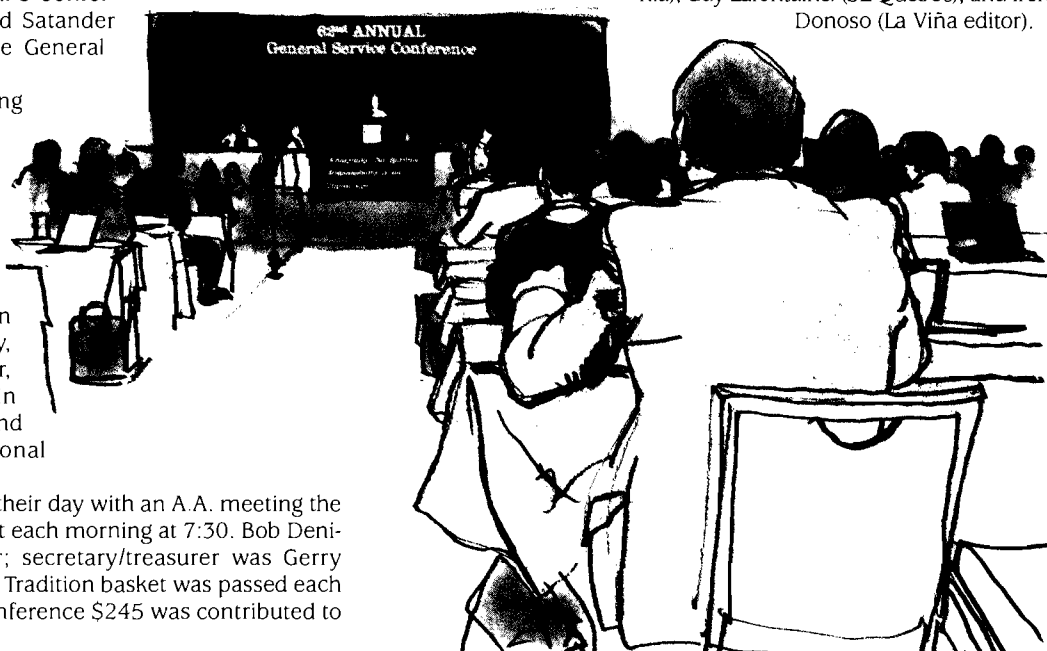
At the Delegates Only Dinner Tuesday evening Roger Schelling, NW Texas, was elected delegate chair for the 63rd Conference; Greg BreVard, Wyoming, will be the alternate chair.

During the busy week Conference committees reviewed the many agenda items before making recommendations to the entire Conference for their review and vote, many items eventually resulting in Conference Advisory Actions.

Presentations throughout the week reflected thoughts on and the pros and cons regarding the Conference theme cautioning about our Tradition of Anonymity and Social Web sites. Some of the topics addressed were the role of sponsorship, rotation and young people in the new technology.

A.A. members love to hear about the Fellowship's history, and a highlight of the Conference was a Presentation by G.S.O. archivist Michelle Mirza. Following her talk Michelle played a recording of Bill's address at the opening of the 1960 Conference — A.A.'s 25th Anniversary year. This was followed by a large screen visual of the Twelve Traditions — from manuscript to bound book.

Late Friday afternoon rotating delegates (Panel 61) lined up at the mikes for a two-minute farewell. After Ward Ewing's closing remarks the Conference was officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in three languages, lead by: English Ken Schmidt (Central California); Guy Lafontaine. (SE Quebec); and Irene Donoso (La Viña editor).



Conference members met once more at the Saturday morning closing brunch where the rotating trustees gave their goodbye talks: Ken Brueggemann, West Central regional trustee and Vic Phillips, Western Canada regional trustee.

Following brunch approximately 60 delegates visited Stepping Stones, Bill and Lois Wilson's home in Bedford Hills, New York. A highlight of the trip for many was the opportunity to sit in the chair at Bill's desk in Wit's End, the small building where Bill wrote much of our literature. Both desk and chair date back to the G.S.O. in Newark, N.J.

Some may question why we have a Conference every year and the time, labor and expense involved. Steve Price, Western Missouri, shared his thoughts about "why" in his Presentation "Service: Our Legacy."

"Opening day of last year's Conference, I walked into the ballroom and saw what I would call the Super Bowl of the A.A. service structure. I looked around the room and saw 92 other delegates from across the United States and Canada, trustees and directors, and office personnel and thought 'What am I doing here?' I went to my room that night and asked the God of my understanding for help, and here is what He came up with: the Conference week was not about me, and the week was not about you all. The week was about my daughter and my son, and your daughters and your sons. It was about the people that have not yet found this God-giving gift of life.

"I realize that the A.A. Super Bowl is not played here in New York; it is played in our areas, our districts, and in our groups throughout the United States, and the world. I realize that we here at the Conference are just the equipment managers. We provide the equipment so that our groups, districts, and areas can be better equipped to be of maximum service to God, our Fellowship, and the people that have not yet found our life-giving program. It was about making sure that Alcoholics Anonymous is the future.... No matter what the cost, we have to make sure this program is here tomorrow."

Greetings

I'm Alan Hennesy, Panel 61 delegate from Area 57, Oklahoma, and the delegate chairperson for the 62nd General Service Conference. It is a privilege and honor, and only through the Grace of God, that I am here. I welcome all the delegates, trustees, General Service Office and Grapevine staff, and also our visitors from India.

For me to come from a place where no one wanted to see me ever again, to be with you here and have the opportunity and responsibility to serve my area of Oklahoma at the 62nd General Service Conference, is truly a miracle. I am a work in progress.

My first sponsor told me that I would be amazed before I was halfway through. Today, I am now truly *amazed!*

If you are like me, there may be some of you asking yourself: How did this happen, that me of all people, an alcoholic, could be doing this? I just wanted to get sober and stay that way. After coming back, time after time, I finally surrendered and said, "Okay, now what?" That's when the miracles started happening in my life. First, you said that there is going to be a change in what I want and need, and I would need to take some action. This has always been evident in my recovery.

My name was pulled from the hat to be Area 57 delegate, and I knew that it was a God Thing! Then last year, my name was pulled from the hat again to be your delegate chairperson. God knows something, which today, I do not question. I know He has not allowed me to rest on my laurels, and everything in my life today is pretty good.

In the Big Book, Third Edition, on page 553, from the story "Freedom From Bondage," it says: "I get everything I need in Alcoholics Anonymous — everything I need I get — and when

I get what I need I invariably find that it was just what *I wanted all the time.*"

Coming into last year's Conference, our past delegates reassured me that I was ready. At first, I was nervous, overwhelmed, and felt inadequate. But as the week moved along, and listening to the delegates from the previous year, my old ways seemed to be replaced with the 36 principles. I became a part of, and felt in the middle of Alcoholics Anonymous.

This year's theme is "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age." This is something that Bill and Bob could not have possibly thought of in this context. The way A.A. is structured, through the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts was spiritually inspired and put into place, so our spiritual actions, with the principles, will see us through any changes that come from society itself.

I have found, as many of you have, that in A.A. the only way to be spiritually fit in these times of challenge and change, is to pray, talk to our sponsors, and always do the next right thing. That is why, as trusted servants, it becomes our responsibility to keep the 36 principles in true perspective, and to continue to pass it on, not only to the newcomers, but also to those who may not have fully understood what Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age, is really all about.

Based on A.A.'s strength and history of personal and intimate sharing, the spiritual nature of "one drunk talking to another" is an ongoing concern when discussing technology as a source of A.A. information. Even many Internet-savvy A.A. members say that they do not want the ease of new technology to detract from the one-on-one sharing that has been so essential to our Fellowship and our recovery from alcoholism. It is helpful to remember that there is no need to let the speed of technology dictate the speed of our actions.

I believe that everyone here today is doing everything they can to make Alcoholics Anonymous stronger and better. I also understand that we all can have a different idea of what defines "stronger" and "better." This week we will test our theories and we will come to some difficult decisions. We may not agree on all that happens, but we can still return to our areas and groups with the ability to help them be better informed.

I look forward to meeting more of you as this week passes and hope you will have the best Conference experience. I believe that the 62nd General Service Conference will be remembered by those in attendance for many twenty-four hours ahead.

Alan Hennesy, Oklahoma

Keynote Address

The opportunity to give this keynote address is an honor for which I cannot sufficiently express my gratitude. The gifts of service are truly priceless, of that I assure you, despite the fact that I have been challenged with this topic. The words it is composed of are individually worthy of far-reaching reflection.

The "Digital Age" is characterized by brisk and unrelenting changes in communication technology and presents us, as leaders in Alcoholics Anonymous, with continuous challenges. Meeting the changing wants and needs of our membership, and employing these new avenues for effectively carrying the message, keeps us forever engaged in the most important of our functions, the guardianship of our Traditions. While serving as a Panel 54 delegate I concluded, and assured the Fellowship in my area, that the A.A. service structure does not have as its purpose to change Alcoholics Anonymous. Rather, most of its focus and energy are spent confronting and adapting to a changing world, and within that context its purpose is to ensure that the basics of A.A., its fundamental principles, remain unchanged. That's because those principles

are the primary ingredients for successfully carrying the message of our Three Legacies to the still solitary, still self-centered, and still-suffering alcoholic. After a few more Conferences and four years on the General Service Board, my view has not altered and I still believe that our custodial responsibility is paramount.

Of course, we will always want to enthusiastically examine any benefits inherent in our changing environment. Quoted on page 255 in *As Bill Sees It*, from a 1960 Grapevine article, are these amazing words: "Nothing matters more to A.A.'s future welfare than the manner in which we use the colossus of modern communication. Used unselfishly and well, it can produce results surpassing our present imagination." Adopting that optimistic attitude, this 62nd Conference has inherited a farsighted and creative leadership role. We will want to view all evolving cultural, economic, technological, and demographic circumstances as though our greatest concerns are growth in the worldwide membership of A.A. and the questions we face regarding self-support. We don't speak specifically of expansion, but in that respect we must always ask how we can better reach and serve the broadest possible range of alcoholics of whatever age, race, faith, and digital capability. Our principles must be employed as guides that help us navigate unfamiliar seas and never as permanent anchors that keep us from moving forward.

I know that there will be fears around our tradition of anonymity as we explore new communication tools, and I don't wish to discount those concerns. In that respect, most A.A.s appreciate that our principle of anonymity is concerned with personal confidentiality between members and with personal anonymity when members of A.A. are communicating with the public. Individual awareness, respect, common sense, and self-restraint still represent the solution to the former. For the latter, education and cooperation of the media, coupled with a general acceptance of the Eleventh Tradition by members, has generally averted widespread infractions. Vigilance will have to be ongoing and awareness must be encouraged, but the same principles and remedies apply. I concluded therefore, with respect to the theme of this Conference, "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age" that we are not faced with modifications in our custodial responsibility because we are living in something called the "Digital Age." Perhaps, however, we are challenged even more as leaders to ask: What are our "Spiritual Responsibilities"?

About seven years ago, a friend began his A.A. service presentation with this simple and instructive idea: "When Bill W. described anonymity as the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, I think he was talking about more than confidentiality."

In the closing paragraphs of Tradition Twelve, Bill W. explains it this way: "These experiences taught us that anonymity is real humility at work. It is an all-pervading spiritual quality which today keynotes A.A. life everywhere. Moved by the spirit of anonymity, we try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members both among our fellow alcoholics and before the general public. As we lay aside these very human aspirations, we believe that each of us takes part in the weaving of a protective mantle which covers our whole Society and under which we may grow and work in unity. We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 187)

That, I trust, is our *individual* Spiritual Responsibility as trusted servants, and essentially a bequest of our founders. Bill W. was a visionary and, despite his self-confessed tendency toward a power-driven personality, he had the kind of humility that is expressed by anonymity. Bill was frequently in a minority position with his new ideas and concepts for A.A., and he must have been sustained by an enormous disregard for personal acclaim or popularity. His selfless courage and persistence were exceedingly principled and un-

encumbered by personal inhibition as he forged the A.A. program of recovery, the guidelines for group life, and our service structure with all their complexities.

As Bill passed on the leadership role to us, these qualities were especially clear in his essay on leadership in Concept IX. He hoped A.A. would be led by individuals with those same qualities; that each of us would never accept anything without a sober appraisal; and that we would always be ready to act boldly and expediently when circumstances called for it.

With respect to our *collective* Spiritual Responsibility during this week, as the leadership body of the Fellowship that saved our lives, I must begin with our Responsibility Statement: "I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible."

The first sentence of Concept VI is illuminating as well: "On behalf of A.A. as a whole, our General Service Conference has the principal responsibility for the maintenance of our world services, and it traditionally has the final decision respecting large matters of general policy and finance." Clearly, there are two areas of leadership responsibility that our founders passed on to us as members of the Conference. We are to focus on the health and effectiveness of our world services, carrying the message to anyone, *anywhere*. We will spend much of our time this week doing that. Additionally, we are to focus on large matters of policy and finance. That has to do with ensuring the future of Alcoholics Anonymous, ensuring that the hand of A.A. will *always* be there.

Despite the marvelous rewards inherent in them, our leadership positions are challenging, require hard work, and not always trouble-free. The responsibility we have is great and complex. In Concept IX, Bill reminds us to employ our considerable capacity for foresight, and adds, "Vision is therefore the very essence of prudence, an essential virtue if there ever was one. Of course, we shall often miscalculate the future in whole or in part, but that is better than to refuse to think at all." In both the introduction to the Concepts and in Concept VI, Bill essentially hands us his design for the service structure as though it was preliminary and open to amendment. He assures us as follows: "However satisfactory and right our present arrangements seem, the future may reveal flaws that we do not yet envision. New conditions may require refinements or even considerable alterations." It seems, Digital Age or otherwise, we are still fundamentally and profoundly responsible for a work in progress.

Above all else, our Spiritual Responsibility is to maintain and encourage unity. We have these specific words from the last paragraph in Concept VII: "If, therefore, in the years ahead, the Conference will always bear in mind the actual rights, duties, responsibilities and legal status of the General Service Board, and if the Trustees in their deliberations will constantly realize that the Conference is the real seat of ultimate authority, we may be sure that neither will be seriously tempted to make a 'rubber stamp' out of the other. We may expect that in this way grave issues will always be resolved and harmonious cooperation will be the general rule."

We come together in this Conference once a year, Area delegates, General Service Office and Grapevine staff, Corporate Directors, and Trustees of the General Service Board, all participating equally, because this is the "effective conscience for our whole Society." Our Spiritual Responsibility while here is to practice our principle of anonymity on the highest plane, to allow and encourage the manifestation of our ultimate authority, as expressed in the group conscience. For us, by way of our three splendid Legacies, the rewards for a little discipline are miraculous new beginnings, a wonderful host of friends, and incredible purpose.

Vic Phillips, Western Canada regional trustee

■ Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2012 Conference.

MOTION

It was recommended that:

- 1 The General Service Conference supports the General Service Board's development of a plan to restructure the current A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., corporate and governance structures. The plan may, among other things, address the separate corporate existence of both entities, as well as issues of governance and operations. The plan will be designed to increase unity, better reach and connect the General Service Office and the Grapevine to the broader Fellowship while addressing financial stability. The plan will be submitted to the 63rd General Service Conference for approval prior to implementation.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

- 2 The limit on one-time bequests from A.A. members to the General Service Board be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 3 The theme for the 2013 General Service Conference be: "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory – Our Solution in Action."
- 4 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2013 General Service Conference:
Spiritual Principles for World Service:
 - a) The Triangle — More Than a Shape
 - b) The General Service Conference Inventory — Why is it Necessary?
 - c) Self-Support — What Does it Mean to the Fellowship?
 - d) Primary Purpose — Carrying the A.A. Message
- 5 The following inventory questions listed in the "INVENTORY PLAN," which were approved by the 2011 G.S.C., be discussed each year for the 2013, 2014 and 2015 General Service Conferences:

2013

- A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall
 1. Reflecting on Concept I, how does the Conference ensure that it is the conscience of A.A. as a whole?
 2. How well is the use of floor actions serving us?
 3. Reflecting on Concept X, how well is the authority of the Conference defined?
 4. How well does the Conference fulfill the General Warranties of Concept XII?

- B. Composition of Conference
 1. Should delegate areas be more consistently based on actual membership numbers?
- C. Committee System
 1. Could the committee process be improved to more effectively introduce change in the Fellowship, and if so, how?
- D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness
 1. What improvements could be considered to make sure the agenda selection process is more effective?
 2. How well do all Conference members communicate to the Fellowship about why we have a Conference and how the committee system works? How could we improve in this communication?
- E. Conference Preparation (background, content, delivery, etc.)
 1. How well do the delegates balance their preparation for the Conference, especially in keeping with Concept III and Article Three of the Conference Charter? How could we improve in the practice of our rights and responsibilities under Concept III and Article Three of the Conference Charter?
- F. Conference Week Schedule
 1. How can we improve the way time is allotted during the Conference for reports, presentation/discussion/workshop topics, and thorough discussion of agenda items?
 2. How are leadership and participation affected by late night work sessions?
- G. General Service Board/Corporate Boards (A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)
 1. Is the current makeup of the board (numbers and proportions) still the most effective? If not, what changes should we consider?
 2. How could we improve the methods used to solicit trustees and directors to get the most appropriate people interested in the positions?
 3. What more could be done to insure the General Service Board remains transparent and thorough in their reporting to the Fellowship?
- H. Leadership
 1. Reflecting on Concept IX, are the qualities of leadership, as identified in the leadership essay in *The A.A. Service Manual*, still the qualities that we should try to encourage in Conference members? If so, how successful are we in encouraging those qualities? If not, what changes should we consider?

2014

- A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall
 1. Reflecting on Concept IV, how effective are we in treating all Conference members as equals (no one regarded as second class)?
 2. Reflecting on Concept V, how well does the Conference facilitate the hearing and resolution of minority appeals/report? How could it be improved?
 3. Does the structure encourage each individual in the Fellowship to feel and act as a member of a "society of alcoholics in action?" If not, how could we improve?
 4. Does the yearlong Conference process effectively encourage all Conference members to lead (or serve) in the spirit of our upside-down service structure? If not, how can we encourage all Conference members to do so?

- B. Composition of Conference
 - 1. Should regional divisions be based on membership numbers, the number of areas contained in each region, or some other criteria? Please explain.
- C. Committee System
 - 1. What is the right balance of participation among committee members (delegates, staff) and how can we best achieve that balance?
- D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness
 - 1. How well is the message of the Conference theme being carried out throughout the year?
 - 2. What other suggestions do we have for how to improve the effectiveness of the yearlong process?
- E. Conference Preparation (background, content, delivery, etc.)
 - 1. How can we improve the manner in which Conference background material is developed and distributed?
- F. Conference Week Schedule
 - 1. At the Conference, what is the difference between being a leader or being a reporter? Can a person be both at the same time?
- G. General Service Board/Corporate Boards (A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)
 - 1. Reflecting on Concept XI, does the General Service Board exercise serious care in having the best possible assistance in carrying out their duties? How can this process be improved?
 - 2. Does the current role of the board most effectively address the needs of the Fellowship? If not, how should their role be changed?
 - 3. Is the selection/election process for trustees and directors effective and impartial/fair? How would you change it?
- H. Leadership
 - 1. How can we improve the methods of selecting effective leaders and nurturing leadership qualities in our trusted servants?
 - 2. What more could be done to ensure broad diversity of representation in our A.A. leaders?

we consider regarding: a) structure, b) composition, c) effectiveness?

- D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness
 - 1. How can we better communicate that the Conference process is more than one spring week in New York?
 - 2. How do the delegates and regional trustees support the year-long process effectiveness?
- E. Conference Preparation (background, content, delivery, etc.)
 - 1. What more could be done to prepare delegates for the Conference?
- F. Conference Week Schedule
 - 1. What Conference activities give participants the most opportunities to be leaders?
 - 2. Does the time allotted and the manner in which information is communicated from the trustees and board members allow delegates to adequately understand and/or question their reports? How could this be improved?
- G. General Service Board/Corporate Boards (A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)
 - 1. Reflecting on Concept VI, how can the Conference ensure that the authority we delegate to the General Service Board is commensurate with the responsibility we have entrusted to them?
 - 2. Reflecting on Concept VIII: (a) How well is the General Service Board exercising custodial oversight and how effectively are they serving as the principle planners and administrators of policy and finance? (b) What are the boundaries between oversight vs. delegation? When is each practiced?
 - 3. Should the Fellowship have more direct influence in the selection of Class A trustees, corporate directors, and General Service trustees? If yes, how might that be accomplished?
- H. Leadership
 - 1. How well is the Third Legacy Procedure serving us? How could it be improved?

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

2015

- A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall
 - 1. Reflecting on Concept II, how can we better serve as the actual voice and be an effective conscience for our whole society?
 - 2. Reflecting on Concept III, how can we effectively balance the freedoms and responsibilities that come with the right of decision?
 - 3. How might any one of the Concepts be revised in essence or wording to more effectively and relevantly guide our leaders?
- B. Composition of Conference
 - 1. Is the size and structure (proportions of delegate/trustee/staff) of the Conference the most effective for conducting the work of the Fellowship? If not, how could it be made more effective?
- C. Committee System
 - 1. Committee system (Structure, Composition, Effectiveness, etc.): Does the Conference committee system function in accordance with our principles? If not, what changes should

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 6 The current statement regarding "Singleness of Purpose" in C.P.C. literature which reads:

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings."

be revised to read as follows:

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend open A.A. meetings as observers, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed A.A. meetings."

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- 7 The text in the “What A.A. Does Not Do” section in the C.P.C. pamphlets “A.A. in Your Community,” “If You Are A Professional” and “Members of the Clergy ask about Alcoholics Anonymous” be replaced with the text in the section “What A.A. Does Not Do” in the “A.A. at a Glance” flyer and the entire section read as follows:

What A.A. Does Not Do

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover...solicit members...engage in or sponsor research...keep attendance records or case histories...join “councils” or social agencies (although A.A. members, groups and service offices frequently cooperate with them)...follow up or try to control its members...make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses...provide detox, rehabilitation or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment...offer religious services or host/sponsor retreats...engage in education about alcohol...provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money, or any other welfare or social services...provide domestic or vocational counseling...accept any money for its services, or any contributions from non-A.A. sources...provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 8 The revised draft pamphlet “It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell” be approved.
- 9 The pamphlet “A Message to Corrections Professionals” be revised with the following changes:

- a) Replace the first paragraph under the section “Release and paroles” with the following paragraph:

One point which usually needs to be explained is why inmates have any need of A.A. while they are incarcerated. The answer is that the A.A. program is far more than staying away from alcohol. A.A. has been called a way of life, and its success for groups that meet while in custody shows that this program can help the alcoholic inmate live a sober and contented life, both while in custody and after release.

- b) Change the title of the section currently called “Release and paroles” to “Re-entry and Parole.”

- c) The current statement regarding “Singleness of Purpose” in the last paragraph, which reads:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as “substance abuse” or “chemical dependency.” Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings.

Be revised with wording that is consistent with the description of the difference between Open and Closed meetings in the pamphlet “The A.A. Group” on page 13, to read as follows:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as “substance abuse” or “chemical dependency.” Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend *open* A.A. meetings as observers, but only those with a drinking problem may attend *closed* A.A. meetings.

- 10 The trustees’ Corrections Committee develop a draft replacement for the section “A.A. in correctional facilities” in the pamphlet “A Message to Corrections Professionals” to be brought back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 11 The annual delegate’s contribution be increased from \$1,200 to \$1,600.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

- 12 A.A. Grapevine, Inc. move forward with an audio strategy to have members call in and record their story on 3rd party recording technology.
- The stories will be subject to the same editorial process as print stories.
 - The Audio endeavor will, at a minimum, break even financially.
 - The committee requests that the board ensure that all contracts protect our Traditions, with the option to discontinue any and all contracts at any time.
 - The committee requests that a status and financial report be submitted to the 2013 Conference Committee on the Grapevine as background.
- 13 A.A. Grapevine, Inc., carry out the “Sunset” proposal for Grapevine items. The “Sunset” proposal is a plan to phase out older or slow-moving Grapevine items and archive them digitally or make them available in another format.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 14 The revised pamphlet “A.A. and the Armed Services” be approved.
- 15 The short form of the Twelve Concepts for World Service be added to the book *As Bill Sees It*.
- 16 The final revision of the *Living Sober* booklet, with changes to outdated language or practices, be approved with minor editorial changes.
- 17 The pamphlet “Circles of Love and Service” be revised, and requested that the trustees’ Committee on Literature prepare a draft pamphlet or progress report for the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 18 Satander Bhalla and Daler Mathadu from the General Service

Board of India be admitted to the 62nd General Service Conference as observers.

- 19 Roger Bédard alternate delegate, Area 89, Northeast Quebec Canada, be seated as a Conference member at the 62nd General Service Conference because Estelle Falardeau, Panel 61 delegate for Area 89, is unable to attend.
- 20 The 65th General Service Conference be held April 19-25, 2015 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.
- 21 The use of electronic devices at the General Service Conference be approved in keeping with the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the Conference" as presented to the 2012 General Service Conference, superseding the 2004 Advisory Action regarding the use of personal computers at the Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 22 The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2011 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey with minor editorial changes.
- 23 The video public service announcement for the Spanish-speaking community, "Tengo Esperanza," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved with minor edits.
- 24 The video public service announcement for the Spanish-speaking community, "Tengo Esperanza," be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, in addition to the work of local committees, and that the information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2013 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.
- 25 The revised "Anonymity Wallet Card" be approved.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 26 All changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* be noted by vertical margin change bars in the edition in which the change appears for the first time.
- 27 The following term and definition be added to *The A.A. Service Manual* in Chapter One: Introduction to General Service in the section titled Glossary of General Service Terms:
"Rotation — the spiritual principle of sharing the responsibility for A.A. through changing leadership."
- 28 The current illustration on page S16 be modified in the following manner:
 - Replacing the bottom section of the illustration that deals with the General Service Board and its two operating corporations with the corresponding section from a previous version, minus the table-and-chair graphic.
 - Changing "District Committees" to "Districts."

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 29 The following slate of trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. in April 2012:

Class A

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE	The Honorable
Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.	Rogelio R. Flores
Corliss Burke, B.Ed	John Fromson, M.D.
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	Michele Grinberg, J.D.

Class B

Rod Betonney	Don Massey
Donald Cusson	Don Miller
Nancy Haynes	Eleanor W. Nault
Barbara Kelly	Pamela Reising
Roberta Lindeman	Clayton Vandivort
J. Gary Lutz	Andrew Ware
George G. Martin	Marty Watters

- 30 The appointment of the following officers be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2012:

Officers of the General Service Board

<i>Chairperson</i>	Ward B. Ewing, D.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Pamela Reising
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Michele Grinberg, J.D.
<i>Treasurer</i>	Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE
<i>Secretary</i>	Eleanor Nault

- 31 The January 2012 appointment of the following officers by the chair of the General Service Board be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2012:

<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Rick Walker

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

- 32 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2012:

Andrea G. Barthwell	J. Gary Lutz
Rod Betonney	George Martin
Joe Downey	William Noonan
Phyllis A. Halliday	Rick Walker
Roberta Lindeman	

- 33 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2012:

Ami Brophy	Clayton Vandivort
Donald Cusson	Albin Zezula
Michele Grinberg, J.D.	[vacancy]
Nancy Haynes	[vacancy]
Don Miller	

NOTE: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Bylaws state that its board shall be comprised of "no less than seven (7) and no more than ten (10) directors."

■ Presentations and Reports

FINANCE REPORT

Monday afternoon, the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by Terry Bedient, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Terry Bedient and I am a very grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report to the 62nd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor will be included in the *Final Conference Report* and auditor partner Kevin Sunkel was here yesterday for the joint meeting. Available throughout the week are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, Grapevine controller. Our goal is to help you become familiar with our financial condition so that you can communicate clearly to your area. Enhancing our understanding of finance is one sure way to improve the service structure. Your area will be listening carefully to what you report after the Conference, so let us know what we can do to enhance the communication.

To begin our review of the financial position of our General Service Office, A.A. World Services Publishing activities, La Viña, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the Reserve Fund, we will review 2011 results, 2012 budget, and early projections for 2013 and 2014.

"Around the Picnic Table" is a phrase coined at the 59th Conference. It means that much of the finance discussion during Conference is "preaching to the choir." But what we really need to do is plan for better communication as members talk around the picnic table.

Our conversations this week will emphasize the importance of self-support and Slide 1 lists a few things to consider in communicating with the Fellowship about finance. Focus on the spiritual value of contributing with examples of how contributions get used. Yes, we are facing some financial challenges, but our service structure is designed to foster responsibility and stability. Members can be confident that trusted servants are accountable, based on the checks and balances that have been built into

the financial structure of staff, accountants, auditors and officers. Humanize the numbers. If a \$9 million G.S.O. Services budget seems intimidating, we can talk in terms of \$6 per member or \$137 per group. Emphasize corporate poverty—that we should have just enough to carry the message. And encourage Grapevine subscriptions as an excellent way to help carry our lifesaving message.

Slide 2 summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office. I am sure we are familiar with the functions listed with the possible exception of the last line, entitled Supporting Services. This includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. It would be difficult for the various service functions to operate without this support structure. The total cost of G.S.O. functions for 2011 was \$8,747,139, which is 1.2% more than in 2010. Most of the Functional cost centers showed slight increases, but I will highlight a few differences. In 2011 the General Service Conference was held in New York City instead of the more economical property we are in today. In 2010 we had the World Service Meeting in Mexico City, and the net cost, which falls to G.S.O., was \$205,600 for which there is no comparative cost in 2011. As well, there was no cost for the International Convention assignment in 2011. There was a reduction of approximately 8.5% in the Loners/Overseas category. Included in this category is the cost of Foreign Literature Assistance which we provide to start-up structures around the world. In 2011 there were fewer requests than in the past.

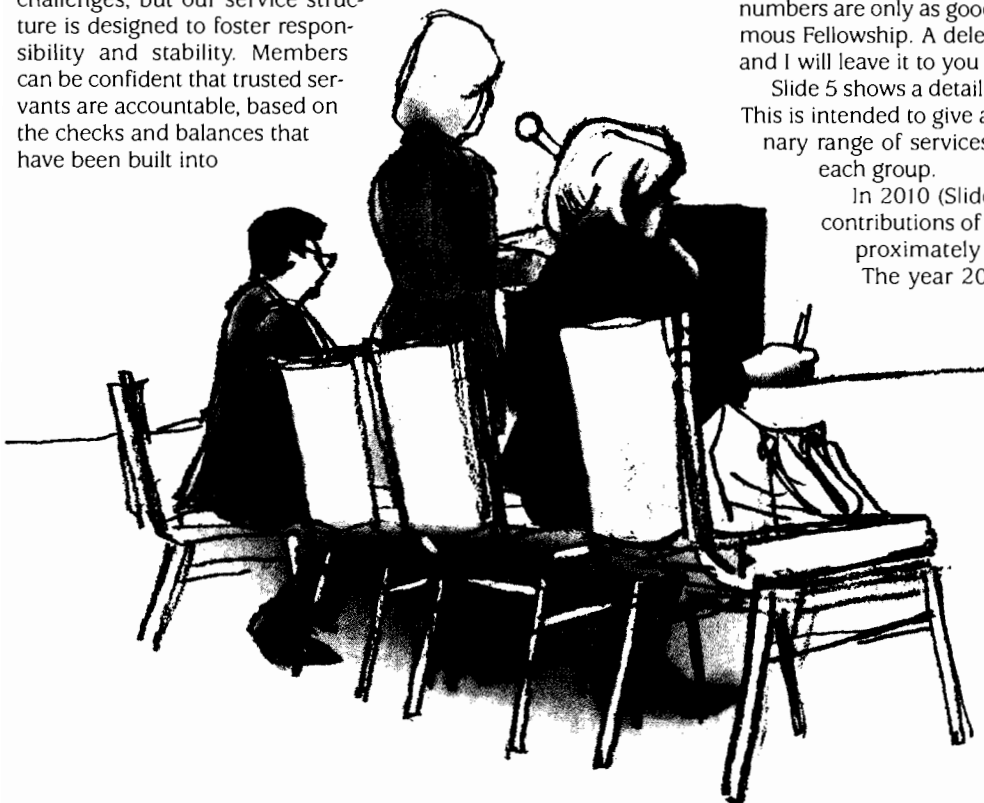
Slide 3 is similar, except that Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. Group and member statistics are shown at the bottom of the slide.

Slide 4. Here, we have displayed a few member statistics. We see that an annual contribution of only \$6.32 per member or \$137.01 per group in 2011 would have allowed the Service side to be fully self-supporting from contributions. How do we arrive at these numbers? It is just a simple calculation of costs shown on financial statements divided by the number of members or groups shown on the Contribution statistical report. And remember, those numbers are only as good as the data we can capture in an Anonymous Fellowship. A delegate asked me to add an "ideal column" and I will leave it to you to fill in the blanks.

Slide 5 shows a detailed breakdown of Group Service activities. This is intended to give a broader understanding of the extraordinary range of services performed by your G.S.O. on behalf of each group.

In 2010 (Slide 6), the General Service Board received contributions of \$6,264,454, which was a decrease of approximately \$144,000, or 2.2% less than last year.

The year 2011 marked a slight downturn in Contributions received from both A.A. members and groups, as well as other countries around the World that help us with Foreign Literature Assistance efforts. I am sure I speak for everyone when I say how deeply grateful we are for this support from across the Fellowship, considering these tough times. We are grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help pay the bills of your General Service Office. A special word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who worked to help make this strong result possible. And I hope information from this Conference will help to assist in your



communication about self-support around the picnic table.

Slide 7 summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2011 amounted to \$12,768,845, which was about 2.4% greater than 2010 or \$298,000 more. We must remember that there were substantial purchases just prior to the price increase of July 1, 2009. After deducting the cost of goods sold, shipping and warehousing costs, there remains a gross profit of \$7,961,813, or 63.7% of sales. We then deduct Program expenses of \$2,710,727 and Supporting expenses of \$1,950,621. A.A.W.S. had an Excess of Revenue over Expenses of \$3,300,465. Prior reports have noted the importance of maintaining a realistic Gross Profit percentage, which A.A.W.S. directors and staff continue to monitor.

La Viña (Slide 8), our Spanish-language magazine, reported a loss greater than budget, due in part to additional costs resulting from a Conference Action in 2010. Gross profit from the sale of magazines and related items equaled \$70,728, an increase of about \$19,400 from 2010. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$140,451, the result is a loss for 2011 of \$69,723. This compares to a loss in 2010 of \$75,480 and was comparable to the 2009 loss of \$54,472. A loss of \$105,669 has been budgeted for 2012. Please remember that La Viña's direct expenses are paid from the General Fund, which houses all contributions.

A.A. Grapevine (Slide 9) turned a slight profit in 2011. Over the year, you have heard of extensive work underway to solve a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. A.A. Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$2,316,763 in 2011. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$1,472,411. Gross profit from related items was approximately \$385,475, giving a total Gross Profit of \$1,857,886. Total Costs and expenses of \$1,859,346 are deducted and then Interest Income of \$24,300 is recorded. The result was a profit of \$22,840 as compared to a budgeted loss of \$93,970. A significant portion of the 2010 loss was due to reorganization costs. The Grapevine budget for 2012 anticipates a profit of \$34,284.

Slide 10 shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2011. The G.S.O. shows contributions, interest, and literature profits totaling \$9,565,088. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$8,747,139, which leaves a positive result for 2011 of \$817,139. To this we add the operating profit of Grapevine \$22,838 and the La Viña loss of (\$69,725). This results in a 2011 bottom line of \$771,062. This positive bottom line assists in keeping the Reserve Fund on an even keel.

Slide 11 is similar to the information shown on slide 10 but with a little bit more information on the expense side.

Slide 12 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, G.S.O. and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, G.S.O. has only two sources of money: contributions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund. Historically, G.S.O. has relied on literature sales to help balance the budget.

Slide 13 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, Grapevine and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, Grapevine has only two sources of money: subscriptions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than is necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund.

Slide 14 covers the General Service Board Reserve Fund. The Reserve Fund ended 2011 with an adjusted balance of \$15,296,921, equal to approximately 11.9 months of operating expenses. At the end of 2010, the Reserve Fund balance was the equivalent of 11.3 months of operating expenses. Many of you know that a 1977 Conference Advisory Action asked our Auditor to comment annually on the adequacy of the Reserve Fund. As reported in *The A.A. Service Manual*, the Reserve Fund is for infrastructure investments or extraordinary circumstances, but not to fund long-term obligations. For 2011, our Auditor has stated that without reference to long-term obligations, "the question of adequacy is answered in the affirmative."

Slide 15. Over the past decade, a number of actions have been taken to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. Big Book prices were reduced \$1 with publication of the 4th Edition, then restored in 2004; selected book prices and handling charges were raised in 2005; G.S.O. accomplished a major cost reduction program in 2007 and 2008; in 2009, both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine implemented price increases.

NOTE — no comment on the next few slides.

Slide 18. Based on future projections from both G.S.O. and Grapevine, we may well be relying more on contributions in the coming years. So remember, "A dollar ain't what it used to be."

At this point in the discussion last year we had several pages of projections to review. I know that the trustees' Finance Committee forwarded preliminary financial projections to the Conference Finance Committee for review so I won't go into any further discussion at this point except to say that the trustees' Finance Committee expects to receive updates of these projections at the July meeting.

Our Auditor (no slide) continues to remind us of long-term obligations for post-employment commitments to current employees and retirees, for both pension and medical benefits. These obligations are funded out of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine operations. With regard to Pension, A.A. has for its employees a Defined Ben-



efit Pension Program, which was established in 1965. By law, Column A must nearly equal Column B in about 5 years. The unfunded Pension Liability on the balance sheet is about \$10.3 million. A.A.W.S. and Grapevine have included paying down this liability into their budgets. We will need to sustain an annual level of fund payments of approximately \$1,700,000 for each of the next several years. Our Pension and post-retirement health obligations now account for about 12% of the G.S.O. budget.

Our benefit plans should be periodically reviewed, but remember that as long as G.S.O. remains in business, pension benefits, which have already accrued cannot be changed.

Pension review — A subcommittee of the General Service Board was formed in late 2011. Their objective is to coordinate the review and selection of pension plan options for transitioning from a Defined Benefit Plan to a Defined Contribution Plan for new A.A.W.S. and G.V. employees. Plan implementation is targeted for January 2013. There is an ongoing subcommittee to oversee Grapevine cash flow in the context of recent draws on the Reserve Fund.

I am pleased to acknowledge the extraordinary talent and dedication that I am privileged to observe as treasurer. Thank you to members of all the finance committees who sort through enormous detail throughout the year. Thank you to Phyllis Halliday and Ami Brophy for competently overseeing our operating corporations. And a very special thank you to Don Meurer and Eugene O'Brien, our talented and dedicated finance managers.

2012 will undoubtedly be marked with some uncertainty and perhaps some surprises due to the continuing hard economic times. But there will be new groups and more members and unlimited opportunities for the Fellowship to continue to prosper.

And remember, Finance has no importance in and of itself. Finance is simply a way to help carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Terry Bedient, treasurer, General Service Board

CARRYING THE A.A. MESSAGE

Kathy Gutierrez, delegate from S. Florida/Bahamas/Virgin Islands/Antigua, chaired the Presentation/Discussion session Tuesday afternoon.

Still Our Primary Purpose

The primary purpose of my home group, of every A.A. group, is to carry its message (recovery through our Twelve Steps) to the alcoholic who still suffers. In trying to help my group carry out that primary purpose, I can't give away what I do not have, so I have to stay sober myself in order to help others to achieve sobriety. Thus, our primary purpose was and still is, "to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety." Put in different words: "Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics, and to practice these principles in all our affairs." Since this is our primary purpose, everything we do as A.A. members, as sponsors and sponsees, as members of a home group, and in our participation in A.A. service work, really has to be in the furtherance of our primary purpose. Otherwise, how is it something we are doing as sober members of A.A.?

"Nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics." Even so, A.A. ultimately remains an altruistic program. Not only do I need to give this away to keep it, the only way I can possibly give back any small part of what A.A. has given me is by passing it on. And that's a good thing, because although we have reached a lot of drunks over the years, there remain many more still stumbling in the dark.

When the Big Book was first published, there were 130,879 alcoholics drinking and dying in the United States for every alcoholic sober in A.A. Our "first one hundred" amounted to less than eight ten-thousandths of one percent of the entire alcoholic population of the USA (0.00076%).

Today, in the United States and Canada, there are approximately 25 alcoholics drinking and dying for each alcoholic in A.A. We A.A. members amount to about 4% of the alcoholics in our service area. Across this entire planet today, there are almost 339 alcoholics drinking and dying for each alcoholic in A.A. Worldwide, our entire membership amounts to less than three-tenths of one percent of the world's alcoholics (0.295%).

Reaching out to those still-suffering alcoholics, in this service area and around the world, we face the challenge of preserving our Tradition of anonymity in this digital age. That is vital. Bill and Bob learned the lessons of the Washingtonians. Forget our primary purpose, neglect our anonymity, and those drunks in the dark may never get a chance to share our program of recovery. Anonymity doesn't just assuage the fear of the newcomer; anonymity is also the lifeblood of our spirituality and our society.

I never want to step over a drunk to argue about a Tradition, but I also must remember that our Traditions protect A.A. from us well-meaning egomaniacs, us power-driving, immature, sensitive, sober alcoholics. Honoring our principles saves us from ourselves.

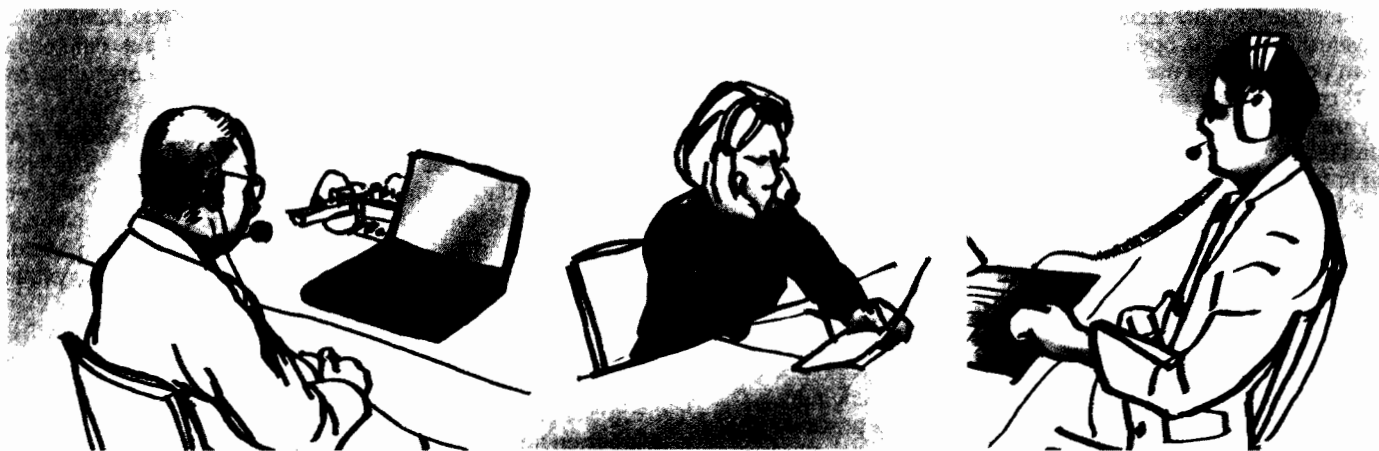
Today my area is looking at developing a secure portion of our Web site from which to provide contact information for members available as Bridging the Gap contacts for alcoholics coming out of treatment facilities. A few areas have already begun to use Web sites for secure contact information, but most have not. Are we within our Anonymity Tradition in doing this?

It appears that we are — at group, district, area, region, General Service Conference, trustee and board levels, we maintain contact information, on paper and on computers, in our homes, offices and meeting locations. Someone could enter any of those locations, under false pretenses or by stealth or brute force, and take that confidential information. If before we leave for the day, we lock our doors, or lock up our lists, then we do not need to burn or eat our lists before leaving the premises, to honor the principle of anonymity.

Similarly, no matter how secure the Web site, it might be subjected to hacking. Nonetheless, if we take appropriate precautions to secure our contact information in our digital data storage on our Web site from public access, we can maintain contact information to facilitate putting our members in touch with alcoholics soon to leave treatment facilities and return to our communities. In my area, our geographic size and sparse population makes digital storage a faster and surer way to accomplish that goal.

At this Conference, we may also be considering whether A.A. should have an informational presence on Facebook. Again, this is not a violation of our Traditions. It is simply a contemporary version of the billboards upon which A.A. once placed signs, with Hot Line numbers, telling the world how to get in touch with us when alcohol became a problem, or the Public Service Announcements we have used in more recent years. My favorite message was "If you want to drink that's your business. If you want to stop, that's our business."

Throughout our history, our respect for our Traditions, including singleness of purpose and anonymity, has always been tinged with fear and uncertainty, shadowing our choices. One of our original groups grappled with whether an alcoholic who also suffered from "another addiction even more stigmatized than alcoholism" could be admitted into A.A. Our spirituality ultimately overcame our fears, and we welcomed him, and he became a strong member of A.A. But no matter how many times we learn how much trouble comes from fear, our fear of the untried and of the new can



influence our decisions, including our decisions about digital outreach in A.A.

Of course we should be careful. My area will have to be satisfied that we can safeguard our digital contact information or the informed group conscience will not approve the plan.

Of course we should move slowly. Before we establish our information presence on Facebook, we must be clear about how we can respect A.A. anonymity in social media and we have not yet achieved any such clarity.

Our best motives are undoubtedly mixed, and our perceptions always suspect. Yet, so long as we remain true, both to our Traditions and to our responsibility to the still-suffering alcoholic, a power far greater than us will guide our efforts. We will be able to reach those who will still stumble and fall under the weight of our common disease — today, in this digital age, just as in the ages of billboards, or radio and television.

Terry Spear, Montana

Social Web Sites

There are now reportedly over 2 billion Internet users. We must remember that we do not know who is seeing our photos, reading our words, or finding our links to other Web sites. What we put on the Internet in social network Web sites is public knowledge and we must not assume otherwise. Social networking is a recent addition to our communication options, and it continues to change and be applied for many purposes. It would be an error to think of our use of Internet social Web sites as being private communication, for they are clearly not private. What we put on the Internet stays on the Internet and can be accessed by many, including employers, judicial, legal, criminal, business, and other entities without our knowledge.

Members of Alcoholics Anonymous address the use of the Internet and social Web sites with emphasis on knowledge and application of our Twelve Traditions. The Digital Archive of the A.A. Grapevine offers good insights about the Internet, and suggestions about its purposes. The link to the Digital Archives is at www.aa-grapevine.org, and a search for "Social Web sites" will bring forth writings worth reading. Some examples follow.

A June 2008 Grapevine article "Carrying the Message, a Special Report: A.A. and the Digital Age," included the following: "Some A.A.s are understandably confused about anonymity on a social network Web site or a personal Web site — even an A.A. Web site that is password protected." The article continues to refer the reader to the issue of anonymity on the Web as provided by

A.A. literature and the General Service Office, including the A.A. World Services Web site, which states: "We observe all A.A.'s principles and Traditions on our Web sites. As anonymity is the 'spiritual foundation of all of our Traditions,' we practice anonymity on A.A. Web sites at all times." We need to assure that our use of other Web sites is equally in compliance with our A.A. Traditions, especially the Eleventh — "Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio, and films." The Twelve Traditions were written long before the advent of the Internet or social Web sites. We must consider that since they can be publicly accessed, we must treat them as we would apply the Tradition to press, radio, or films.

The September 2010 article "Dear Grapevine — Snap-happy" by S.E.B. speaks to the need to remove photography "from various conferences," and asks if "people in these photos know they are going to end up so exposed?" This article is a reminder that we have a responsibility to protect the anonymity of all in our Fellowship, and that we should not publish photographs of other A.A.s or of A.A. functions. Inserting a photograph of an A.A. function in a social Web site, knowing that what is put on such sites is public, violates the anonymity of others. We need to be "responsible" to all in A.A.

Another September 2010 article titled "An Air of Unity — A Delegate Shares About the 60th General Service Conference" covers "the increasing problem of online anonymity breaks on social networking sites. It was discussed that when members publicly reveal their A.A. membership, whether in online profiles or comments or by signing up for groups or events that strongly imply A.A. members, they damage A.A.'s reputation for protecting members' identities. Conference members said this may frighten away prospective newcomers who are concerned about their own anonymity." It goes on to "encourage members to download and review the 'Internet Guidelines' sheet from aa.org, share it with other members, and discuss anonymity with their groups."

All of the above references to Grapevine stories are now located in the archives at the A.A. Grapevine. This information is worth downloading and sharing with others, and is an excellent resource from which to learn more about the public nature of social Web sites. Such sites are not private, as is often believed by the general public. There are many more writings and resources in the Grapevine and from www.aa.org from which to learn about the use of social Web sites as a responsible member of A.A. in any A.A. related matter.

Wikipedia.org has 207 sites in their "list of major active social networking Web sites, excluding dating Web sites," and this does

not include “defunct social networking Web sites.” That is 207 individually prepared, operated, and managed sites, each having its own policies about use of your personal information, as well as 207 conditions for initiating and disconnecting services provided by the site. Policies vary about confidentiality, control over your profiles, posting, and much more. It is the responsibility of users to know what they are doing with the information posted on social Web sites, and what the social Web sites are allowing others to do with your information. We often find that the Web sites will state that they are maintaining your anonymity, yet frequently perform the opposite. They will also explain how they may use information put on the site to profile each person for commercial, legal, or employment purposes, either by the site itself or by access to it from outside sources.

One can consider social Web sites akin to walking through a large crowd of unknown people, while speaking privately to a friend through a loud amplifier. You will not know what others are hearing, how they are hearing it, or to whom or when they will repeat it. As we learn in A.A., it is our responsibility to protect anonymity, to avoid gossip, and to maintain our Twelve Traditions and the other tenets of our Fellowship. Caution is advised whenever referring to ourselves or others as A.A.s. In A.A. meeting groups, service structure events and other A.A. activities, wherever and whenever we are putting forth the hand of A.A., we are referring to Alcoholics Anonymous. We have a duty to be responsible “in all of our affairs,” and that includes in our use of social Web sites. A reminder is on page 293 from *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* where Bill W. writes “...we see anonymity at the general public level as our chief protection against ourselves, the guardian of all of our Traditions, and the greatest symbol of self-sacrifice that we know.”

Art Mohr, Central Michigan

Young People in A.A.

When I first received the loving invitation to present at this year's Conference, I was quite excited — then I read my assigned topic. It's obvious that I'm not a young person in A.A. I was 40 years old when I arrived at the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous, and I might be one of the most reluctant participants in the Digital Age there is. I mean, I still pick up a real newspaper in my driveway every morning!

Then it hit me, ah-ha! Another chance to learn and grow! So, as I set about collecting and sifting through the huge collection of information available on this subject, I realized I had enough material to talk for an hour instead of the five minutes I've been given. Another part of my preparation included talking with a good cross section of young people for their input; so much of what I'll share here today comes from them and not me. As usually happens when I start digging around in A.A., I seemed to come up with more questions than answers.

Last year, the International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (ICYPAA) took place in San Francisco, which is in my home area, and I had the honor of attending and participating. This was my very first YPAA event of any kind, and it was an incredible experience I will not soon forget. The question I kept asking myself that weekend was: How do we transition the folks involved in YPAA committees, with their energy, excitement, and enthusiasm, into general service? Why is it that the average age of delegates keeps getting older every year?

Carrying the Message: *This is our twelfth suggestion: Carry this message to other alcoholics! You can help when no one else can.* (Alcoholics Anonymous, p. 89)

We don't need to change the message for the benefit of young

people; the message is the same, young or old. Now, some of the young people groups may package the message slightly differently, with more of an emphasis on the fun to be had in sobriety, but, regardless of age, our message of recovery is timeless.

Anonymity in the Digital Age: Young people, whether A.A. members or not, have grown up in the Digital Age. It is how they've learned to communicate. Anyone with teenage children can tell you that their kids have cell phones, but you can call them all day long and never get an answer. Send them a text, tweet, or Facebook message, however, and you get a reply within moments.

Much has been said and written about anonymity and how Traditions Eleven and Twelve apply in today's Digital Age. A.A. Guidelines on the Internet and the “Understanding Anonymity” pamphlet are both good sources of shared experience on dealing with anonymity in today's rapidly changing communications world. The A.A. Grapevine is also a great resource with many varied opinions.

The theme of the October 2011 Grapevine was “Anonymity,” and the issue included several stories devoted to this subject. However, my favorite article on the topic, entitled “Getting Up to Speed,” appeared on page 28 of the November 2011 issue. The author makes some very good arguments, including the point that social media sites like Facebook are inherently private and not public. So the question is begged: Does social media really operate at the same level of press, radio, and film?

Most of the young people I know in A.A. are involved in general service and/or with YPAA Committees. These folks tend to be more aware of, and informed about, the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous than your average A.A. member. In fact, most YPAA conventions for the past several years have included panels on the very subject that is our Conference theme this year: “Anonymity in the Digital Age.” So, young people are aware of this issue and are discussing it, which is all we can really hope for. Like every problem or situation in A.A., this too could be solved by better sponsorship and better communication.

While most young people I spoke with believe there are big benefits to using social media as an avenue to help carry the A.A. message, most don't equate the breaking of personal anonymity on Facebook with doing it at the level of press, radio, and films. To many the line of press, radio, and films seems so black and white, while the line concerning social media is less clear. This is mostly due to common social media procedures like membership, passwords, and the ability to set levels of privacy.

The overall attitude among young people in A.A. actually seems to be that there are much more important things to focus on in recovery. In reality, what is it we're so afraid of? What is the big harm being done to A.A. as a whole? Anonymity breaks have been going on since the early days of our Fellowship. People are going to do whatever they want to do. We can only do the same thing we've always done: In a very loving way remind the member of the “spiritual foundation of all our Traditions,” which is anonymity.

In my mind, personal anonymity as it relates to others in the program is the most important aspect of this topic. Newcomers should feel safe to come into the rooms of A.A. cloaked in as much anonymity as they deem necessary to be comfortable. As I've heard many young people put it; it's all about mindfulness, respect for others, and keeping my ego right-sized. We only have two enforcers in A.A.: the first is a Loving God, and the second is King Alcohol. Which one we choose to serve is up to each of us.

Ken Monson, California, Northern Coastal

The Importance of Sponsorship

My loving invitation is to give a presentation on "The Importance of Sponsorship." Consequently, I'm also thinking about our Conference theme, "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age." Thinking about these topics causes me to recall the lessons I learned from my sponsor.

Eva, my sponsor, was the toughest woman in my group. In fact, when I came around she was the *only* woman in the group. This group of people, called "the Fellowship," explained to me the importance of sponsorship, and their belief that a man sponsored a man and a woman sponsored a woman. I asked them "Who sponsors Eva?" One member spoke up and said that it took their collective recovery to sponsor her.

They told me about Bill Wilson's many attempts to stay sober. They talked about his hopeless state of body and mind, and how the diagnosis of hopelessness doomed him to certain death. Moreover, they explained Bill's desperation and his final conclusion that to stay sober he had to find and help another alcoholic. My group's members endeavored to impress upon me that alcoholism was a deadly disease, and that left untreated it would eventually end in madness or death.

Anonymity was an important aspect to my sponsor and to her sobriety. She explained to me the purpose of selfless service, and she also explained that should she take credit for someone else's sobriety, she would also need to take responsibility for their possible relapse. She went on to teach me that alcohol was a cunning, baffling, and powerful opponent, and that taking credit for another person's success in Alcoholics Anonymous could, and most likely would, lead to pride and control issues that could cause resentment.

As I gained more sober time, my sponsor taught me about the difference between personal anonymity and anonymity at the level of press, radio, film, and television. I know for certain that in today's Digital Age, with Facebook, Twitter, and other such media, my sponsor would encourage me to be very, very careful with both my anonymity and the anonymity of other members. Her most frequently used advice for me was: If in doubt, don't, until you find out.

My sponsor was not big on talking about a personal God, but she believed in an "attitude of gratitude" and in thanking her Higher Power for her sobriety every day. She was known for her wisdom in A.A., and she attributed that wisdom to our Big Book and the Grapevine. I am so fortunate to have inherited her tools; tools not just for sobriety, but for *contented* sobriety. Even though she did not do service beyond the group level, she got another member to drive us to some district and area meetings. I soon became the general service representative (G.S.R.) for the Progressive Group, and I've been involved in service ever since.

My sponsor died fifteen years ago. She was twenty-eight years sober. Her voice still rings loud and clear in my mind. "Pass it on," she says, and I do. At the end of the chapter "More About Alcoholism" in the Big Book, it says: "The alcoholic at certain times has no effective mental defense against the first drink." As I was taught, my defense must be spiritual, and part of my spiritual program includes observing frequent A.A. involvement in order to short-circuit my dangerous, deluded, and diseased thinking on the subject of alcohol.

I smile when I think these thoughts, and I wonder what new lessons my sponsor would teach me today. I wonder how she would explain the difficulties and importance of protecting "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age." I believe she'd likely say that A.A. will always find a way because our loving God, as we understand Him, is our ultimate and final authority.

Gerrie Dubien, Northeast Ontario

CHANGE — ESSENTIAL TO A.A.'s GROWTH

Wednesday morning Presentation/Discussion session was chaired by Nancy Horan, Southern Wisconsin.

Service: Our Third Legacy

Hi everybody, I'm Steve Price, and I'm an alcoholic, Panel 61 delegate for Area 39, Western Missouri. I have the privilege of serving on the Public Information Committee. It is an honor to be asked to share my experience on Service, Our Third Legacy. A little over 17 years ago I walked through the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous and it was suggested to me that I get a sponsor. After some deliberation, I did. My sponsor told me we were going to do the Steps and get involved in the A.A. service structure. I then began my journey into our Third Legacy. My dictionary defines service as work done by one person or a group that benefits another. It defines legacy as something handed down from an ancestor or a predecessor from the past. I remember when I first started going to our area assembly. I would sit on the back row and think to myself, "What is this all about, and what is the overall purpose?" I sat and listened to these people called area officers and someone called a delegate to our General Service Conference, and wondered if I would ever become one of these people. My sponsor told me that some day I could be up there, but meanwhile we had work to do. He showed me an inverted triangle in a book we call *The A.A. Service Manual*, and told me that it was my lucky day. He would start me at the top of the triangle, and I would get the privilege to work my way down. That is exactly what happened. It never once entered my mind I was being of service and/or becoming a part of the Legacy.

Our book tells us that we need to be of maximum service to God and to others. Before I came into the program this concept never played a part in my life. I have found that being of maximum service to God and to others is inconvenient, time consuming, and sometimes expensive. I have also found that not being of maximum service to God and others is deadly to me, our program, and those to come.

I would like to share some thoughts I had at last year's Conference. Sunday, opening day of the Conference, I walked into the ballroom and saw what I would call the Super Bowl of the A.A. service structure. I looked around the room and saw 92 other delegates from across the United States and Canada, our Board of Trustees and Directors, and all of our office personnel and thought "what am I doing here?" I thought my area had made the biggest mistake in its history by sending me there.

I went to my room that night and asked the God of my understanding for help, and here is what He came up with: Conference week was not about me, and the week was not about you all. The week was about my daughter and my son, and your daughters and your sons. It was about the people that have not yet found this God-giving gift of life. It was about making sure that Alcoholics Anonymous is the future.

I realize that the A.A. Super Bowl is not played here in New York; it is played in our areas, our districts, and in our groups throughout the United States, and the world. I realize that we here at Conference are just the equipment managers. We provide the equipment so that our groups, districts, and areas can be better equipped to be of maximum service to God, our Fellowship, and the people that have not yet found our life-giving program.

My alcoholic perception of becoming a delegate meant being an elite member of our service structure. During past years, I thought I was in service to become a delegate. I realize now that I was not in service to become a delegate, but rather that the Fellowship was training me to be of service and to carry the message

of Alcoholics Anonymous in whatever capacity it takes to insure our survival and the survival of the alcoholic who still suffers. Being of service to my group, my district, my area, and the Fellowship as a whole is not about becoming a legacy. It is about our survival. No matter what the cost, we have to make sure this program is here tomorrow.

Steve Price, Western Missouri

Spirit of Rotation

The spirit of rotation is the spirit of service. Rotation is the test of truly being of service. This, of course, is something that everyone here today clearly understands. For many of us, the principle of rotation is one that is much discussed in our areas. It is a principle that, while often known, is not always understood and not always practiced.

However, it seems for most A.A.s that time in service and experience with practicing the principle, brings an understanding of, and appreciation for, the value of rotation. When I began to write this presentation I thought about pointing to some of the places in our literature where the principle of rotation is discussed: Tradition Nine, Concept XI, and the many job descriptions of service positions found in *The A.A. Service Manual*. There are many wonderful passages in our literature from which I could quote, and perhaps should quote, to capture the essence of this topic. But what I thought I should do instead is relate my experience, strength and hope — to tell you my own story — to tell you what is in my heart.

I arrived in A.A. as one of those guys who was always ready to jump into the driver's seat and get things running right. It was like I was born with a gift of always knowing what was good for you — what you should be doing. A gift not everyone appreciated as much as they should have when I shared it, even though I shared with the best of intentions.

Of course, being so driven by ego is what got me here. Luckily for me I arrived, as we all do, beaten enough by alcohol to have a grain of humility, to be the smallest bit teachable. When I no longer had all the answers there was room for my higher power to enter into my life. A crack that let the light in. Because I did not have all of the answers anymore, I had to ask for help from my sponsor, from others, from the God of my understanding. I began to learn something of patience, tolerance, trust and love.

Service in A.A. has offered a similar experience. I do not drink coffee and had no idea how to make it, so I asked. I did not know how to be a greeter, so I asked, watched and learned. I did not know how to be a D.C.M. so I did these same things. I read A.A. literature, I found a service sponsor, I stayed teachable. I made mistakes. I learned that the best I could do was good enough. A big lesson for this perfectionist. Humility, grain by grain, came from that slightly off balance feeling of not knowing exactly what I should be doing.

When I arrived in A.A. I was an expert in many things, knowledgeable in a few and wise in none. The problem with being an expert is that I already know the best way of doing something, so I am intolerant of new ideas or new approaches. In

A.A. it seems that I rotate on from a service position just ahead of becoming an expert.

I suppose one might ask if the practice of rotation then makes us inefficient. Perhaps we would get more done if we allowed the people with the experience to serve longer. Bill answers this from one perspective in his Concept XI essay. I have another perspective or experience. It might be that if we held on to our A.A. service positions longer, we could really change some things in A.A. But don't we all come to know that A.A. is not about changing things, it is about changing people. We may sometimes laugh, or sigh in frustration, about how long it takes for things to change in A.A. — how we are never in a hurry.

However, is this not really because we are not in the business of changing things, but changing ourselves and helping others find a way to change?

As I rotate on from a position (and it seems easier to think of rotating "on" than rotating "out"), not yet being an expert, I am willing to help the new person with some sense of tolerance, humility and love. To *help* the new person, not to do it the way I think it should be done, but to help him or her find a way to be of service that is theirs. Is this not what I am called upon to do with the newcomer? Not to push my higher power on them, but to help them find their own way to be of service. To simply help them find the path to change.

Tradition Twelve says that "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. . . ." As I have served in A.A. I have had an opportunity to see and experience the principle of anonymity in action. It is in the examples of the trusted servants who preceded me in my area. I saw how their lives were enriched when what they did was for the good of A.A. and not about them. They did not see their service as some sort of power or prestige that their ego might drive them to hold on to, and so they rotated on to become those "elder statesmen."

We see this same example in the biannual rotation that happens at our General Service Office. In the August/September 2007 issue of *Box 4-5-9* the following paragraph appeared:

"Is rotation easy? No, say those who have done it. Is it essential to the A.A. way of life? Yes, says the collective voice of A.A. experience. Rotation is frequently referred to as 'anonymity in action' because it is one vital way we have of avoiding power, prestige and personal recognition from distorting our best intentions. Also, since the process of rotation in almost all service positions — from the group level to the



board of trustees — limits the length of individual service, it does away with popularity contests, 'ever reminding us to place principles above personalities,' in the spirit of Tradition Twelve."

I have loved every service position I have had in Alcoholics Anonymous. I can't say I have wanted to give up any of them, but I know what I have received in A.A. When I serve for the good of A.A., I benefit in innumerable and immeasurable ways. You have taught me that to keep this gift, I must "give it away." I want this joy for others. For them to find it, I must move aside and make room. If a newcomer walked into a meeting of A.A., would I give him my chair and stand in the back so he might find what I have found? When I don't rotate, am I not holding on to my chair? Saying that I am more important than A.A.? Is it more important for me to keep mine than to help the newcomer?

If I am truly being of service, if I am truly honoring our Tradition of anonymity, if I truly love Alcoholics Anonymous and want to help the new person, I will rotate with joy in my heart. Perhaps with a little sadness that the experience is over — I will certainly miss all of you next year — but I will have joy in my heart for the experience.

Thank you for my life.

Scott Huyghebaert, British Columbia/Yukon

Diversity — Let's Keep Our Doors Open for Any Who May Suffer from Alcoholism

How fortunate for me to receive a loving invitation to discuss diversity in A.A. — I serve one of the most diverse areas in the U.S. and Canada, Area 49, Southeast New York. Of course, I was very nervous, so I shared with my sponsor and my husband (a past delegate) my fears and concerns about standing in front of a group of people while trying to read anything. They each assured me this was something I could do!

In Area 49 we have meetings in Spanish, French, Russian, Polish, and Korean. We have a tribe called Shinacott on Long Island. We serve rural as well as densely populated urban areas, including inner cities which remind me a lot of remote communities. Our young people are extremely active in all areas of service — ICYPAA in Times Square 2010 was the largest ever! Our meetings cover all types, from men's and women's meetings to meetings for writers and artists, and even to meetings for dual diagnosis and gay/transgender. We are pioneers in Special Needs and Disabilities.

The challenge, I believe, is to integrate everyone who says they are an alcoholic and unite us all. Our Third Tradition states "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking." Regardless of any other problems or identifiers, we should consider ourselves alcoholics first and foremost.

I came from a somewhat small town, where everyone strove to be alike. Throughout my life I always associated with people just like me, who spoke, acted, and behaved as I did. There was no middle ground — either you were with us or you were against us. This attitude kept me drunk and sick for a long time. Coming into Alcoholics Anonymous, my life changed and I opened myself up to many new people who were not like me. As I attended my first meetings, I noticed many people sitting around talking about how they were staying sober — men, women, straight, gay, all different races, different religions and beliefs, from all financial and educational backgrounds. No one seemed to care about the differences between them. Their primary purpose was to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and help each other to stay sober. I saw the diversity of people in the rooms and wanted to be a part of. Deep inside I knew this was my bridge back to life — a life fuller and deeper than I had imagined.

As we read in Tradition Three, "A newcomer appeared at one of these groups. . . . He soon proved that he was a desperate case . . . 'But,' he asked, . . . 'will you let me join your group? Since I am the victim of another addiction. . . .'" Spirited (controversial) discussion ensued, 'We deal . . . with alcoholics only,' the elders said. Another of the group spoke, 'What we are really afraid of . . . is our reputation.' While the newcomer's fate hung delicately in the balance, one of the members spoke in a very different voice. "As we have been talking, five short words have been running through my mind . . . 'What would the Master do?'" Not another word was said." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, pp 141-142)

Group experience gave birth to Tradition Three. The long form of this Tradition states "Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover." (*ibid*, p. 189)

It is vitally important for us to keep our doors open to all newcomers who state they are alcoholics. As they enter our groups with their many faces and differences — let us always maintain an attitude of love and tolerance. Let us remember that "To many a desperate drunk A.A. is the court of last appeal. How can we slam the door on anyone who stands outside?" They may be different but "Who of us dares to say, 'No, you can't come in,' thereby setting himself up as judge, jury, and perhaps executioner of his brother alcoholic?" (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 103) May our Higher Power continue to bless us and help us to welcome all who come through the doors of A.A. seeking recovery from the disease of alcoholism, regardless of their differences.

Susan Flynn, Southeast New York

Archives — Where the Past Meets the Present

I am honored, nervous, and delighted to be here today. When I received my loving invitation to give a presentation, my thoughts alternated on a myriad of emotions, mostly on apprehension, but also a blend of excitement and gratitude. The invitation suggested that I focus my talk on "Archives — Where the Past Meets the Present."

I thought about the topic and started reading through our literature to ensure that I knew what I was talking about. Then I thought again and decided to take the "keep it simple" approach to this presentation and share from my experiences; so here goes.

I came into A.A. on October 6, 1988, and almost from the get-go I started reading about our history in books like *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, and *Pass it On*. The more I read the more I wanted to know, and I wanted the past to meet the present right then. So I decided to visit the places I was reading about and try to make it real. I went to Founders Day in Akron, Ohio and visited the Mayflower Hotel and saw the Church Directory and the phone that Bill Wilson made that historic phone call from. I then visited the Gate House where Dr. Bob and Bill met for the first time. I also visited Dr. Bob's house and saw what I had read about. I looked through the archives that are stored there. I went to the Akron Intergroup archives and read more about the early years of Alcoholics Anonymous. I visited Dr. Bob's gravesite, and it started to become real. I wanted more, so I went to Stepping Stones and toured the house that Bill and Lois lived in, including "Wit's End," the small house that Bill and his friend built.

I sat at Bill's desk where he wrote *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*. By this time I was excited beyond belief. But I still wanted more, so I went to the Wilson House in Vermont and slept in the house that Bill Wilson grew up in. I went to Bill and Lois's gravesite and paid my respects as

best as I could. I had brought the past to meet my present. At the General Service Conference last year I was able to visit the G.S.O. Archives, and I learned more about our history and how they are actively capturing this historic evidence and preserving it for the future and for our use. But archival service also extends to our group histories, to including the districts and area levels.

In Area 01 we are working toward each group getting a historical collection of when and how their groups got started. We are doing the same at our district levels, and our area Archives Committee is hard at work getting and preserving our area history. They are asking oldtimers to tape their stories; the G.S.O. Archives can help you get started with suggestions for how to conduct a successful taped interview.

Creating a history of your home group through research and interviews will help you learn how, when, and why your group got started. You can then share this history with your district and area. The collective experience of the past reminds us how little hope there once was for the suffering alcoholic — and also of how far we've come, thanks to Alcoholics Anonymous. I am looking forward to serving with all you at our 62nd General Service Conference as we do all we can to ensure A.A. remains alive and well.

Dennis Jaroslawski, Alabama/Northwest Florida

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE ARCHIVES

Thursday afternoon G.S.O.'s Archivist gave a Power Point Presentation. George Martin, chair of the trustees' Archives Committee, chaired the Discussion session following the Presentation.

Good evening and thank you, George, for your introduction. It is a privilege for me to serve as your Archivist and I am delighted to be here, presenting to this Conference body for the second time. I want to welcome the new Panel 62 delegates to New York and hope that you will all feel free to use G.S.O.'s archives as a valuable resource. The Archives staff will do their best to answer any questions you may have on our work as archivists or on A.A.'s history. I think it is very hard to convey just how dedicated and hard-working our Archives staff is, but I would like to publicly commend them for their outstanding efforts.

This afternoon I have been asked to give a presentation on our Archives. Through my presentation I hope to demonstrate how connections to our past are important to developing and maintaining our sense of place, purpose, and connectedness. Thank you for this wonderful opportunity.

In all of our lives, there are moments that cause us to pause and reflect about whether or not we can make a difference. Now, there are some who believe that our Archives is little more than a "black hole," one that constantly consumes valuable money and resources. It is not my intent to persuade you that archiving A.A.'s history is critical, but I respectfully submit that I am fortunate to have a career that does make a difference. In the grand scheme of things, what we do in the Archives is profound. We are the selectors and preservers of our history. The past will never even have a chance to meet the present should our resources become unavailable. We must preserve material to some degree or it will simply vanish, and for this reason the very act of preservation is a foundational belief for archivists. We save the records of today — including the debates of this Conference and, hopefully, many more to come — so we can share our experience, strength and hope with future generations of newcomers, just as the stories from our past have been saved and shared with us.

A few years ago I came across a quote by a former President of the Society of American Archivists that wonderfully captures the essence of what I am trying to say: "Archives are, and will re-

main, that place where, above everything else, the souls of a person and of a community are both preserved and laid bare. Insofar as any human can find truth, truth is in our holdings. Insofar as any human can find immortality, immortality is in our stacks."

Indeed, the truths of Alcoholics Anonymous are maintained and to be discovered in our holdings.

One of my favorite topics, which I think of as a significant and critical link to the past, is the history of the writing of the Twelve Traditions. The Traditions are messages that were formulated 66 years ago as a guide for all of our future actions — guides that we continue to rely on in this 21st century — and hopefully well beyond. Our Twelve Traditions provide us with the successful tools of self-government, and suggest ways that A.A. as a whole should conduct and define itself in relation to the larger world. The extent of our vast collection of correspondence between Headquarters and the groups in the United States and Canada starting in the 1940s and ongoing through the 1950s is estimated to be over 24,000 documents. We have committed to a sustained investment in their preservation because these letters provide us with unique and primary testimony regarding the growing pains of our evolving Society and the solutions that were discovered.

The Conference theme this year is "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age." Anonymity is the foundational building block of the Fellowship, with roots going far back into the years before the Traditions were actually composed. For instance, three years after A.A. separated from the Oxford Group, Bill wrote a personal letter to a member in Richmond, Virginia in October of 1940, explaining the reasons for that split. In this letter he writes, "Excessive personal publicity or prominence in the [Oxford Group] work was found to be bad. Alcoholics who talked too much on public platforms were likely to become inflated and get drunk again. Our principle of anonymity, so far as the general public is concerned, partly corrects this difficulty preventing any individual receiving a lot of newspaper or magazine publicity, then collapsing and discrediting A.A." The clarity and insight of the thoughts contained in this letter are really wondrous! Our cofounder certainly possessed a unique ability to envision and avoid the disastrous consequences of these kinds of actions far ahead of the fledgling digital movement.

Since the mid-1940s, we have heard many alcoholics voice their concern within the Fellowship over the erosion of anonymity and since the 1960s, this Conference body has heard numerous presentations on the subject of anonymity. In the Archives, our staff is pleased to provide useful historical perspective with regard to this Tradition. In a 1946 letter the Headquarters secretary wrote that the "principle of anonymity is probably the hottest subject today with money following a close second." Since then, I ask you, how much have things changed? The Digital Age certainly presents a new challenge to this Tradition, but the substantive core remains unchanged — "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our traditions." As A.A. grows worldwide, Bill's words from 1946 seem almost prophetic: "In the years that lie ahead the principle of anonymity will undoubtedly become a part of our vital tradition." Bill continues by adding that anonymity is "so very valuable to us now, it may become an incalculable asset for the future. In a spiritual sense, anonymity amounts to the renunciation of personal prestige as an instrument of general policy. I am confident that we shall do well to preserve this powerful principle; that we should resolve never to let it go" ("A.A. Tradition" pamphlet 1947). And as Dr. Bob eloquently said, "If we have a banner, that word, speaking of the surrender of the individual — the ego — is emblazoned on it. Let us dwell thoughtfully on its full meaning and learn thereby to remain humble, modest, and ever conscious that we are eternally under divine direction" (A.A. Grapevine, September 1948).

Storytellers introduce the past to the present in our society. Humorous anecdotes, tragic tales and personal recovery stories all find a permanent habitat in the Archives. Each day our staff of Archivists continues to draw from our history, which has been chronicled in early writings, in speeches, and in personal letters. And we are currently digitizing these invaluable assets so that our Archives will be electronically searchable.

Our Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, is a compendium of personal stories as well, and because of that it holds intrinsic value for us. We have seen it undergo various changes since its first publication, going through varying formats and editions until now, some 73 years later, the Big Book is even available digitally. But whatever the format, the essence of the experiences communicated have not changed, and newcomers in this century are still able to read decades-old stories that have been carried through to the current Fourth Edition. I would like to share an excerpt from one of Bill's letters, where he reveals how he cleverly gathered the stories for the Second Edition. For me, this piece not only possesses historical significance, but it humanizes the past, another tremendous asset only available from our archival records.

"In addition to the book just done on the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions, we have been revising the story section of the A.A. book from tape recordings made at actual A.A. meetings. Not dinners, special occasions, or the eloquent efforts of our elder statesmen — the stories we have selected come from almost unknown A.A.s who did not know they were recording for posterity. This makes the identification with the newcomer who reads the book much better. Moreover, we have a far wider range of experience than we had in the old story section. There the choices were narrow because there were so few of us. And we were all 'last gaspers.' Women in A.A. were almost unheard of then, too. And as for young people, none such had turned up." (Letter: 1953)

Technology has evolved but the message remains the same. We are a storytelling society; individual recovery stories in the Big Book show how A.A. works, making a transformation from despair to hope of a new life. And the treasures held in the A.A. Archives make those stories come alive in a way that would never be possible without them.

Photographs also tell a story. They capture drama and humor, and provide us with a unique sense of place. Our repository contains thousands of photographs, negatives, and slides. But the value of the collection doesn't lie in the quantity of the images, but in the quality. The stories captured, the lessons taught, and the feelings inspired are timeless.

This brings me to my last point. History is not limited to paper and film, but also recorded in audio. Oral history continues to be an important research methodology, so tapes and transcripts need to be effectively integrated into the collection. Now that we are building a comprehensive audio catalog — a challenging but important ongoing feat — we are discovering even more interesting facts that help bring some of these ancient anecdotes to life. The dawn of the Digital Age has allowed for optimized access to these recordings by A.A. members, historians, and other information seekers. But digital technology has also forced us to confront difficult questions of copyright restriction, liabilities, and other legal stipulations.

I am going to conclude with excerpts from an audio recording by our cofounder, Bill Wilson, at the opening ceremony of the 1960 General Service Conference. Bill remarked that A.A. is in an era of evolution but our Steps and Traditions were unlikely to change.

Dear people, I was terribly afraid that an address would be required and sensing that, I rushed upstairs to get a little powder for my false teeth so if I stood you up think nothing of it. This is the 25th Anniversary year of our Fellowship that is the 22nd year of our Trusteeship and it is the 10th year of this Conference on which so much of

our destiny depends. I wish I had the capability to communicate to you what these 25 years have meant to us, to Lois and to me. What the Trusteeship has meant, what the labors and the demonstration of this Conference has meant. I really can't do that, I can just make a stab at it. At a time like this before thinking about today or tomorrow, old timers like Lois and me think about the past. . . . Here ends, still yet, an era of change. Our Twelve Steps probable won't change; the Traditions, not at all likely. But our manner of communications, our manner of organizing ourselves for function or service...let us hope that this goes on changing for the better, forever. There is a very natural resistance that we have towards change. We are apt to say well it worked very well the way it was so why change. But after all, we've undertaken several tremendous changes. You will remember that in the very early days people said well why a self-appointed Trusteeship, later people said why a book, and now in 1950 very loudly many people say why a Conference, so I cite that to show that on good evidence we are indeed ready to make all kinds of change. Not that any great changes are in prospect but I think we ought to stay open-minded on this matter of change. . . . We reference the past and its lessons for so long as those teachings work. When they don't work, we re-adapt and we reshape. That has been our history. The lessons of the past, however, are something that we ought to preserve. Sometimes we go to the other tack, throwing out the baby with the bath water, ignoring the lessons of the past, and for these reasons, that we might want to change but that we must also understand the past and its lessons in connection with this Service Conference, I have been trying to do a set of interpretive essays, or rather articles. . . . Therefore we enter this 25th year stepping across one more threshold into the future. What does the future hold for us? What may its perils be like? How can we strengthen ourselves against the time of peril? To put it negatively, to put it positively, how can we increase our communication with the sea of drunks around us?

As I said in the beginning, it is gratifying to have a job that can make such a difference as this, for without the records we so carefully preserve, we might well simply lose these "lessons of the past" — and then where would we be?

Michelle Mirza, archivist



■ Reports from the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Greetings and welcome to the 62nd General Service Conference, especially to those who are attending their first Conference and to our guest observer from India. I know we are all here to do the "business" of A.A., but I have always viewed the General Service Conference as a spiritual adventure — at once exciting and a lot of hard work, but also uplifting as we seek to reach an informed group conscience for A.A. in the U.S. and Canada. And, while we have a lot of business on our agenda for this week, some of which relates to A.A.'s growing presence on the Internet — a presence that has created some challenges for us as a Fellowship, particularly in terms of anonymity — I believe that a higher power will be ever present as we address that "business."

Therefore, it is appropriate that our theme for this year's Conference is "Anonymity — Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age." Bill reminds us in an article in the A.A. Grapevine of January 1955 that not only is anonymity "the greatest protection our society can ever have," but that "the spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice." More than ever, A.A.'s exposure to the world at large via the Internet has expanded tremendously. The Internet is both a marvel for helping to carry our message and

informing the public at large about A.A. and a challenge in terms of adhering to our principles — especially that of anonymity. It is well then that at this time in A.A.'s history and at this Conference we reexamine our principle of anonymity in the light of the electronic age.

Over the past year, our General Service Board has welcomed some new members: Class B trustees J. Gary Lutz, Clayton Vandivort, Barbara Kelly, and Nancy Haynes. Additionally, Rod Betoney, Pacific Regional Trustee, joined A.A.W.S. as a new director. Michele Grinberg, Class A trustee, and Donald Cusson joined the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board as directors.

We also have a new staff member at G.S.O. Tracey Ober joined the G.S.O. family in August. Tracey is on the Corrections desk responding to the multitude of inmates who write to the office. She now has two General Service Board meetings under her belt — her first trials by fire, and she has done very well. I hope you will take a moment to welcome Tracey during the Conference week.

One of the most significant projects undertaken this year has been the production of our own digital apps to provide the Fellowship with e-book versions of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. This was launched in December and is proving to be popular. The Grapevine, Inc. also entered the digital field with its e-book publication of *The Language of the Heart*. We are hopeful that this method of distributing A.A. literature will grow.

In response to last year's Advisory Action regarding A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., I have been working with an ad hoc committee seeking ways to enhance cooperation and efficiency between the two corporate boards. As a result of this effort, the Grapevine has moved its offices from the 10th floor of the Interchurch Center to a smaller, more economical space on the 12th floor, which will result in considerable savings in the coming years. Much of the Grapevine's shipping, mail room and copy center operations are now provided by A.A.W.S. along with its on-site sales, which now occur at G.S.O. We are presently looking at ways to coordinate our e-book sales and exploring the possibility of having Grapevine licensing and translations matters coordinated by A.A.W.S. As the ad hoc committee continues its work going forward, I want to express my appreciation for the work of Ami Brophy, executive editor/publisher of the A.A. Grapevine, and Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, for their cooperative efforts during this transition period.

The General Service Board has met four times since our last Conference. Aside from the members meeting of the board at the Conference last year, the trustees held three quarterly meetings at the Crowne Plaza Hotel in New York.

One of the most important actions we of the General Service Board undertook this year was taking our inventory. It was suggested in a previous inventory done a number of years ago that the board take its inventory every three years or so and the time had come for us to take this action. We added an extra day and a half to the 2011 October Board meeting for this and then followed up with a weekend meeting in January of this year in Atlanta. We were assisted by a consultant, Gregg Talley, whose name you may recognize, as his firm, Talley Management Group, has



served the Fellowship as our International Conventions consultant since 1990. The Inventory Planning Committee, chaired by Michele Grinberg, provided us with pertinent topics and questions that laid the ground work for us to get the process well underway.

The major concern arising from the inventory revolved around the Board's use of time. It was felt that too much time was spent on what could be termed as "management" issues and not enough spent on larger, strategic issues facing the Fellowship and the Board. The follow-up committee will be looking at the Board's structure and schedule to develop time to further discuss the varied and significant concerns identified in our inventory.

Since the 61st General Service Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Sturbridge, Massachusetts; Davenport, Iowa; Wichita, Kansas; and Miamisburg, Ohio. An "Additional" Forum was held in Woodland Hills, California. Also, there were two local Forums, one held in Kennewick, Washington and the other, a two-for-one Local Forum, in Great Falls and Miles City, Montana. All were well attended by enthusiastic members interested in participating in A.A.'s Three Legacies.

Financially, G.S.O. continues to find ways to prudently use the A.A. dollar and cut costs in these challenging economic times. You will hear a full financial report from our treasurer, Terry Bedient.

Don Massey and Barb Kelley, our trustees-at-large, were our delegates to the REDELA (the Meeting of the Americas) in San Salvador, El Salvador. In addition to the REDELA, our trustees and staff traveled abroad to share our experience with other countries, including Germany, England, South Africa, and India where the Asia-Oceania Zonal meeting was held. I attended a seminar on *The Harmful Use of Alcohol* at the World Health Organization in Geneva, Switzerland, and was also privileged to attend the 21st Native American Indian A.A. Convention in Las Vegas, Nevada.

In the upcoming year, in October, we will be hosting the World Service Meeting in Rye, New York, and A.A. continues to expand internationally. This past year we learned that members in Iran had formed a small General Service Board and a G.S.O. We are told they are now working on developing a Conference structure.

Currently, the Big Book has been translated into 64 languages with several pending translations in various stages of preparation — a few of these pending items include Bambara, a dialect spoken in Mali, K'iche' for the Mayan-speaking population in Guatemala and Belize, and Haitian Creole.

I'd like to share excerpts from three recent letters written to the Publications Department from international folks:

The first is from a member in Cook Island in the Pacific about the Maori Big Book translation: *"We are already using the Chapter 5 translated content in our meetings, both in town and in the prison. It has been VERY well received by the local members."*

And from a Peace Corps volunteer in Gulu, Uganda/East Africa: *"Thank you so much for the literature you sent for the prisoners at the Uganda Government Prison-Gulu. They are so excited about receiving it. They have set up a Lit Committee and have a process outlined so that people can have maximum access while still exerting some accountability."*

And the last, from Zimbabwe, a member writes: *"Oh! My goodness — the box of A.A. literature has just arrived. What a fantastic beginning to my sober day. I collected the box from the post office this morning, and all the contents are in perfect condition. Our newer members are going to be so grateful to obtain a Daily Reflections — they haven't been able to get one of their own. They have been borrowing from older members, but, as you know, it is so nice to have one of your own. I don't know how to thank you all — I'm over the top with gratitude. Please thank all the members concerned. Our small fellowship is doing very well and it is growing ever so slowly, but surely."*

A.A. is truly an international community and the need for A.A.

and translations of its publications is apparent. The sharing of experience, strength and hope invigorates us all. I hope you share with the members and groups in your areas how their service participation and Seventh Tradition contributions impact A.A. around the world.

Finally, as you know from my letter to you earlier this year, much of which I will repeat at this time, at the 2012 January Board week-end the General Service Board passed the following motion which, following past precedent, I am bringing forward from the GSB to the Conference. The motion reads as follows:

"The General Service Conference supports the General Service Board's development of a plan to restructure the current Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc. corporate and governance structure, while retaining the Grapevine's independent editorial voice. The plan may, among other things, address the separate corporate existence of Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc., as well as issues of governance and operations. The plan will be designed to increase unity, better reach and connect the Grapevine to the broader Fellowship while addressing financial stability. Any plan developed will be submitted to the 63rd General Service Conference, in 2013, for approval prior to implementation."

Most of you here today are familiar with the issues involved, but to recap here is a brief overview of some of the challenges and concerns regarding the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. that the Board has been discussing:

- The universal migration in the publishing industry from print to electronic magazine publications;
- The General Service Board's fiduciary responsibility to the Fellowship in further authorizations to the A.A. Grapevine's use of the Reserve Fund to meet operational needs. (Drawdowns from the Reserve Fund since 1995 total \$1,447,299. In 2010 alone, the drawdown was \$588,000. This exceeds the \$573,200 that in its good years the Grapevine contributed to the Reserve Fund);
- The A.A. Grapevine's projections for 2013 and 2014 estimate further drawdowns totaling \$498,169 unless policies and operations can be changed;
- The increasing focus on A.A. Grapevine's overall welfare has led to a growing sense of disunity in the Fellowship that has proven to be a distraction in fulfilling our primary purpose.

The A.A. Grapevine is an important resource for carrying the A.A. message. Your General Service Board seeks only to find the best solutions for our future. As part of the recent inventory we reviewed ongoing discussions and concerns regarding the A.A. Grapevine, dating back to 1989. We concluded that the problems were complex and would require serious and thorough study before any changes were made. It is important to note here that no change is being proposed at this Conference.

As you know, the scope of the General Service Board would allow it to proceed with the development of a plan on its own, but initiating such a plan would have the potential for historic significance, so we are bringing the Board's motion to the Conference. This matter will be addressed after the Conference Committee Reports.

And so, as Conference week is upon us once again, we begin our work. Let us resolutely continue reaffirming our commitment to carrying A.A.'s lifesaving message. The General Service Conference is a precious gift passed on to us by our forbearers and, as the inheritors of their legacy, it is our responsibility to be sure the hand of A.A. is always there for the still-suffering alcoholic reaching out for help anywhere in the world.

As this week unfolds, may a loving God bless you and guide you in your endeavors.

Ward Ewing, D.D., chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: director of staff services, G.S.O. staff, chief financial officer, publications director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of A.A. Grapevine.

Each year directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office (G.S.O.), and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of my fellow directors. The purpose of the publication activities and group services provided by A.A.W.S. and G.S.O., as requested from the Fellowship, is to support members' and groups' Twelfth Step efforts to reach the still-suffering alcoholic. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the 61st Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff, review updates on group services activity, track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations related to A.A.W.S., review financial reports, price new and revised publications, consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and to address other pertinent matters.

The board utilizes the committee system to address extensive agendas, to gather background material, and to thoroughly consider requests. The board, in turn, discusses committee reports and votes on any recommendations presented by a board committee in these reports. In addition, each committee and the board as a whole conduct long-range and strategic planning. Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (considers the needs of all service assignments); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (overseas budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (suggests candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies).

Group Services — A net total of 972 new A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada were listed at G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact receives A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step activities.

Following up with a 2011 Additional Committee Consideration from the Grapevine Conference Committee, information about the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña is being inserted into general service representative kits.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site is the responsibility of the A.A.W.S. Board of Directors, acting through its Services Committee and in accordance with the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

- **Web Site Redesign:** Initial planning has begun for a redesign of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to substantially improve navigation on the

site. The exploratory phase of the work has concluded, and we are moving forward with construction.

- **Daily Reflections Online:** The board approved the recommendation from the Services Committee to post a *Daily Reflections* page on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site that would be refreshed daily. Available in all three languages, the daily reading can be accessed by clicking on a link on our home page. The committee also asked management to explore the feasibility of e-delivery for *Daily Reflections* similar to that currently available for newsletters.

- **Activity Reports:** The board approved the 2011 Quarterly and Annual Web Site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. These reports detail requests for changes and additions to the Web site and how they are addressed. The annual report is provided to the Conference Committee on Public Information from the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Forums and Other Events — Throughout the year, G.S.O. staff members are invited to attend and participate in many local and area service events, conferences and conventions. These trips help provide information about G.S.O. to A.A. gatherings and help staff to gather local experience to add to other collected experience available from G.S.O.

Regional and Additional Forums — Since the 61st General Service Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff have participated in five Regional Forums: the Northeast Regional Forum in Sturbridge, MA, in May, 2011; the "Additional" Pacific Regional Forum in Woodland Hills, CA, in August, 2011; the West Central Regional Forum in Davenport, IA, in September; the Southwest Regional Forum in Wichita, KS, in October, 2011; and the East Central Regional Forum in Miamisburg, OH, in November 2011.

Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A. Grapevine Seminar — The 26th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A. Grapevine Seminar was held in Tucson, AZ, September 29th through October 2nd. Chair Pam R. represented A.A.W.S., and in attendance from G.S.O. were the general manager, representatives from the Publications Department, and G.S.O.'s staff member serving as liaison to intergroup and central offices. Communication between intergroup/central offices and general service was a significant topic of discussion.

National A.A. Archives Workshop — G.S.O. Archivist Michelle Mirza participated at the 15th Annual National A.A. Archives Workshop in Helena, MT, in September, 2011.

International — Trustees and G.S.O. staff members also accept invitations from A.A. in other countries to share experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures. Highlights include: The 16th European Service Meeting was held in October, 2011, in Frankfurt, Germany. The theme of this event was "Unity — Our Safeguard." The International desk coordinator and the general manager presented at this event, focusing on the importance of striving for worldwide unity. The International desk coordinator and the general manager participated in the 5th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting in Johannesburg, South Africa, in June, 2011. Twenty delegates from the following countries participated in the 9th Asia Oceania Service Meeting held in Chandigarh, Punjab, India, July 22-24, 2011: Australia, Bhutan, Hong Kong, India, Japan, MERRCA (representing eight Middle Eastern countries), Nepal, New Zealand, Russia, Singapore, Sri Lanka and Thailand.

Financial — Complete audited financial details for 2011 are included in the Conference Manual and *Conference Final Report*. Here is an overview: G.S.O. had a net profit for the year 2011 of \$817,900, compared with a budgeted profit of \$300,080. This net profit is \$437,000 less than the \$1,255,300 profit reported for the year 2010. Net sales of \$12,506,100 for the year 2011 were ap-

proximately \$9,000 (0.7%) less than budgeted. Gross margin from literature sales was \$9,538,800, approximately \$61,800 (.065%) greater than budget and \$217,100 greater than 2010. Contributions received of \$6,264,500 were \$235,500 (3.6%) less than budgeted and \$144,000 (2.25%) less than the total for 2010. Total revenue for 2011 (gross profit from literature sales, contributions, and interest earned on cash flow) was \$14,226,400. Total revenue was about \$222,400 less than budgeted and \$47,000 less than in 2010.

2012 Budget — The A.A. World Services Board approved the 2012 General Service Office budget with a net income of \$147,893; after review by the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee, the budget was approved by the General Service Board.

Publications — Sales unit distribution from G.S.O. of all books in English excluding "no charges" totaled 1,776,013 units for 2011. Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* unit sales of all formats for 2011 were 945,406 and 396,135 respectively. Unit sales for these titles in 2010 totaled 886,873 and 363,669. A.A. purchases totaled 1,418,481 units (79.9% of total units). Purchases of items by non-A.A. individuals/entities in 2011 totaled 357,532 units (20.1% of total units). A new A.A. Literature Catalog was mailed in conjunction with the mailing of the Fall 2011 issue of *Box 4-5-9*. For the first time, the catalog included a section with items from the A.A. Grapevine.

E-Book Project — After a positive reception on our *E-Book Initiative* presentation at the 2011 General Service Conference, the first two A.A.W.S. e-books, Fourth Edition Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (in English, French and Spanish) were launched on a new A.A.W.S. Online Store in December. Work continues to ensure the smooth operation of the system and sales simultaneous with the development of an app for Android and iPad. Our IT group and Publications Department addressed post-launch corrections, adjustments and communications. The A.A.W.S. Online Store and the instructions for use on the App were made available in Spanish and French, and an update for the app for Apple products was deployed in mid-February. The next two e-books planned for release are *Daily Reflections* and *Living Sober*. For the period December 12, 2011 through February 29, 2012, we sold 3,609 e-books in English, French and Spanish — 1,904 Big Books and 1,705 *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*.

Online Sales — After lengthy discussions, A.A.W.S. approved the concept of online sales. The online sales will include a revised shipping and warehousing charge. The shipping price changes will not take effect until online ordering is implemented, and the date for this is many months in the future.

Literature in Translation — The committee discussed their continuing commitment to providing A.A.W.S. material in English, French and Spanish when feasible and appropriate. The committee voiced their wish to continue an annual review of A.A.W.S. materials not available in all three languages.

Images in Translations — The board approved the recommendation from the Publishing Committee that translation of A.A. literature may include images to better reach suffering alcoholics from widely divergent cultures and backgrounds in countries other

than the United States and Canada. Translations remain within the purview of the Publications Department.

Advisory Actions Book — The board approved the recommendation from the Publishing Committee that an anonymity-protected PDF of the *Advisory Actions of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous 1951-2009* be made available as an electronic service piece to be sent to A.A. members upon request.

Unfunded Projects — The Publishing Committee reviewed an inventory of the Publications Department unfunded projects, and advised moving three projects forward for inclusion in the 2012 budget: ASL and CD formats for the new pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs"; large print formats in French of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; and Conference Advisory Actions Summary Booklet (1989-2011 only) in French and Spanish.

Bar Codes — The Publications Department will be providing bar codes on books in order to help track inventory and process purchases. They will also look into adding bar codes to A.A.W.S. pamphlets.

G.S.O. and Staff Operations — At year-end 2011, G.S.O. had 77 full-time employees, and 3 part-time employees. The service piece "Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S." describes in detail the services provided by the A.A. staff assignments and other employees at G.S.O.

G.S.O. Visitors — In 2011, G.S.O. welcomed 1,641 visitors, including several groups ranging from 10 to 75 members. Many A.A. members traveled great distances to visit G.S.O. and to express their gratitude, in many languages, for their sobriety. One of the main highlights for members is a visit to the G.S.O. Archives where the welcoming Archives staff provides information and answers questions.

Archives — A.A.W.S. approved the Publishing Committee recommendation that the quarterly issues of *Markings*, the Archives newsletter, be translated into French and Spanish at a cost of \$8,000 per year. Based on a 2011 Conference Additional Consideration, G.S.O. Archives developed the *Archives Preservation Guidelines* to provide guidance to local archivists responsible for maintaining the physical and intellectual integrity of the collection. Additional information about the vital work of the Archives is available in the G.S.O. Reports section of the Conference Manual.

Copyrights — The A.A.W.S. Board received a Copyright and Reprint Report presenting an overview of policies, practices and information. Preparation of the report included compiling lists of copyright, and reprint requests and responses, as well as inventorying the status of copyrights on major A.A.W.S. works. This report will be valuable as the board reviews intellectual property questions and considers fair use of A.A.W.S. copyrighted material.

Reprint Requests — During the year 2011, A.A.W.S. granted permission/did not object to 110 requests to reprint from A.A. literature, and denied permission (including lack of authority to grant permission) to 41 requests.

On-Site Grapevine Sales — With the move of the Grapevine from the 10th Floor in the building to smaller offices on the 12th Floor, G.S.O. has begun handling their on-site shipping, mailroom and sales functions.

Working in coordination with Area registrars, the Fellowship New Vision (FNV) Manual has been completed and distributed to all users.

Pam Reising, chair, A.A.W.S.



■ Literature Distributed — 2011

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	428,386
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	328,814
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	42,580
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	148,024
Daily Reflections	139,574
Daily Reflections (large print)	12,675
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	149,588
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	7,325
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	170,635
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	21,392
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	48,108
A.A. Comes of Age	7,301
As Bill Sees It	27,145
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	20,839
As Bill Sees It (large print)	6,419
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	8,114
"Pass It On"	6,904
Experience, Strength & Hope	11,485
Total	1,585,308

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	22,216
Living Sober	127,255
Living Sober (large print)	8,069
Came to Believe	43,665
Came to Believe (large print)	2,865
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	14,571
Total	218,641

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	11,057
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	22,636
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	31,305
A.A. for the Native North American	13,912
A.A. for the Woman	88,560
The A.A. Group	78,226
A.A. in Your Community	39,201
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	19,184
A.A. in Treatment Settings	17,536
The A.A. Membership Survey	23,713
The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs	93,635
A.A. Tradition—How It Developed	25,022
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	10,722
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	113,966
Circles of Love and Service	39,317
Bridging the Gap	24,307
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	14,710
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	10,638
Do You Think You're Different?	99,893
Frequently Asked Questions	201,839
Frequently Asked Questions (large print)	6,054
G.S.R.	38,641
Grapevine—Our Meeting in Print	19,556
How A.A. Members Cooperate	16,496
How It Works	59,066
If You Are a Professional	32,653
Inside A.A.	35,720
A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic	19,000
Is A.A. for You?	337,224
Is A.A. for Me?	89,073

Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	14,003
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	63,727
It Happened to Alice	31,469
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	37,020
The Jack Alexander Article	22,262
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	10,289
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	45,052
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	26,445
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	9,991
A Newcomer Asks	297,478
Problems Other Than Alcohol	105,592
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	268,204
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	15,923
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	31,451
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	54,487
Twelve Tradition Flyer	7,036
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	46,551
This Is A.A.	244,898
This Is A.A. (large print)	6,025
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	15,504
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (large print)	46,881
Too Young?	59,662
Understanding Anonymity	61,451
What Happened to Joe	33,366
Young People and A.A.	87,312
A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs	21,672
Total	3,296,613

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	258,660
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	49,432
Wallet cards-Anonymity	34,078
Anonymity Display Card	1,962
Parchment-scrolls	1,707
Placards	431
C.P.C. Workbook	1,180
Archives Workbook	608
Corrections Workbook	949
P.I. Workbook	1,514
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,388
Treatment Facility Kit	414
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk 12	
A.A. Guidelines	80,936
Group Handbook	2,246
Wire Racks	1,456
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	10
Audio CDs	628
DVD's	4,771
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	121
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)	17
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cd album)	2,186
A.A. Comes of Age (cd album)	290
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	39
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cd album)	1,125
TV Public Service Announcement	290
Radio Public Service Announcements	193
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,487
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,410
Fact File	1,982
Table Top Display 12 & 12	499
Pioneers of A.A. (cassette album)	4
Pioneers of A.A. (cd album)	64
Living Sober (cassette album)	7
Living Sober (cd album)	241
Total	452,337
Grand Total	5,552,899

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	12,217
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	8,628
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	5,348
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous large print)	3,739
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	4,040
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,220
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,521
Transmítelo (Pass it On)	3,051
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	7,447
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	11,272
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./ Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	3,834
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	15,399
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,128
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	5,292
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	4,654
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)	4,206
De las tinieblas hacia la luz	3,268
Total	103,264

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	9,187
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	29,487
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	19,669
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	50,874
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	6,270
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	2,772
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,126
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	1,291
Seamos amistosos con nuestros amigos (Let's be Friendly with our Friends)	1,064
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,313
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	8,621
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	2,861
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	4,485
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	2,229
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	7,696
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	7,511
El Miembro de A.A.—Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs)	2,402
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	4,836
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	699
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	11,636
La Tradición de A.A.—¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition—How It Developed)	1,726
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	12,779
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales	

(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	1,173
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	4,398
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	3,297
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,494
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,070
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,113
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,503
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,104
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	4,715
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	4,038
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	1,200
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	7,637
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	2,013
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,067
Es A.A. Para Mí? (Is A.A. for Me?)	10,616
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	4,751
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	5,629
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	2,436
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,280
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,539
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,694
El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A. Legacy of Service)	546
Si Usted es un Profesional (If you are a Professional...)	3,521
El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A. (Grapevine... Our Meeting in Print)	1,406
¿Demasiado Joven? (Too Young?)	1,338
Alcohólico Necesidades Especiales A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs	554
Total	268,666

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	8,958
Parchments, Spanish	326
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	8,998
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	26
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cd album) (Big Book on cd)	818
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	9
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (cd album)	949
Total	20,084
Grand Total	392,014

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format relie)	3,807
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format souple)	1,337

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format poche)	641	Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	371
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format relie)	1,604	Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	361
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format souple)	588	Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	838
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format poche)	230	Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	495
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	466	Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,766
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	1,948	Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,390
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,696	Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	2,128
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	450	Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	1,145
(Expérience, Strength and Hope)		Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,252
(Experience, Strength and Hope)	393	Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,343
Transmets-Le (Pass It On)	726	Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	709
Total	15,886	Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,351
Plaquettes (Booklets)		La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,154
Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,662	L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	550
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,779	Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	981
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,378	Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,257
Total	5,819	Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,435
Brochures (Pamphlets)		Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,497
Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	8,909	Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	2,228
Foire aux Questions sur les A.A. (44 Questions)	2,865	A.A. pour l'alcoolique plus age (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	1,106
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	7,901	Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	3,487
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	2,287	Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,190
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	639	Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	424
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,295	Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,668
Le membre des AA face à la medication et autres drogues (The A.A. Member—Medications & Other Drugs)	2,728	Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	828
Les A.A.—Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	1,396	Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	311
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	242	Pour L'alcoolique Besoins Speciaux (A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs)	879
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	3,365	Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	2,889
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,642	Total	82,201
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	47	Divers (Miscellaneous)	
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	485	12 & 12 (cassette album)	2
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	1,769	12 & 12 (cd album)	471
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	651	Les Alcooliques Anonymes (cd album)	585
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	702	Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,931
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,326	Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	951
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,246	Carte Je Suis Responsable (I am responsible wallet card)	601
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	508	Video Cassettes	0
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,328	DVDS	58
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	228	Notre Methode (How It Works)	13,129
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	2,011	Manuel de Groupe	19
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,598	Pochette de l'Information Publique	29
		Pochette des Centres de Detention	5
		Pochette de la CMP	14
		Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	11
		Pochette des Centres de Traitement	5
		Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	178
		Total	17,989
		Grand Total	121,895

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is one of two operating corporations of the General Service Board and the multimedia publisher of Grapevine magazine content, available on various platforms and in a variety of formats. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. also publishes Spanish language content in La Viña magazine and its related book, CD and audio formats.

By charter, the A.A. Grapevine Board consists of seven to ten directors. Since the last Conference, there have been seven: two general service trustees; a Class A trustee; two regional trustees; one nontrustee director; and the executive editor/publisher.

As a rule, the purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts.

The A.A. Grapevine board met 11 times since the last Conference — four times during quarterly board meetings; five times as a Planning Committee; and two special meetings. The Grapevine Board conducted an inventory in conjunction with its March 2012 Planning Meeting. In 2011-2012, two standing committees were active: the Nominating Committee, chaired by Michele Grinberg, facilitated all facets in the selection of candidates for board openings; the Finance & Budget Committee, chaired by Donald Cusson, oversaw the budget process. Three Grapevine directors also participated in the General Service Board Shared Resources ad hoc committee. The Editorial Advisory Board did not convene during 2011.

Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has produced 12 issues of Grapevine, 6 issues of La Viña, an annual wall calendar and pocket planner, and its first two e-books: *The Language of the Heart* (in English) and *Best of Bill* (in English and Spanish). During 2011, the La Viña magazine was expanded to 64 pages, in response to the 2011 Conference Advisory Action intended to bring La Viña to spiritual parity with the Grapevine magazine.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. distributed 92,688 Grapevine and La Viña books, CDs, and other items including the latest book titles: *Step by Step* and *Emotional Sobriety II*. This is down 5,814 units from budgeted levels and 41,223 below 2010, which included 32,336 units of Grapevine's Special Convention Issue.

Circulation — Grapevine's average monthly print circulation was 90,493 in fiscal year 2011. (This is greater by 2,258 than budget and 2,611 less than 2010.) Following the relaunch of www.aa-grapevine.org in May 2011, 2,687 Grapevine On-

line subscriptions were added. The average bimonthly circulation of La Viña was 8,982. (This is 465 greater than budget and 241 above 2010 levels.) Based on the Grapevine's 2010 subscriber survey, it is estimated that the magazines are passed on to approximately 2.5 readers per copy, thereby reaching an estimated 226,200 readers per Grapevine issue and 22,400 per La Viña issue.

Operations — In early 2011, A.A. Grapevine undertook major operational restructuring measures resulting in lowered expenses, a reduction in work force, and the substitution of conference calls for half of the board's off-site planning meetings. The Shared Resources Committee facilitated collaboration between A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on projects identified by Grapevine management including a combined mailroom and catalog and a move to a new office space that will effectively reduce Grapevine's occupancy costs by just over \$74,000 per year. As Grapevine has not increased its product shipping prices since 2002, the board approved a 25% product shipping charge increase to become effective September 1, 2012.

Financial — Complete audited financial details for 2011 are included in the Conference Manual and *Conference Final Report*. Here is an overview:

- Throughout the year the Grapevine Board focused on closing the deficit gap and successfully worked to avoid Reserve Fund draw-downs. Grapevine ended 2011 with net income of \$22,838 against a budgeted loss of \$101,976. La Viña finished the year with a loss of \$69,725 against a budgeted loss of \$114,693.

- Revenue on the magazine and subscription products reached \$2.3 million, an improvement of \$219,000 over 2010. Gross Profit on the magazine was ahead of budget by almost \$160,000. This is a reflection of the July 2009 price increase as it integrated into





the magazine subscription base and the inclusion of the new online subscription products.

- Gross Profit on books and related items was below budget by \$119,325. This corresponds with industry trends and Grapevine is adapting along with other magazine and book publishers as content consumption habits change. CD sales were down as well, as CDs are being replaced with newer technologies such as MP3 downloads. Although Grapevine budgeted down 10% from 2010 levels for books and related items, the decline proved to be more accelerated.
- Overhead Costs were budgeted at \$1,958,096 and came in at \$1,859,347. This was a savings of \$98,749. This savings occurred mainly in two categories — Web Expenses and Selling Expense. Web Expenses were below budget as many of the costs of the relaunch were amortized

rather than directly expensed. Selling Expenses were below budget by \$53,172. There were other savings that were offset by legal expenses that exceeded budget by \$23,648.

La Viña — *La Viña* is published by A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and funded by the General Fund of the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship. *La Viña* had an average circulation of 8,982 per issue. Gross Profit on the magazine was \$52,340. This is ahead of budget by \$27,877. Revenue was ahead of budget by \$13,824. Gross Profit on Related Items was below budget by about \$2,000. Overhead was below budget by \$19,118. This was primarily due to Selling Expenses, which remained unspent by \$16,000. The Net Loss for 2011 was \$69,725 or \$44,968 ahead of the budgeted loss of \$114,693.

A.A. Grapevine and the Reserve Fund — A.A. Grapevine maintains a balance in the Reserve Fund to fund its unfulfilled subscription liability. Grapevine increased its balance in the Reserve Fund by \$50,000 to \$1,828,500 in December of 2011 because the subscription liability increased to \$1,945,452. The liability was funded at 94% as of December 31, 2011. Grapevine's target funding level is 95%. Grapevine will need to deposit another \$20,000 to reach 95%. No drawdown from the Reserve Fund occurred during FY2011.

Web Site — Relaunched in May 2011, to better serve the Fellowship and to engage a wider, varied and younger audience, the redesigned Web site is an essential part of Grapevine's current and future plans. March 2012 reports indicate that an average of 23,000 unique visitors spend an average of 4:46 minutes on aagrapevine.org each month. In May of 2012, Grapevine will introduce its new complimentary Grapevine Quote, featuring excerpts drawn from the deep well of classic Grapevine literature. Selections will be posted daily on aagrapevine.org and may be requested on an opt-in basis for e-mail delivery.

It is clear that many Grapevine subscribers are committed to the print magazine, and in keeping with the Fellowship's

desire and support, the print publication will continue. At the same time, Grapevine's online products have attracted new subscribers with very few conversions from print. In fact about 1/3 of our online subscribers are opting for both the online services and the print magazine. Offered as a bundle, the Grapevine Online subscription provides access to previously unpublished stories, Audio Grapevine, the Story Archive and the current issues of Grapevine/*La Viña* online.

At current prices, GV's basic online subscription costs subscribers about ten cents a day and the print subscription is eight cents per day. Diligent work is going into attracting an expanded subscriber base, yet it is possible that a price increase of a dollar a year in 2013 might be required to achieve self-support.

Your A.A. Grapevine board and management are committed to self-support and are determined that A.A. Grapevine, Inc. will continue to be lean, evolve and grow. The focus on financial health demonstrated throughout 2011 will continue in 2012. It is understood that cost reduction represents only one side of the break-even equation, while new revenue sources fulfill the other pivotal requirement of the break-even equation. Your support is essential.

In addition to the Daily GV Quote, what the Grapevine Board and management are evaluating/considering for the balance of 2012 and through 2014 include:

- Communicating directly to groups through use of group contact information provided through Fellowship New Vision (FNV).
- Continuing to release e-book versions of current titles on a staggered basis.
- Converting and offering existing GV CD content in MP3 formats.
- Creating a Magazine App in Single Copy and/or Subscription form.
- Reimagining the GV Calendars in a variety of formats.
- Offering print versions of GV Anthologies (books) through commissionable distribution channels.
- Presenting Audio content through the subscription service.

As a mirror of the membership, Grapevine both reflects and belongs to the Fellowship. For 68 years, Grapevine has conveyed the "Voice of A.A." as a tool for many in recovery, evolving over time and reliably carrying the message to anyone who reaches out for the hand of A.A. If the Fellowship wishes Grapevine and *La Viña* to be here now and in the future — for alcoholics and our friends, many of whom may not know about A.A. yet — additional subscribers and the service structure must participate in supporting A.A. Grapevine, Inc. as an integral element of our program.

Grapevine's future is in the hands of the Fellowship.

Don Miller, chairperson



■ AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2011

Books

Best of Bill (Hard Cover)	2,018
Best of Bill (Soft Cover)	5,643
Best of Bill—Large Print (Soft Cover)	862
Best of Bill—French (Soft Cover)	2,197
The Home Group—French (Soft Cover)	362
Le Langage Du Coeur	592
Best of the Grapevine I (Soft Cover)	733
Best of the Grapevine II (Soft Cover)	474
The Language of the Heart (Hard Cover)	3,835
El Lenguaje del Corazon	2,146
Best of the Grapevine III (Soft Cover)	437
A.A. Around the World	491
The Language of the Heart (Soft Cover)	2,802
Thank You For Sharing	680
Spiritual Awakening	2,819
The Home Group-Revised (Soft Cover)	1,686
I Am Responsible: The Hand of AA (Soft Cover)	886
Emotional Sobriety (Soft Cover)	7,547
The Language of the Heart (Large Print)	395
In Our Own Words	1,386
Beginners Book	4,717
Voices of Long-Term Sobriety	1,843
A Rabbit Walks Into a Bar	2,936
Spiritual Awakening II	2,938
Step By Step	3,333
Emotional Sobriety II(Soft Cover)	3,724
Best of Bill—Spanish	2,719
Lo Mejor de la Viña	1,159
El Grupo Base	1,316
Total:	62,676

Cassette Tapes

Total: 63

CDs - English

Sub-Total: 4,754

CDs - Spanish

Sub-Total: 3,280

Totals: 8,034

Miscellaneous

Facsimile of First Grapevine	361
Slogans—French	195
Victor E. Poster—French	—
AA Preamble	527
Grapevine Binder	226
Man on the Bed	1,170
Slogans	895
Serenity Prayer	1,503
Victor E. Poster—English	92
Wall Calendar	5,548
Pocket Planner	6,511
Grapevine Workbook	—
Co-Founder's Memorial Issue	975
French—Co-Founder's Memorial Issue	123
Traditions Checklist	463
Victor E. Poster—Spanish	34
Spanish—Preamble	218
Spanish—Slogans	255
Spanish—Serenity Prayer	502
Spanish—Tradition Checklist	932
Special Convention Edition Issue—English	1,123
Special Convention Edition Issue—Spanish	150
Special Convention Edition Issue—French	112

Total: 21,915

Grand Total: 92,688

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2012	APRIL 2011	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	642	715	(73)
Alaska	478	474	4
Arizona	1,544	1,577	(33)
Arkansas	445	469	(24)
California	7,741	8,220	(479)
Colorado	1,633	1,748	(115)
Connecticut	1,234	1,293	(59)
Delaware	349	386	(37)
District of Columbia	174	179	(5)
Florida	4,520	4,759	(239)
Georgia	1,912	2,054	(142)
Hawaii	393	439	(46)
Idaho	618	595	23
Illinois	2,683	2,911	(228)
Indiana	1,241	1,282	(41)
Iowa	837	896	(59)
Kansas	918	958	(40)
Kentucky	754	813	(59)
Louisiana	622	696	(74)
Maine	534	541	(7)
Maryland	1,143	1,203	(60)
Massachusetts	2,209	2,312	(103)
Michigan	2,648	2,733	(85)
Minnesota	2,075	2,202	(127)
Mississippi	361	384	(23)
Missouri	1,341	1,354	(13)
Montana	538	546	(8)
Nebraska	698	745	(47)
Nevada	787	812	(25)
New Hampshire	611	668	(57)
New Jersey	2,384	2,621	(237)
New Mexico	531	580	(49)
New York	4,621	4,905	(284)
North Carolina	1,845	1,955	(110)
North Dakota	324	316	8
Ohio	2,042	2,232	(190)
Okiahoma	658	699	(41)
Oregon	1,376	1,451	(75)
Pennsylvania	4,696	4,995	(299)
Rhode Island	304	326	(22)
South Carolina	805	888	(83)
South Dakota	308	339	(31)
Tennessee	901	975	(74)
Texas	3,239	3,470	(231)
Utah	475	508	(33)
Vermont	346	349	(3)
Virginia	1,909	2,063	(154)
Washington	2,494	2,691	(197)
West Virginia	345	410	(65)
Wisconsin	2,041	2,147	(106)
Wyoming	224	246	(22)
Puerto Rico	19	23	(4)
Virgin Islands	38	48	(10)
Subtotal US	73,661	78,275	(4,614)
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	856	857	(1)
British Columbia/YKN	1,041	1,011	30
Manitoba	328	343	(15)
New Brunswick/PEI	244	231	13
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	355	328	27
Ontario	3,011	3,029	(18)
Quebec	224	233	(9)
Saskatchewan	357	357	0
Subtotal Canada	6,416	6,389	27
FOREIGN	892	950	(58)
Grand Total	80,969	85,614	(4,645)

GRAPEVINE ONLINE SUBSCRIPTIONS

As of March 1, '12 --- **Diff.**
4,758 ---

LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*

Mar./Apr. '12 **Mar./Apr. '11** **Diff.**
6,567 6,165 402

(*does not include monthly orders)

■ Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Archives Committee is responsible for developing and implementing the policies that govern the Archives services and makes recommendations to the General Service Board on Archives procedures and budget. Through its group conscience, and guided by A.A.'s principles and professional standards, the committee undertakes and maintains responsibility and authority for the maintenance and use of the Archives. The committee continues to support the G.S.O. Archives' commitment to grant access to the archives for legitimate research purposes. The committee has had three meetings since the 2011 Conference, and granted permission to 17 researchers for use of archival materials. All requests are carefully considered through recommendations from the Archivist and established policies.

In response to a 2011 Conference Archives Committee Consideration, the committee requested that the Archivist solicit new material and stories from local A.A. archivists for the "Shared Experiences" section of the Archives Workbook. We received excellent sharing from a wide variety of locations and selected seven of these to replace the current stories. The committee approved a new service piece, "Archives Preservation Guidelines," and asked the Archives staff to begin distribution of the document. The Guidelines were created in response to a 2011 Conference Archives Committee Consideration. It is the first of a planned series of service pieces about maintaining an archival repository. It is hoped that this service piece presents helpful suggestions on basic archival procedures to local archivists responsible for maintaining archival collections. The new service piece has been posted on the "Archives and History" portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site under the section "Resources for Local A.A. Archivists."

The committee reviewed the Archives Photocopying Policy, and several observations were shared on topics including our mission of service to the Fellowship, professional archives practices, proprietary and copyright issues, and conformity with the Fair Use Policy. A new Photocopying Policy was adopted which balances the researcher's need for access, while still acting within the parameters of the Copyright Law, A.A.'s Tradition of anonymity, and the preservation of members' confidentiality. The committee also approved revisions to the history and archives film, *Markings on the Journey*, and is hopeful that the project can be completed in time for the 2015 International Convention. In January the committee forwarded a proposal, received from an area, to the 2012 Conference Archives Committee suggesting changes to the Conference Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure.

Throughout the year, the committee received progress reports on a range of projects executed by the Archives staff, as well as tabulated research inquiries handled by the staff. The Archivist also apprised the committee of projected goals and other tasks outlined for the upcoming year.

George Martin, chairperson

Staff report: The year 2011 marked the 36th anniversary of the G.S.O. Archives official opening. In observance of our anniversary, we created displays illustrating our work and conducted special tours throughout the Archives in an effort to raise awareness about the value of archives — and archivists. It was a great opportunity for everyone in the office to visit the Archives and to learn about the importance of preserving the Fellowship's documented memory and its impact on our lives.

One of our achievements in 2011 was the creation of a detailed inventory of the on-site Archives vault collections. The project aimed to provide a comprehensive list of our resources, at the container level and on-site, that includes shelving location and other

general data associated with each collection. The inventory aids us to: gain control of archival assets; efficiently mine the collection; and enhance search and retrieval.

The Archives serves the Fellowship by providing resource material and service to A.A. members, researchers and others about A.A. history, responds to worldwide information requests, and offers professional support to local A.A.s interested in researching their group or area's history. In 2011 we responded to over 1,600 requests for information. It is our responsibility to provide the facts, the correct dates and places, and, more importantly, to help further access to the collective wealth of information and wisdom of A.A., which has accumulated in the last 76 years of our history. With our dual roles as record-keepers and researchers we know that nothing can be more helpful than discovering shared information from the past that directly applies to the present. We welcomed over 75 new local archivists and committee chairs serving either in the area or district position and furnished each individual with an Archives Workbook and handy resources.

Another way that we endeavor to raise awareness of A.A.'s history and archives is the newsletter, *Markings — Your Archives Interchange*. This is an electronic newsletter published three or four times a year and delivered to subscribers via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system. The spring issue featured an in depth article that explored the history of Alcoholics Anonymous in prisons. The issue also included a memorial in observance of Bill W.'s 40th death anniversary on January 24. The summer issue focused on the General Service Office, highlighting key events that occurred at each office location. In the fall we featured a biography of Jim B., one of A.A.'s early members and author of the Big Book story, "A Viscious Cycle." Currently, more than 7,500 members subscribe to *Markings* and, beginning with the spring 2012 issue, the newsletter will also be available in Spanish and French.

We are continuing in our relentless efforts to digitize early Alcoholic Foundation/Works Publishing records beginning with 1938 through 1955. This project commenced in 2009 and is being undertaken by a part-time scanning assistant. We anticipate a completion date of December 2012. Another multi-year project involves the development of the Archives audio catalog. This is a multiple-phase project that involves listening to thousands of audio recordings arranged in series. In 2011 we completed the International Convention series that included the extent of the recordings for each Convention, beginning with the first one in 1950 through the most recent in 2010. We have now begun a new series that contains over 2,000 recordings — a feat undertaken with the assistance of a part-timer. What an incredible thrill it is to listen to the early recordings! Through sound recordings the past speaks to us directly; they are an irreplaceable part of the historical record. We also continued in our ceaseless work of preserving the history of the Fellowship. Our associate archivists worked with several collections to preserve, arrange and create Finding-Aids for the Robert Hitchins Papers, David Aronofsky Papers, I.C.Y.P.A.A. Collection, John Bragg Papers, Waneta New Papers and Al Marineau Papers.

The Archives Service Piece, *The A.A. Archives* (Copyright 2001), was translated to Spanish and French for the first time. A minimal redesign of the cover was also done. The translated work has been posted to the Archives section of the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.

The Archives' rotating exhibits are intended to stimulate interest and inform and enlighten visitors about our treasured past. Last year we highlighted the following: rare and unseen items from the Archives; nonalcoholic women who played an instrumental role in A.A.; a Founder's Day exhibit; History of the General Service Conferences; biographies of Ebby T. and Jim B.; and a look at A.A. through the decades.

Finally, the Archives staff extends gratitude to those who have

graciously donated material to the Archives within the past twelve months. We received many wonderfully rich collections that includes: **Audio Recordings:** Warden Duffy at the 1950 A.A. International Convention and oral histories. **Papers:** Jimmy Burwell and Bill W. correspondence. **Books:** *Alcoholics Anonymous (Second Edition)*; *Varieties of Religious Experience*; *The San Quentin Story* by Warden Duffy (1950); second and third printings of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; and first printing of Al-Anon's publication, *Many Voices, One Journey*. **Collections:** Articles, correspondence and images related to Captain Jack Sloggett. **CD:** A.A. History in the Cayman Islands, and How It Works in Navajo.

Michelle Mirza, archivist



AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee, formed by the General Service Board in 2003, is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The Audit Committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

Terry Bedient, chairperson

COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Compensation Committee, formed in 2006 by the General Service Board, consists of at least four trustees. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The Compensation Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

George Martin, chairperson

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 62nd General Service Conference, "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age." We also discussed summaries of the 2011 Evaluation Questionnaires and a Post-Conference Sharing Session that included suggestions for improving the flow of the Conference to allow sufficient time for committee reports and Con-

ference business. The committee reviewed and approved the schedule for the 62nd General Service Conference week, which reflected additional time for discussion of board reports, presentation topics, committee reports and sharing sessions.

The committee reviewed the three-year Conference Inventory Plan, approved by the 2011 General Service Conference, that will take place at the 2013, 2014 and 2015 General Service Conferences, and noted that, as outlined in the Inventory Plan, the 2012 Conference Agenda Committee will be determining the Inventory questions that will be discussed each year. The committee suggested that the 2012 Conference Agenda Committee consider reducing the number of presentation topics for the 2013 General Service Conference to allow scheduling for the Conference Inventory process.

Workshop questions for the 62nd General Service Conference were approved. The committee also discussed the Conference Dashboard, noting that this is on an experimental basis and will be re-evaluated in 2012.

The committee discussed an Additional Committee Consideration from the 2011 Conference Agenda Committee requesting that the trustees' Committee on Conference meet/confer with the Conference Committee on Agenda prior to the winter quarterly board meeting to address matters concerning the Conference week agenda and agreed to take no action. It was agreed that there was no clear explanation on the benefits of such a meeting or on what Conference week agenda matters would be addressed at an additional meeting prior to the joint trustees' and Conference committee meeting.

At the request of a trustee to review the General Service Conference committee assignment process, a subcommittee was formed to review the procedures for assigning delegates to Conference committees. The committee concurred with the subcommittee's final report that the procedures and practices used during the committee selection process fulfill the random selection and criteria requirements reflected in Advisory Actions.

The committee reviewed Form B: "Request to Use Laptops During the G.S.C." and the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference." The committee agreed to discontinue Form

B as it is outdated and agreed to forward to the 2012 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions a request to consider policy and guidelines regarding the use of personal electronic devices at the General Service Conference.

The topic of Floor Actions at Conferences was discussed and it was noted that the Floor Action procedure was revised in 2010 and that the number of Floor Actions decreased significantly at the 61st Conference in 2011. Also discussed was the distribution of publications that are "works in progress" for Conference approval, and the 2004 Conference Advisory Action was cited: "The current practice for viewing or examining all materials other than service material submitted for Conference approval be continued adhering to the principle of the 'right of decision' throughout the Conference process."

The A.A. General Service Board of India requested that two trusted servants from their service structure attend the 2012 General Service Conference as observers. The committee approved the request and forwarded it to the 2012 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

The committee reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2012. Forty-one items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference Committees, or to the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards. This total does not include any items that may have been submitted directly to committee secretaries or to the two corporate boards.

Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a productive and enriching Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us.

El Nault, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the summer edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Eva Sanchez

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Then, in August of 2009, the trustees' committee expanded its scope to include service to Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees and oversight of Special Needs literature. The title of the committee has been changed to Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. To that end, the committee agreed to add to their Scope the following phrase: "Maintaining an interest in the changing attitudes within the professional community regarding Alcoholics Anonymous, providing the tools through A.A.'s Publications and other strategies to reach the professional community/treatment facilities with an interest in fostering the kind of attitudes which allow A.A. to better reach the still-suffering alcoholic."

Among the many tasks completed this past year, the committee:

- In response to committee considerations of the 2011 Conference Committee on C.P.C. regarding the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook, worked with the Publications Department to add the following to the C.P.C. Workbook:
 1. A list of goals and project suggestions for C.P.C. committees.
 2. A summary of shared experience from C.P.C. committees and professionals.
 3. The service piece "Suggestions for Using the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña as a Tool in Cooperation With the Professional Community Service."
- Agreed that it would be helpful to include the A.A. Grapevine or La Viña magazines in C.P.C. Kits. The expenditure of \$750.00 was included in the 2012 budget.
- Forwarded a draft product and report on replacing the current "A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community" DVD with a new compilation DVD that includes existing material, as requested by the 2011 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- Forwarded a proposal to add the phrase "nonalcoholics may attend as observers" to the "Singleness of Purpose" statement in C.P.C. literature.

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities — In response to committee considerations from the 2011 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, the committee:

- Conducted a line-by-line review and forwarded to the 2012 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities a progress report on the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- Agreed to replace text of shared experience on carrying the message into psychiatric settings in the Treatment Committee Workbook at its next printing.
- Forwarded to the 2012 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities a suggestion to create a pamphlet for the alcoholic who suffers from mental illness.
- Thoroughly reviewed and discussed the section of the Treatment Committee Workbook "Carrying the Message into Noncorrectional Youth Facilities" and agreed to take no action. The committee agreed that safety and clearance issues were adequately addressed.
- Agreed to a review of both content and format of current A.A.W.S. material that is intended to make the A.A. message accessible to alcoholics with special needs.

Rod Betonney, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet relatively few know what A.A. is or what we do, and even fewer have been to an “open” A.A. meeting. The staff member on the Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) assignment, along with an assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2011, 388 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.’s A.A. Web site. Hundreds of other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. is the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* The Spring issue featured an in-depth article on Grapevine, the A.A. Fellowship’s magazine, and the Winter issue focused on how A.A. reaches out to diverse populations and highlighted sharing from General Service Board trustees on carrying the A.A. message to Native North Americans. Currently, more than 9,000 professionals receive *About A.A.* Approximately one-third of the list receives the newsletter via A.A.’s Digital Delivery system.

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 29 national or international conferences of professionals in 2011. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space, display and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. Thousands of professionals in a broad range of fields visited the A.A. booth at these national events. In the interest of extending the hand of A.A. to all who suffer, each year some Public Information events are also included, such as the National Association for Advancement of Colored People (N.A.A.C.P.) and American Association of Retired Persons (A.A.R.P.) In addition, 36 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees. G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities have created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators, and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O., and are encouraged to attend “open” A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Adrienne Brown

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities — In July 2009, the task of communicating with Special Needs-Accessibilities service committees within the A.A. Fellowship has been given a permanent home on the Treatment assignment. While each type of service committee addressed by the assignment may strive to carry the A.A. message of recovery from alcoholism to different populations of alcoholics, the overall purpose of the Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities assignment is to share A.A. and service committee experience and information through literature, activity updates and other communications with these distinct committees. The assignment currently communicates with: area and district Treatment committee chairpersons, area and district Bridging the Gap (B.T.G.) committee chairpersons, area and district Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons, and area and district Special Needs-Accessibilities committee chairpersons.

Communication with these trusted servants begins with a welcome letter from the assignment coordinator, along with some of the service materials that might be helpful as the committee chair starts out in the new position. While physical materials are still sent through the post, the new trusted servants are also directed to G.S.O.’s A.A. Web site (www.aa.org) where A.A. Guidelines, service committee Workbooks, and other service materials may be read and/or printed directly from the service committee “buckets.” In addition, all area level service committee chairs receive a list of other area level service committee chairs to facilitate sharing experiences and activities.

During their term of service, area and district chairs receive updates on other committees’ activities thorough articles in *Box 4-5-9*, and receive updates from the assignment coordinator that may contain ideas, activities, questions and solutions from other committees. These assignment updates also contain items of interest from G.S.O., requests for sharing on a particular question when appropriate, and efforts to address possible areas of confusion.

Correspondence from newly sober clients in treatment centers, and from professionals in those facilities, is always welcome. In addition, communication is received from alcoholics with special challenges (blindness, deafness, brain injury, etc.) asking for A.A. literature in a format that they can understand. Each of these receives a response from the staff member, with as many as possible linked as well to an A.A. member or committee in the Fellowship who can serve as an additional resource.

The staff member on this assignment serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

This staff member is also the regional correspondent to the Northeast Region, sharing A.A. experience with hundreds of A.A. members monthly via e-mails, phone calls and written correspondence.

Mary Dargan

CORRECTIONS

Trustees’ report: The trustees’ Committee on Corrections serves to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings.

“It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell” pamphlet — The committee met three times since the 2011 General Service Conference and continued work revising the pamphlet “It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell” in line with a 2009 Advisory Action and Additional Committee Considerations from 2010 and 2011. Since the committee had already selected new stories for the pamphlet, we focused on the

other editorial content, format, and illustrations. We reaffirmed the importance of an easy-to-read format — looking at different options presented by the Publications Department — and agreed on a design that could be folded to look like a standard-sized pamphlet while preserving a layout that allows for larger print and plenty of white space. The committee studied a writing analysis of the editorial content and noted that the pamphlet maintains an easy reading level throughout. Also, the pamphlet now has content that will appeal to both young incarcerated alcoholics and “lifers.” We previewed sample illustrations and made suggestions based on our collected experience working with correctional facilities. Finally, we discussed and approved the final draft revision and re-design of the pamphlet “It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell” as submitted by the Publications Department, and agreed to forward the draft to the 2012 Conference Committee on Corrections.

“A Message to Corrections Professionals” pamphlet — The committee reviewed four proposed changes to the pamphlet “A Message to Corrections Professionals.” In light of the number and scope of these changes, we agreed to forward the entire pamphlet to the 2012 Conference Committee on Corrections to review and consider revisions as follows:

- Adding information on the benefits of the A.A. program of recovery to alcoholics both during and after incarceration.
- Changing the statement on Singleness of Purpose to make it more consistent with the description of the difference between Open and Closed meetings in the pamphlet “The A.A. Group.”
- Incorporating “re-entry” terminology into the pamphlet by renaming the section now called “Release and paroles” to “Re-entry and parole.”
- Replacing the section “A.A. in correctional facilities,” which contains numbers and statistics based on an outdated questionnaire, with content communicating something more relevant — instead of conducting a new, and possibly costly, survey.

Corrections Workbook — Acting on a 2011 Additional Committee Consideration, the committee discussed the need to conduct a comprehensive survey of A.A. corrections activities similar to those conducted in past years, and decided instead to update the “Survey Summary” pages in the Corrections Workbook with local sharing that had been collected as a response to an Additional Committee Consideration in 2010. We also asked that the staff gather any new experience from the Fellowship on challenges to corrections service work and local solutions and to work with the Publications Department to combine the results with existing material and incorporate it into the Workbook. We replaced the “Survey Summary” pages in the Corrections Workbook with the new material to be included in the next printing.

The committee also reviewed the suggested changes to the Corrections Workbook forwarded by the 2011 Conference Committee on Corrections. All approved changes were incorporated into the most recent Workbook along with a list of suggested updates from staff and previous committee actions. In response to a 2011 Additional Committee Consideration that a process be established for updating the Workbook at each printing that would ensure accurate references, staff consulted with the Publications Department and confirmed that it is a historically accepted practice that it is the editorial responsibility of the Publications Department to update all numerical page number references, addresses, statistical information, and current terminology as determined by either the trustees’ or Conference Committees whenever there is a reprint of an existing publication or the introduction of a new publication.

“It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell” video — The committee discussed a proposal to update the 1987 video “It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell,” and agreed to forward it to the 2012 Conference Committee on Corrections, for consideration for a possible remake.

“A.A. in Correctional Facilities” pamphlet — In response to recommendations contained in an Advisory Action from the 2011 General Service Conference, the suggested text changes referring to Traditions and Big Book studies as additional types of A.A. meetings have been sent to the Publications Department to be incorporated in the Conference-approved pamphlet “A.A. in Correctional Facilities” at the next printing.

Following up on another 2011 Additional Committee Consideration, staff added a line to the welcome letters to new Corrections chairs about how and where to find new A.A. material that might not yet be listed in the current literature catalog.

Donald Cusson, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Around 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a prerelease contact. While not everyone who writes to G.S.O. has a problem with alcohol, all letters are answered; those indicating they have a drinking problem are provided with basic literature, information about Twelfth Step services specifically designed for the alcoholic who is incarcerated, and a warm invitation to participate in the Fellowship and program of recovery of A.A.

If an incarcerated alcoholic requests free literature, he or she may be sent a Big Book and a selection of pamphlets, and often the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, with an explanation that the enclosed literature is made possible through the voluntary contributions of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada. However, this assignment tries to avoid being viewed as the primary source of A.A. literature, since “carrying the A.A. message” in this way is an A.A. service opportunity. Requests for multiple copies for an inside group, or ongoing requests from the same facility, are usually referred to those local A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service. This practice is also in keeping with past recommendations of Conference and trustees’ Committees on Corrections.

The Corrections Correspondence Service, coordinated by this assignment, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many alcoholics who are incarcerated are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. To fill their requests, this assignment puts out regular pleas to the Fellowship through various channels for new correspondence volunteers — especially males. One of the challenges to this staff assignment is explaining why — when A.A. members continue to volunteer their time — we can never completely close the gap. The short answer is that every day more and more alcoholics in correctional facilities discover that the root of their problem is alcohol and decide to do something about it! Once they come across the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, they want to share their journey with someone, just like the rest of us. In 2011 we linked 819 male and 384 female alcoholics in prison to an outside A.A. correspondent through the C.C.S. In order to meet those requests, we needed to be able to match the inmates with 1,203 outside A.A. volunteers. Although many of those volunteers offered to write to more than one incarcerated alcoholic at a time, the number remains large. And that is the data for just one year.

One of the most gratifying aspects of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions (H&I), and Bridging the Gap committees. Two or three times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs with updated information about new tools or shared expe-



FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report:

G.S.O. — At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2011 and reported that G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$340,080, which after Conference actions resulting in mid-year budget adjustments, was reduced by \$40,000 to \$300,080. For the year 2011, however, G.S.O. turned in positive results from operations of \$817,947. Both revenue and expenses were considerably less than budgeted.

Net sales for 2011 were approximately \$12,506,000, approximately \$9,000 (.07%) less than budgeted. Manufacturing and royalty expense were slightly less than budgeted, however shipping and warehousing expenses were slightly greater than budgeted. The result was gross profit of \$7,961,325, or \$13,525 (.17%) greater than budgeted. On the downside, Contributions received ended the year approximately \$235,500 (3.6%) less than budgeted. We were able to curtail some expenses and defer others so expenses were \$740,000 (5.2%) less than budgeted.

A.A. Grapevine — The Grapevine budget anticipated a net loss of \$101,976 for 2011. The actual result for the Grapevine was a net profit of \$22,840. For

the year, Gross profit from sales items was approximately \$40,000 better than budgeted and expenses were \$99,000 less than budgeted. Included in the revenue for 2010 was the result of the Grapevine Convention item that netted approximately \$71,000, which did not repeat in 2011. La Viña anticipated a \$114,700 loss, but achieved only a \$69,723 loss.

Reserve Fund — At December 31, 2011, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 11.3 months of operating expenses. After taking into account transfers to the Reserve Fund, authorized by A.A.W.S. in March of 2012, the Reserve Fund will represent approximately 11.9 months of 2011 combined operating expenses but 11.3 months of 2012 budgeted expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions from members. Contributions of \$6,189,866 received from *groups and members* were approximately \$180,000, or 2.8 less than budgeted, and \$89,000 (1.4%) less than in 2010. The \$6,189,866 in contributions came from 27,066 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents approximately 42.4% of the 63,845 groups listed with G.S.O., just slightly less than the 43.9% reported last year. Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,264,454 received by G.S.O., reflected in our 2011 financial statements, include approximately \$74,588 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2010, \$129,518; 2009, \$133,715; 2008, \$137,600; 2007, \$144,400; 2006, \$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000.

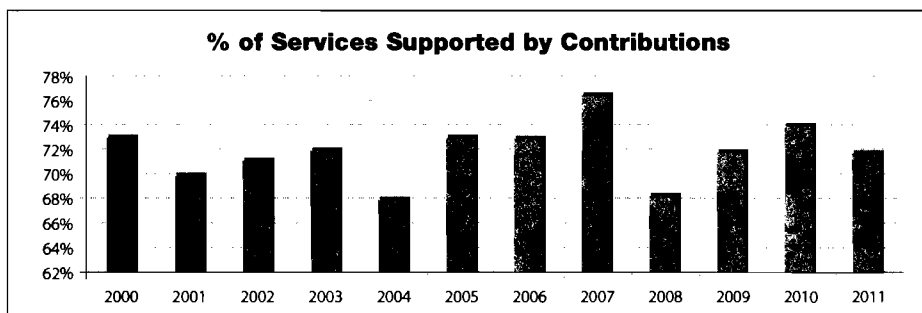
This year the number of groups listed at G.S.O., as shown on the Contributions Statistics report included in the Conference material, was 63,845, some 972 greater than the 62,873 reported last year. It is important to remember, however, that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us. While total contri-

rience on how to use those tools. This past year included a call for sharing on local challenges faced by committees and the solutions they developed to be included in an updated section on corrections service experience in the Corrections Workbook, as well as news about a trend toward communicating with committee chairs via e-mail, discount A.A. literature available, ideas for stimulating interest in the Corrections Correspondence Service, and an explanation of how and why G.S.O. protects the privacy of inmate letters, along with stories reminding committee chairs of how desperately these incarcerated alcoholics want and appreciate the help of outside A.A. members.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site has a special section where most Corrections service material can be found, including current and past issues of the newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls (SFBTW)*. This quarterly publication contains excerpts of sharing from A.A. members in prison who have written to G.S.O. This desk prepares selections from these A.A. members' letters and sends them a copy of the excerpt along with a request to reprint it in a future issue of *SFBTW*. The permission letter also mentions the possibility that the newsletter might be posted on G.S.O.'s Web site. Posting this anonymity-protected newsletter on the Web site and inviting members who take meetings into correctional facilities to print out copies is another way of ensuring that the sharing from this population of alcoholics gets into the hands of those who need it most.

A.A. members involved in corrections service frequently ask how they can get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. Often, people in the Fellowship unfamiliar with this type of Twelfth Step activity express the fear that the alcoholic in prison will not identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and are reluctant to commit to the amount of time institutions sometimes require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into their correctional facilities. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

M. Tracey Ober



bution dollars were lower, the total number of contributions increased. The Contributions department noted 80,683 received during 2011, approximately 3,500 more than the 77,185 received during 2010. Beginning in June 2010 we implemented the Contributions online function. For the period June through December we received approximately 1,056 contributions via the online method, representing approximately \$82,500. During 2011 we received approximately 1,748 online contributions for a total of \$156,553.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$12,506,136, which was only \$8,864 (.07%) less than budgeted, and approximately \$322,225 greater than 2010. During 2011, approximately 945,500 Big Books were sold compared with 885,075 in 2010; 1,220,000 in 2009; and 1,110,000 in 2008. We must remember, however, that a significant number of books were purchased prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase. Printing and manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were in the aggregate just about on budget. The Gross profit of \$7,961,325 was very close to budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$14,226,434, approximately \$222,366 less than budgeted.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2011 were \$13,408,487, approximately \$740,233 less than budget but \$390,000 greater than 2010. For the year 2011 all of the expense categories were under budget. Three significant components of this decrease were in Salaries, Other Literature Assistance and Contracted Services. Salaries were under budget due in part to unfilled positions and in part to employees out on disability, and holding the line on hiring. Other literature assistance was under budget by approximately \$60,000 due to a combination of fewer requests for assistance from emerging Fellowship Structures around the world, as well as a reduction in the cost of some of the translation expenses, due to some of the literature being produced in foreign countries instead of in the New York area. In the Contracted Services category, we were under budget because projects were not undertaken. When compared with budget, the lower revenues combined with lower expenses resulted in a 2011 positive operating bottom line of \$817,947, approximately \$517,867 less than 2010.

Expanding a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2011, \$8,747,139 was spent to provide Services to the Fellowship, \$105,000 greater than was spent in 2010. This compares with \$8,642,112 in 2010; \$8,783,762 in 2009, \$9,447,300 in 2008.

The 2011 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 33.1% (which includes various group contact-type costs in addition to Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 15.3%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 8.7%; trustees' and directors' activities, 5.8%; Regional Forums, 6.6%; Archives, 9.0%; C.P.C., 5.5%; Public Information, 5.1%; Correctional Facilities, 4.0%; Treatment Facilities, 2.4%; Special Needs, 2.0%; Nominating, 1.9%; and other various 0.6%.

Contributions provided 71.6% of the support and 28.4% came from the profit from literature sales. This compares with 74.2% and 25.8% in 2010; 71.7% and 28.3% in 2009 and 68.1% and 31.9% in 2008.

2012 G.S.O. Budget — Sales for 2012 have been budgeted approximately even when compared with 2011, with a slight increase for e-book sales. Even though Contribution revenue was down slightly in 2011, we anticipate a slight increase in 2012 based on an improving economy and increased efforts

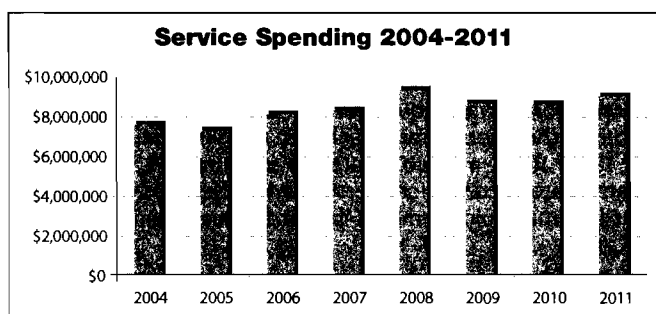
by both the A.A.W.S. and the trustees self-support communication efforts.

Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. We are trying to make more use of electronic communications wherever possible to reduce costs of postage and supplies. One should remember that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower overall gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages and make price increases necessary from time to time.

Recent pricing history — In 2005, after reviewing financial matters, trusted servants recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed, by one year, the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. Previously, the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prices of books and booklets were increased effective July 1, 2009, anywhere from \$.25 to \$2.00.

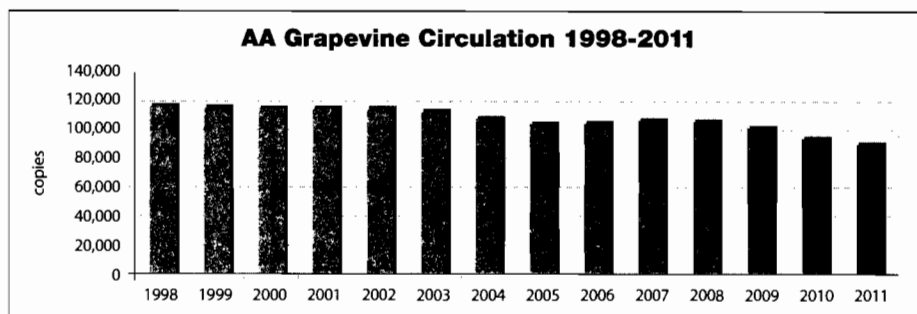
The 2012 budget anticipates approximately a 6.6% increase in costs when compared with 2011 actual results, but only a 1% increase from the 2011 budget. Recall earlier discussion of above under budget conditions in several of the line items during 2011 that were below budget in 2011. Based on these preliminary assumptions — approximately a 1.8% increase in sales, a 4% increase in Contributions, and an increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 2012 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$147,893, a very thin bottom line considerably less than the \$817,947 achieved for 2011. During the budget process, the A.A.W.S. Board, as well as the trustees' Finance Committee, remains cognizant of the need to replenish funds that have been withdrawn from the Reserve Fund. Management continues to assess expenses and operations with an eye towards reduce costs.

The Reserve Fund (and Historical Reference for price adjustments) — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on lit-



erature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments. As noted in previous reports, G.S.O. management was charged with presenting a 2009 budget with sufficient revenue that, with all things being equal, would maintain the Reserve Fund at a nine-month level of operating expenses after three years. The adjusted balance used for the calculation at December 31, \$14,496,921 (before March transfer) amounts to about \$227 per listed A.A. group. The balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has increased approximately \$2,600,000 from last year. Dividing total Contributions received (\$6,264,454) by the 63,845 groups listed gives us an average of about \$98 (down from \$102 last year), while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$137 (the same as last year).

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, gross magazine income for 2011 of \$2,316,763 was approximately \$219,300 more than the prior year. Included in total magazine income are the following items: the print magazine, single copies, back issues, Digital Magazine Subscriptions, GV Online, Digital Archives Project Subscrip-



direct costs of \$17,877, and a gross profit of \$1,477,093 is anticipated. Gross profit from magazine is anticipated to be approximately \$4,600 greater than 2011. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to decrease approximately \$10,600 to \$374,894, while interest income is estimated slightly higher than 2011.

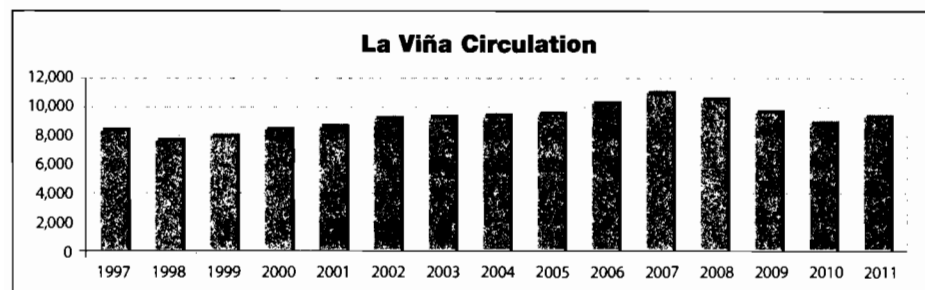
A profit for 2012 of \$34,284 is anticipated, compared with the \$22,840 profit for 2011.

La Viña — *La Viña* is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2011 average circulation of 8,982. This compared with a 2010 average of 8,741; 2009 average of 9,663; 2008 of 10,404.

The hope had been that *La Viña* would increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we would see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has yet to turn a profit. During 2011, subscription income was \$106,563 and direct costs of publishing were \$54,223, resulting in a \$52,340 gross profit. During 2011, *La Viña* realized approximately \$18,386, came from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$140,451. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to *La Viña*. Therefore, the overall loss on *La Viña* for the year was \$69,725, compared with a loss of \$75,481 for 2010; a loss of \$54,472 for 2009, \$76,260 for 2008 and \$67,047 for 2007.

For 2012, the loss on the *La Viña* magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$105,669, (approximately \$35,946 greater than 2011), with circulation anticipated to be level. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the magazine, approximately \$1,410,203 has been invested in *La Viña* in excess of revenues generated. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that *La Viña* continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

Other items — The subcommittee constituted last year to oversee the cash flow of the Grapevine, monitor cash balances, and oversee remedial activities that will bring an end to the negative

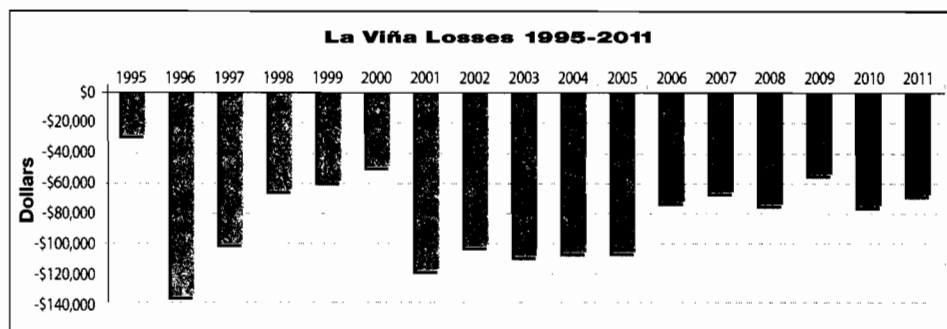


tions, and the Audio Grapevine. Average paid circulation of 90,493 was approximately 2,611 less than 2010. The average paid circulation of 90,493 compares with 93,104 for 2010, 102,281 for 2009, and 104,993 for 2008.

Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,472,411 was \$226,879 greater than 2010, and \$159,890 greater than budgeted. Other publishing income was \$131,557 less than budgeted and \$194,200 less than 2010, which included revenue from a Convention item. Gross profit on magazine related items was approximately \$119,000 less than budgeted, and \$150,000 less than 2010 as well. Total income, including interest earned, was \$1,882,186, 62,500 less than 2010, but \$26,000 greater than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,859,346. Costs and expenses were \$359,319 less than 2010, and \$98,700 less than budget. Excluding *La Viña*, the Grapevine reported a profit from operations of \$22,838, which was approximately \$421,875 greater than the 2010 loss of \$399,037, and \$124,814 greater than the budgeted loss of \$101,976.

The Grapevine's 2012 budget, excluding *La Viña*, anticipates magazine income of \$2,303,568 (approximately \$13,200 less than the \$2,316,763 realized in 2011), a decrease in magazine



Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2012¹

	Groups	Members
United States	58,820	1,290,716
Canada	<u>5,025</u>	<u>93,983</u>
Sub-Total	63,845	1,384,699
Correctional facilities ²	1,555	38,664
Internationalists	3	0
Lone Members	<u>0</u>	<u>105</u>
Total	65,403	1,423,468
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>48,667</u>	<u>710,374</u>
Grand Total	114,070	2,133,842

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 170 countries, including 62 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use the previous year's figures

cash balance and consequent Reserve Fund drawdowns, met via conference call several times during the year and continues to receive monthly updates. Last year the trustees' Finance Committee recommended, and the General Service Board concurred, that a thorough re-evaluation of the Boards' commitment to continued production/support of La Viña be undertaken.

As noted in prior reports, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2006 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

During 2011 a subcommittee was formed to consider alternative forms of pension benefits. A preliminary report is anticipated within the next several months.

Pension review — A subcommittee of the General Service Board was formed in late 2011. Their objective is to coordinate the review and selection of pension plan options for transitioning from a Defined Benefit Plan to a Defined Contribution Plan for new A.A.W.S. and G.V. employees. Plan implementation is targeted for January 2013.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side and consideration of long-term obligations, help to insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. While the economic outlook for 2012 may be uncertain as the economy unfolds, we will continue to monitor events with our goal to insure the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

Terrance Bedient, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 61st General Service Conference, the board has held three General Sharing Sessions. In August 2011 the topic was "Carrying the Message to the Native Americans/First Nations People." Class A trustee Corliss Burke shared on "Carrying the Message to First Nations People," and Pacific Regional trustee Rod Betonney shared on "Carrying the Message to Native Americans." In October 2011 the topic was "How is the drug court system of mandated A.A. attendance working from the perspective of A.A., both in terms of the help being given to those attending and to the ability of A.A. groups to work with newcomers generally?"

The first presentation was given by trustee-at-large/U.S. Don Massey, who shared on the question, "How is the drug court system of mandated A.A. attendance working from the perspective of A.A., both in terms of the help being given to those attending and to the ability of A.A. groups to work with newcomers generally? Are there Tradition issues inherent in mandated attendance?"

The second presenter, Judge Rogelio Flores, Class A trustee, was unable to attend the board weekend due to a family emergency. He forwarded his report and it was read by Sharing Session chair George Martin. Rogelio had been asked to share on the topic: "How well is the drug court system of mandated A.A. attendance working from the perspective of the courts? Is there anything that the A.A. general service system should or could be doing to increase the effectiveness of the program?"

"Concept IX — The General Service Board and Leadership in A.A. — Setting the Example" was the topic of the January 2012 Sharing Session. First to present on Concept IX was Class A trustee John A. Fromson, whose topic was "Into Action." Next, Vic Phillips, Western Canada regional trustee, presented on "A Vision for Us."

Complete copies of these presentations are available and may be requested by the Staff coordinator at G.S.O.

George Martin, chairperson

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office report: Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has produced 12 issues of Grapevine; six issues of La Viña; two new books (*Emotional Sobriety II* and *Step by Step*); its first two e-books — *The Language of the Heart* (in English) and *Best of Bill* (in English and Spanish); a wall calendar and a pocket planner. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has also rolled out "Grapevine Online," a digital subscription product. This bundled digital product offers access to the Story (Digital) Archive, Audio Grapevine (expanded this year to include all stories recorded from mid-2006 to the present), the monthly Grapevine magazine (in HTML format) and five new, never before published stories each week. It is clear that Grapevine subscribers are very committed to the print magazine; consequently there are no plans in place to eliminate the paper magazine.

The Grapevine Online product has attracted new subscribers, with only a few converting from print. Given this ex-



pressed interest Grapevine is focusing on expanding its offering in this area.

In early 2011, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. undertook major cost-saving measures, which resulted in a staff reduction to our present ten full-time and two part-time employees and two freelance art directors. A portion of Grapevine and La Viña's work is accomplished with the assistance of freelancers on a project basis and has proven to be an efficient method for Grapevine to provide high quality products at the lowest cost possible.

In February of 2012, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. reduced its office footprint by moving to a new space that is in line with current needs. This will reduce A.A. Grapevine's occupancy costs by about 65%.

During 2011, the La Viña magazine expanded its pages to 64, due to a Conference action to bring La Viña up to spiritual parity with the Grapevine magazine.

The Grapevine Web site, aagrapevine.org, relaunched in May of 2011. It is currently being visited by over 23,000 unique visitors a month. The redesigned Web site is an essential part of Grapevine's current and future plans. Together with the magazines and other print products, aagrapevine.org helps to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and thereby fulfill Grapevine's mission.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is committed to being self-supporting and much of the corporation's activity in 2011 focused on that goal. Cost reduction represents only one part of the equation. The new GV Online subscription product and the introduction of e-books will attract new revenue, which will fulfill the other essential requirement of the break-even equation.

Eugene O'Brien, controller

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material based on an indicated need, and provides information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; A.A. Guidelines and Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A. Current ongoing projects involving Group Services:

- The Group Services coordinator collaborates with the Special Projects manager regarding the three A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.) and central/intergroup office records and lists.
- Supervises the updating of G.S.O.'s service material that is available, upon request and in Spanish and French, whenever possible.
- G.S.O.'s liaison to over 500 intergroup/central offices in the U.S. and Canada. Has a primary role in coordinating A.A.W.S.'s participation at the annual intergroup/central office seminar and serves on the seminar's Policy and Site Committee. The 27th Intergroup/Central Office Seminar will next take place in Washington, D.C. in September 2012.
- Coordinates with the Digital Media manager to continually update and improve G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- Serves as a resource to the managing editor regarding the updating of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, as secretary to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee, and as regional correspondent to the southwest region of the United States.

Jim Malone

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 22nd World Service Meeting (WSM) will be held October 21-25, 2012 in Rye Brook, New York, with the theme "Rotation: The Heartbeat of A.A." We are anticipating close to 60 delegates representing an estimated 36 countries or linguistic zones. Representing our General Service Board will be first-term delegate Barbara Kelly, trustee-at-large/Canada and second-term delegate Don Massey, trustee-at-large/United States. G.S.O. general manager Phyllis Halliday will be presiding at the event and staff member Mary Clare Lynch will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Mary Cumings, Jim Malone, and Rick Walker. John Kirwin will be the logistical coordinator in charge of the workroom and liaison to hotel staff.

Literature Assistance — The 2012 Literature Assistance budget of \$50,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service board. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 2011, 64 reviews of proposed translations were completed.

Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at four zonal service meetings in 2011, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not convene. In June 2011, Phyllis Halliday and Warren Stafford attended, as observers, the 5th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM), which was held in Johannesburg, South Africa. In July, Doug Richardson attended, as an observer, the 9th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in Chandigarh, India. In October, Phyllis Halliday and Mary Clare Lynch attended, as observers, the 16th European Service Meeting (ESM) in Frankfurt, Germany. Also, in October, Don Massey, trustee-at-large/U.S., and Barbara Kelley, trustee-at-large/Canada, attended, as delegates, the 17th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in San Salvador, El Salvador.

International Trips — The trustees' International Committee refined their decision-making process and record-keeping in order to introduce new items, especially the aspect of measuring outcomes, which will allow for greater transparency and accountability. Perhaps as a reflection on these economic times, the General Service Board and General Service Office received fewer invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, and regional assemblies. In addition to the zonal events listed above, in 2011 trustees and staff members visited Germany, Great Britain, Mexico and Switzerland. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, which carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Don Massey, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 60 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers. The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States and Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and outside professional services. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our trust in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits from the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Working closely with our Records Department to ensure that our International A.A. Directory (for countries outside of the United States and Canada), which is published annually, contains updated contact information for G.S.O.s, central offices and intergroups, groups, foreign contacts and Loners around the world.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 63 languages, and additional translations are in progress.

Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Mary Clare Lynch

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — Much of the exciting activity for the 2015 International Convention lies in the next few years. This year, the committee reviewed a list of suggested 2015 International Convention themes and recommended to the General Service Board that the theme of the 2015 International Convention be "80 Years — Happy, Joyous and Free." The committee also reviewed the updated Site-selection Procedures for the 2025 Inter-

national Convention in anticipation of the start of that process this summer.

Regional Forums — Since the 2011 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Northeast, West Central, Southwest and East Central regions. One "Additional" Regional Forum was held in the Pacific region. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the General Service Board, General Service Office and A.A. Grapevine. Many in attendance were experiencing their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to exchange information between local trusted servants, A.A.s interested in service, trustees, and directors and staff of G.S.O. and Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service.

Following each Regional Forum the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums reviewed a summary of the Forum evaluation questionnaires. During the past year the committee discussed the effectiveness of the current Evaluation Questionnaire and considered a simplified version. The revised Questionnaire will be used at future Regional and Additional Forums.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that a request for a Local Forum, to be hosted by the Spanish districts in Area 06 Northern Coastal California, in June or July of 2012 be approved. Since the 2011 Conference a Local Forum was hosted by Area 40 in Great Falls and Miles City, Montana, in June 2011. A second Local Forum was held in Kennewick, Washington state in September 2011, hosted by Washington East Area 92. The committee conducted its fourth annual review of the content and implementation of Local Forums and Additional Regional Forums and made no changes. The committee noted that to date three Additional and five Local Forums have taken place. Reports from Local Forums indicate that Local Forums have provided A.A. committees a sense of ownership of the events, have engaged and energized the A.A. community, and have created unity overall.

The committee discussed the use of electronic media to provide information about new A.A.W.S. and Grapevine developments at Regional Forums and heard a verbal report from the Regional Forums coordinator regarding Internet availability and related costs. The Regional Forums coordinator shared that Internet access and equipment would be made available for A.A.W.S. and Grapevine presentations/workshops in the general session room, upon request, if feasible.

The committee noted that in 2006, the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums recommended that Additional and Local Forums be implemented on a trial basis with an annual review/inventory for five years by the committee and that the fifth and final review will be in July 2012. The committee reviewed and accepted the 2012 schedule of board and staff participation at Forums. The following Forums are scheduled for 2012:

2012		
June 1-3	Western Canada	Edmonton, Alberta
June 6-8	Eastern Canada	St. Catharines, Ontario
August 10-12	East Central "Additional"	Mt. Vernon, Illinois
September 14-16	Pacific	Fairbanks, Alaska
November 9-11	Southeast	Boca Raton, Florida

Ken Brueggemann, chairperson

Staff reports: *The International Convention* assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary.

While still on the back burner, initial plans are under way for the 2015 International Convention in Atlanta, Georgia, July 2-5, 2015 to celebrate A.A.'s 80th Anniversary! The theme will be "80 Years — Happy, Joyous and Free." Big meetings will be held in the Georgia Dome, and other meetings will take place in the Georgia World Congress Center and local hotels. Notifications about the Convention, including housing and registration information, will be made available as we get closer to the dates. Information will be available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and articles will be published in *Box 4-5-9*, which is mailed throughout the Fellowship.

Eva Sanchez

Regional/Additional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Additional Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. groups, members and trusted servants in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staff. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and regularly scheduled at the invitation of a particular region every two years. With the implementation of Additional Regional Forums, there is currently the opportunity for five Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes Regional Forum flyers to trusted service workers in the region, including the registration form, and coordinates Forum details: hotel arrangements, program, displays, on-site registration, etc. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the host contact who recruits volunteers to assist staff with hospitality, set-up and registration during the Forum weekend. The location for a Regional Forum is decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O., who also suggest presentations and workshops. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "early bird" newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Forum Final Report to all who attend. Advance planning and on-site work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

In October 2006, the concept of Local Forums (LF) was approved by the General Service Board on a five-year trial basis. We are currently in the fifth year of annual review/inventory. The purpose of Local Forums is to bring Forum information to A.A. members in remote, sparsely populated areas, urban neighborhoods, or underserved A.A. communities. Any A.A. community or service entity may request a one- or two-day Local Forum. Unlike Regional Forums, the responsibility for Forum expenses, such as meeting room rental and miscellaneous expenses, are assumed by the Local Forum Committee. At their expense, the General Service Board will send two participants, one from the board and one from the General Service Office or Grapevine office, and will provide literature for display.

The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Julio Espallat

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Committee on Literature since the 2011 General Service Conference.

• *Development of literature which focuses on spirituality* — At their July 2011 meeting, the trustees' Committee on Literature reviewed the recommendation from the 2011 Conference "that the trustees' Literature Committee continue to develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are sober in Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee expressed support for the trustees' efforts to develop a pamphlet which reflects the wide range of spiritual experiences of A.A. members and asked that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration." The chair appointed a subcommittee to review the 201 stories that had been submitted and bring a progress report to the October 29 meeting. At their October meeting, the committee reviewed a written report from the subcommittee on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality, as well as hearing a verbal update. The report outlined the process agreed to by the subcommittee for reading and reviewing the 200 stories in batches of 50, progress toward ranking the first 100 stories, and a proposed completion date that will allow for a final progress report in time for the January 2012 meeting. In January the committee read the progress report, as well as 23 stories that the subcommittee felt were representative of the charge given by the 2011 Conference, and agreed to forward to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature, for their consideration, a progress report on the develop-



ment of literature which focuses on spirituality. In view of the wide scope of the 2011 Conference Advisory Action, the subcommittee felt that it would be beneficial for the members of the Conference Committee on Literature to also read the 23 stories for any possible input or suggestions.

- "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet — At their July 2011 meeting, the committee reviewed the request from the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature that the trustees' committee continue the revision of the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet and bring a draft pamphlet or a report to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for review. The chair appointed a subcommittee to bring a progress report to the October 29 meeting of the committee.

In October the committee reviewed a report from the subcommittee on "A.A. and the Armed Services," which included the process agreed to for ranking the new stories submitted, several stories previously published in the Grapevine magazine, and a few stories from the current pamphlet. Following at least one more ranking stage and conference call, the subcommittee expects to submit a final progress report in time for the January 2012 committee meeting. At the January 2012 meeting, the committee reviewed the progress report and the draft pamphlet and agreed to forward to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature, for their consideration, the draft of the revised pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services."

- *Living Sober* booklet — At their July 2011 meeting, the committee reviewed the Conference Committee on Literature's request "that the trustees' Committee on Literature continue to review the booklet *Living Sober*, focusing on outdated language and/or practices, and provide a new revision to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration." The committee asked the Publications Department to continue work on the draft, and provide the draft or report for the committee at their October meeting. In October 2011 and January 2012, the trustees' Committee continued to review the suggested changes from the Publications Department to update outdated language in the booklet and agreed to forward to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature, for their consideration, the final draft of the revisions to the *Living Sober* booklet.

- *No Action Item* — At the July 2011 meeting the committee discussed a request to add a sponsorship appendix to the Big Book and took no action, noting, among other considerations, that the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" adequately addressed the subject.

Projects forwarded to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature:

- Revised draft pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services."
- Progress report on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality.
- Draft revision of the booklet *Living Sober*.

Requests discussed and forwarded to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature:

- Discuss a suggestion for revision of the pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service."
- Discuss a request to add text from the dust jacket of the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, to the dust jacket of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book.

- Consider a request to add the A.A. Preamble to the front inside pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- Consider a request to add the short form of the Twelve Concepts for World Service to *As Bill Sees It*.

Roberta Lindeman, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Committees on Literature, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Service Publications Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, and intergroup/central office literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 73 area, 327 district and 18 intergroup/central office literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O. The Literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect of the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for Box 4-5-9, published in English, French and Spanish with an approximate quarterly distribution of 60,000 copies in English, 2,070 copies in French, and 3,450 copies in Spanish. A digital delivery service for Box 4-5-9 has been added through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site www.aa.org. There are currently 10,200 subscribers to the service. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in Box 4-5-9. G.S.O. always welcomes committee sharing on service from the Fellowship, which may be included in articles so that Box 4-5-9 can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities. As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

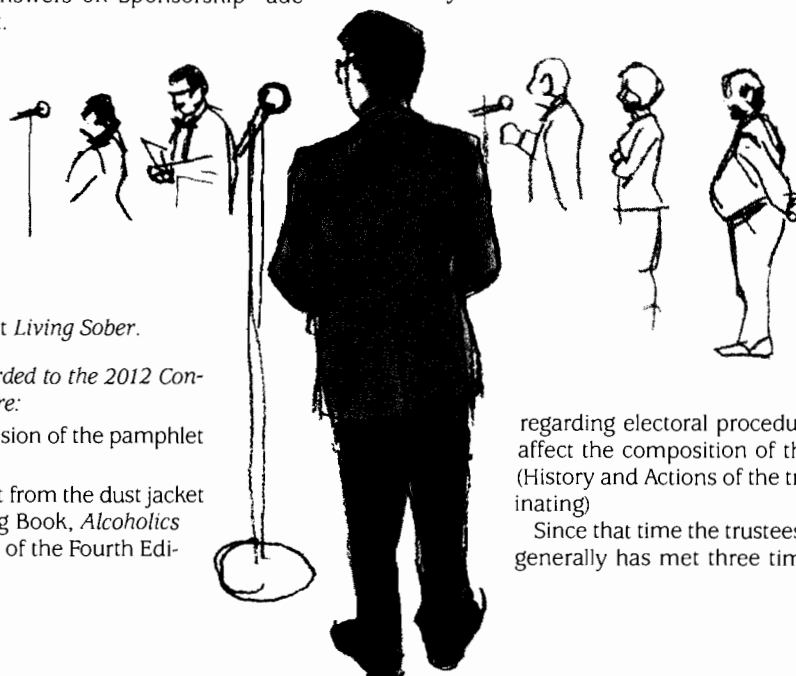
Gayle Solheim Riese

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: The General Service Board's trustees' Committee on Nominating was first appointed by the chairman of the board in 1944. Its primary responsibilities were to "establish criteria for and to review résumés of trustee candidates and directors and to make recommendations

regarding electoral procedures and matters which may affect the composition of the board and election to it." (History and Actions of the trustees' Committee on Nominating)

Since that time the trustees' Committee on Nominating generally has met three times each year and, with the



forming of the General Service Conference in 1951, the committee began to meet annually with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The responsibilities of the trustees' Committee on Nominating grew over time to encompass establishing criteria for all vacancies, whether in the ranks of trustees or among key service directors and staff members.

Activities of this committee in the past year:

- *Follow Up to 2011 General Service Conference* — In response to a 2011 Conference Committee consideration, the committee forwarded a report to the 2012 Conference Committee on Trustees regarding the impact of the Conference disapproving a recommended slate.
- *Regional Elections* — The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2012 all candidates submitted for West Central and Western Canada regional trustees elections.
- *Board Slates* — The committee recommended slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2012, following presentation at the 2012 General Service Conference.
- The committee recommended that J. Gary Lutz serve as trustee director for a two-year term on A.A. World Services, Inc., following the 2012 Conference, to succeed Pam Reising.
- The committee recommended that Clayton Vandivort serve as trustee director for a two-year term on A.A. Grapevine, Inc., following the 2012 Conference, to succeed El Nault.
- *Composition, Scope and Procedures* — The General Service Board approved the following recommendations to revise the language in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures:

Composition:

- Recognizing that the general manager of the General Service Office can be a helpful resource to the trustees' Nominating Committee in its deliberations, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that a change to its Composition, Scope and Procedure be made under "Composition" to add to the third paragraph in this section the following sentence: *"The general manager of the General Service Office is invited to participate, without a vote, in all open meetings of the trustees' Nominating Committee."*

Procedures:

- That the phrase "for disapproval, if any" be removed from all trustees' Nominating Committee procedures as it is procedurally restrictive.
- That new language be added to Procedure No. 1 *Grapevine and A.A.W.S. Procedure for Nominating Corporate Board Directors* regarding the "Consultation Process for the selection of nontrustee directors" and the "Notification of Candidates."
- That a draft procedure for selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board (Procedure No. 14) be approved.
- That language regarding nominating regional trustees and trustees-at-large, adopted by the 2011 General Service Conference for placement in the 2011-2012 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, be changed in Nominating Procedures No. 11 "Procedures For Electing Regional Trustee Candidates in the U.S. and Canada," and No. 12 "Procedures For Electing Trustee-At-Large — U.S. or Canada", to match the language adapted by the 2011 Conference — in both instances to read: *"Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a*

trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

- Additionally in Procedure No 11 and No 12, the committee recommended that language referencing "states" and "provinces" be changed to reference "areas."
- That the following amendment (**in bold**) be made to Procedure No 7 for Assigning Trustees and Directors to General Service Board Committees in section 2b:

Current text reads:

- b. Balance regarding trustee and nontrustee committee members on committees where nontrustee people are used.

Amended text reads:

- b. Balance **and qualifications** regarding trustee and nontrustee committee members on committees where nontrustee people are used.
- The committee recommended that the General Service Board identify strategies for the recruitment of Class A trustees.
- The committee recommended that the following amended language (**in bold**) be forwarded to the 2012 Conference Report and Charter Committee for placement in *The A.A. Service Manual*, page S63, 1st paragraph, 2nd sentence under the heading "Election of Trustees and Officers:"

Current text reads:

"During the Conference, a proposed slate of trustees is presented to the Conference, and becomes the final slate unless a majority of the Conference members votes to disapprove it."

Amended text reads:

- "During the Conference, a proposed slate of trustees is presented to the Conference, and becomes the final slate unless a majority of Conference members votes to disapprove **any one or all proposed trustees listed.**"
- The committee received and reviewed a communication from the chair of the A.A. Grapevine Nominating Committee regarding their plans to recruit nontrustee director candidates and a description of preferred characteristics for A.A. nontrustee Grapevine directors to be used in the notifications.
- The committee agreed to forward a request to A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. that they consider developing and adopting a written policy regarding the solicitation and maintenance of resumes for trustees and directors. It is suggested that the respective policies would address collection, use/access, storage and disposal of any applications and related materials.
- The committee considered a request that it review and reconsider its 2011 nonapproval action to the slate of directors on A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board and took no action agreeing that the 2011 slates for all boards were approved by the 2011 Conference as Advisory Actions and the committee did not wish to reconsider an Advisory Action of the 2011 Conference.
- The committee received notification from the trustees' Public Information Committee and the trustees' Literature Committee of the need for their current appointed committee members to continue serving on their respective committees for another year; the committee approved this extension and agreed to forward their decision to the chair of the General Service Board.

Victor Phillips, chairperson

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment is responsible to the trustees' Committee on Nominating, and to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees as well as to trustees' subcommittees. Since the last Conference,

the staff member prepared background, minutes and reports for three quarterly trustees' committee meetings. The staff member worked with the trustees' committee on vacancy announcements, and also coordinated the transcription and review of resumes for 12 regional trustee candidates who made their names available to participate in this year's Conference elections procedure.

Doug Richardson, acting secretary

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing video and audio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on aa.org; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

Anonymity — The committee reviewed the Anonymity Wallet Card and agreed to forward an updated version to the 2012 General Service Conference.

The committee considered a request to develop new Conference-approved literature focused on anonymity and electronic media/social networking and decided to take no action, noting that there is a General Service Board Ad Hoc Committee that will be discussing Social Media and the Traditions. The committee also suggested that the Publications Department consider updating the cover of the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" to better communicate its content.

The committee considered and forwarded to the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information two requests related to adding language referring to current media to Tradition Eleven.



Communications with the Media — The committee reviewed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, which was sent by e-mail and postal mail in March.

Membership Survey — The committee oversaw the development and implementation of the 2011 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey, and reviewed a draft pamphlet of the results at their January 2012 meeting, which they forwarded to the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee also discussed the purpose and process of the Membership Survey and agreed to continue this discussion at their next meeting.

Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to aa.org, updates on Web site activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the Web site, and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2012 Conference Public Information Committee.

Television P.S.A.s — In response to the 2011 Conference Advisory Action that the trustees' committee produces "a culturally sensitive Spanish-language Public Service Announcement, independent of any English language P.S.A.," a subcommittee was formed to facilitate the selection of one concept for development of this P.S.A. In October 2011, the trustee's Committee on Public Information recommended that the concept "Tengo Esperanza," submitted by Industrial Strength Productions, be developed as the Hispanic video P.S.A. After viewing rough cuts of the P.S.A. at their January 2012 meeting, the committee made suggestions for minor changes, and agreed to forward the P.S.A. to the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The La Viña Editorial Board generously shared their time and expertise to assist on this project by reviewing the proposed concepts, the script and "rough cut." The committee also concluded that if "Tengo Esperanza" is approved, it would be important to fund a centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation phase of the project, in addition to the work done by the local committees. All current A.A. TV P.S.A.s were reviewed and found to be relevant and useful; given that, the committee did not find the need for a new A.A. TV P.S.A. in 2012.

Utilizing New Media Platforms — A subcommittee was formed to develop a comprehensive Public Information media plan. At their January 2012 meeting, the committee accepted the report of the Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee and agreed to continue discussion of the comprehensive media plan at their July 2012 meeting.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information a suggestion that A.A. establish a presence on Facebook for the purpose of providing information about A.A. to the public; this presence would serve as an informational resource only, with no interpersonal communication capabilities.

Young People's Videos — The Guidelines for Submissions were posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in Spanish and French. In addition, AA Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne were contacted and asked to periodically post or print information about the project.

P.I. Kit — In response to an Additional Consideration from the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information the committee reviewed proposed alternative packaging for the P.I. Kits and forwarded a proposal to the 2012 Conference Public Information Committee.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Corliss Burke, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 950 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television and radio Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In April 2011 it was e-mailed and mailed to over 9,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The results of triennial surveys are published in pamphlet form and as a table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

The goal of Public Information work at G.S.O. is to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

Mary Cumings

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the “G.S.O. Staff” with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. The staff coordinator shares responsibility for corresponding with members from Western Canada, covering during the busy six months of the year for the Conference coordinator.

In 2011, the staff received 53,277 pieces of correspondence by mail, e-mail and fax, a 15 percent decrease from correspondence received in 2010. The staff also answers many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. Mail, e-mail, faxes, etc., are responded to within ten business days.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses re-



flect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries.

G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2011, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,641 individuals, in addition to English- and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear “how G.S.O. works” during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the open A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

This staff member also serves as liaison for G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, responding to all inquiries, concerns and suggestions from A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. This staff member is also the contact for maintaining the Web site in a professional manner, including keeping all information on the Web site current.

Rick Walker

■ Area Service Highlights— Panel 62 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alaska: With just over 700,000 people, Area 2, Alaska, averages 1.2 persons per square mile. Two-thirds of the state's population lives in the four largest communities, with the balance of the population spread over an area two and a half times the size of Texas; 83 % of Alaska's towns have fewer than 1,000 residents, and many of these communities are accessible only by air, or by barge in the short summer season. In this vast environment, the area service structure has grown up over time to serve Alaska's 187 active groups and many remote individual A.A.s. Inspired by the Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly in Juneau, standing committees in Area 2 were formed to mirror the Conference committees in 1994. The original thought was to have all G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s assigned to committees, but that idea was never embraced by the service structure. Over the years we have had many Area Committee Chairs who have served as committees of one. Overwhelmed by the idea of reaching out to the full expanse of the area, these committee members often worked diligently in their own communities, building local experience around the state. With the introduction of Area Committee monthly teleconferences in 2006, this broad-based experience really began to gel. Today we have active statewide committees reaching out through technology via e-mail and teleconference to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous throughout Alaska. These committees are actively responsible for reaching out to our remote communities. With a commitment to unity, we travel great distances to rotate our five assemblies each panel around the state. From Southeast to the Interior we Twelve Step our outlying regions regularly. G.S.R.s share group reports at assemblies where we experience the closeness of a small community on a grand scale. The dedication of our groups to active participation in general service is always inspiring to me, and it has been my great privilege to grow up in recovery and service in Area 2.—*Eden Lovejoy*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 consists of the Province of Alberta, the Northwest Territories and a portion of Nunavut, the East Kootneys, and the Peace River Block of British Columbia. The area extends from the Canada-U.S. border north to the Arctic Circle. As of this January, our area has 436 active groups and there are 88 of unknown status. We have 49 districts with 39 D.C.M.s and 343 registered G.S.R.s. We have two area assemblies in the same city every year and two A.C.M.s in different districts selected by a bid process at our yearly Pre-Conference Assembly in March. Our area continues to have a Travel Assistance Program available to all D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s (though funds are limited) to attend assemblies or A.C.M.s. A big highlight for us this year is we have the pleasure of hosting the Western Canada Regional Forum in Edmonton, Alberta, June 1-3. Because of three resignations (two appointed positions and one elected) over the last couple of years, Area 78 has developed guidelines to fill these positions and we'll be asking the area's approval to adopt the guidelines at our September assembly. Area 78 has a new Web master and we're all very excited to see the launch of a new Area 78 Web site very soon. A motion was passed from last September's assembly that we increase the financial amount we send the General

Service Board to seat our delegate. Area 78 geographically is the largest area in North America, which creates problems regarding travel and providing our area services. But listening to the D.C.M. reports at this January's A.C.M., I heard a lot of positive activity in the districts and strong group participation to carry the message of sobriety to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Walter Stadnyczuk*

Arizona: Area 3, Arizona, covers 114,000 square miles and contains a diverse population of 6.4 million people, composed of over 20,000 A.A. members in 900 registered groups forming 54 local districts spread across 15 county districts and one area-wide Hispanic linguistic district. Our area structure assigns groups randomly to one of nine panels that meet at assemblies to consider topics assigned by an agenda committee and makes recommendations to our assembly body. Additionally, our area structure has a service arm made up of 12 coordinators and their committees. There are eight elected coordinators and four appointed coordinators. Rounding out our structure is our Administrative Committee made up of seven elected officers and five D.C.M./D.C.M.C.s-at-large. Our assemblies are bid by local districts ensuring they are hosted in different locations throughout our area. This last rotation has seen many exciting changes. We voted to create a Hispanic linguistic district to accommodate our fast-growing and active Hispanic community. Recently, our area hosted its 12th Annual Corrections Conference, which brings area A.A. Corrections volunteers together with Corrections and Judicial Professionals at the County, State, and Federal levels. The last rotation also saw an increase in our C.P.C. and P.I. activity as these two coordinators and their committees worked together to offer many workshops throughout the area. This and the activities of all our coordinators were showcased at our 2nd Bi-Annual Coordinators Conference held last fall. We look forward to more exciting growth this rotation. Truly, this rotation holds great promise of continued growth in carrying the message of A.A. to the still-suffering alcoholic. This makes me especially honored to serve as Area 3's Panel 62 delegate to the General Service Conference.—*Dave Murray*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 9 Mid-Southern California, is made up of over 1,938 registered groups and serves more than 60,000 members within the geographic boundaries, making us the largest area, in terms of those it serves, of the 93 present areas in the U.S. and Canada. And because of the enormity of the size and the distances between our 26 districts, six of which are Hispanic, we have begun to look at ways of better serving and polling the conscience of our ever growing community. Because there is one delegate for 1,938 groups and 60,000 members compared to the national average of one delegate for every 676 groups or 14,771 members, we have developed a "Think Tank" to gather and process information on how to better serve and communicate with the remote communities, as well as the dense metropolis regions of our area. This Think Tank will eventually conclude with some recommendations as to its research, which may culminate in redistricting, reappropriation, or even requesting the creation of a new delegate area. It may also conclude that we are best serving just as we are. We have a committee for creating our Conference agenda summaries for our yearly pre-Conference workshop. Our past delegates continue to serve a vital function in the education and sponsorship of newer service members, while giving our newly installed board a reason to stay engaged in our guidelines and bylaws. All of our committees have chairs, and most have both English and Spanish co-chairs, which function in unison. We also have the

best coffee maker in all of California, and maybe in all of General Service. From the Native Americans to the snowbirds from Canada, from farmers to fishermen, our area serves the combined voices and consciences of a multi-lingual, multi-cultural Fellowship through the language of the heart as supported by the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous. Thank you for allowing me to serve, and thank God for A.A.—*Jeryl Thompson*

California (Northern Interior): Imagine a group surrounding a tree in Yosemite, ending a meeting on their knees with the Third Step Prayer — one gal for her first time. Picture a district meeting near Mount Shasta, preparing to host an area assembly. Think of a Young People's event in Sacramento. Reflect on a meeting behind the walls in Folsom State Prison. Imagine a Unity Day in Fresno, celebrating Service. Picture a carpool driving past orange and almond groves — on the way to connect with still more alcoholics, and a Twelfth Step call, one drunk sharing with another that there is a way out. This is California Northern Interior Area 7 (CNIA). We have 28,040 members across our almost 50,000 square miles. We are one of six areas in California, and we extend from the Oregon border in the inland valley south to just above Bakersfield. CNIA contains 29 districts, including four Spanish-language districts. We have 1,002 groups, 719 of which are active. Membership is up 7% since our last highlights. We have seven elected area officers, and six appointed chairs. We have a rich set of Archives, including a memoir stating that the origin of "Gratitude Week" had its roots in CNIA. We were honored to host the Bridging the Gap National Workshop Weekend in Sacramento last September. This is the first time the workshop was held in California. We are very committed to supporting Grapevine and La Viña. Our new E-services Committee is going through growing pains, and we identify with some of the struggles that broader A.A. faces. CNIA keeps the Conference cycle alive all year long, and we love Alcoholics Anonymous!—*Lela Meinke*

California (San Diego/Imperial): If you wanted to quit drinking in Area 8, I could take you to a meeting held around a bon fire, or in a basement, or on the beach watching the sun set over the Pacific. However, you're newly sober and antisocial, so you call one of our three central offices; they give you meeting information and set you up with a Twelfth Step volunteer. When A.A. arrived in San Diego in 1940 there was only one meeting on a Friday night, but now that Twelfth Step volunteer keeps you on the run by sending you to over 1,500 weekly meetings held from 5:00 a.m. to midnight. So maybe you fake an illness — but even if you were confined in a home the Meetings-to-Go service will bring a meeting to you. You got picked up on an old warrant and sent to jail? You may find a meeting there, because our two institutional committees carry over 400 monthly meetings into correctional facilities, and the staff will probably know what to do with you because the C.P.C. and P.I. committees work with local professionals. When you've finished your jail time a member of the Contact on Release Committee meets you and arranges to get you back to a meeting, where it just so happens that the Literature Committee is holding their traveling Movie Night — and tonight's DVD selection is *Your General Service Office* (aka *General Service for Dummies*), after which you sincerely, but somewhat naively, ask the question: "How do I get in service?" Now you are hanging out with the winners as representatives from 23 districts and five intergroups descend on you and tell you about the five area assemblies, three Spanish-language districts, and Young People's groups. They tell you about events like Grapevine/La Viña writers' workshops, Foro Locales and Hospitals and Institutions Conferences that virtually fill the calendar this year. Somewhat dazed, but smiling because you are

in service to A.A. in Area 8 and it is better than anything else you've ever had, you extend your hand to that new guy who just walked in the door and start to talk about what just happened, and what it is like now.—*Tom Mooney*

Delaware: Area 12 consists of the "First State" of Delaware. We have a total population of slightly under a million occupying about 2,500 square miles. There are three counties, with each having its own intergroup. Each intergroup has its own committees for providing Twelfth Step efforts in its county. The area and each intergroup have active Web sites, which are linked to the other three, and then to aa.org. Each intergroup has its meeting list posted to its Web site, which gives anyone searching for A.A. information in Delaware access to local, area and A.A. as a whole answers. As 2011, Area 12 has 168 groups registered as active with the G.S.O. We continue to have the highest per capita contribution to G.S.O. and 50% of the groups contributed to G.S.O. in 2011. In turn, 45 contribute to Area 12. There are 13 districts in this area, which form 4 to 27 groups per district. The Area Committee meets six times a year and the assembly meets four times a year. The April Assembly Meeting is a mini-Conference in preparation for the General Service Conference. Our elections are held in September of the odd numbered years. In the even numbered years, the September meeting is devoted to an Area Inventory. This year, we will be hosting our 52nd Delaware State Convention from May 18th to 20th at the Convention Center in Rehoboth Beach. Information and the registration form can be found on our Web site—delawareaa.org. We hope that you will join us in enjoying the fellowship, serenity and Atlantic beach in Rehoboth.—*Dick Humphrey*

Georgia: Area 16, Georgia, has 764 groups; 51 districts, including a linguistic district, which is comprised of 22 groups; five intergroups; 34 groups in Correctional Facilities; and a bimonthly Area Newsletter. Our area assembly meets three times a year. It has committee workshops, orientation for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s, an A.A. speaker meeting and a Sunday business meeting. There is a separate session for D.C.M.s at each assembly, plus two D.C.M. planning sessions in April and November. All state-sponsored events have simultaneous Spanish translation. Our Annual State Convention is prepaid. Groups send in voluntary contributions which cover the cost of the entire convention, therefore there is no registration fee if you reside within Area 16. Our pre-paid convention has hearing impaired and Spanish translations. We have eight Cluster Forums per year. A Cluster Forum is a cluster of districts divided by a region of the state, such as the SW Cluster Forum. These districts put on a one-day forum, which consists of the General Service Conference discussion topics and workshops. The annual SE Delegates Get Together is held in Atlanta during the month of February. We have a Spanish State Convention and a Young People's State Convention. We have an Area Office Committee, six area committees, a Web administrator, and an editor. Our area Web site is aageorgia.org. Area 16 has its own Service Manual. The Georgia A.A. Service Manual is a valuable source of information about the history of A.A. in Area 16, how the assembly operates, and qualifications and duties for various offices. We have an area office with one paid employee. Our area office also houses an archive repository. Area 16 will be hosting the 2015 International Convention. We are in the process of updating our area's history book titled *We Share* in hopes of having it ready for the 2015 Convention. In Georgia we drink sweet tea, eat fried green tomatoes, speak with an accent, and treat our visitors with southern hospitality. It is truly an experience you must not miss. Come visit us on the road to happy destiny.—*Tom Hoban*

Idaho: Although Area 18 is comparatively small in member numbers, we do have the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous alive and well. We are a 501(c) (3) organizational entity and are registered with the Idaho Secretary of State. With the exception of the northern panhandle of Idaho our area includes the rest of the state and a small piece of eastern Oregon. The area is comprised of 12 districts, with 207 registered and active groups trying to fulfill the recovery needs of alcoholics. Some of the area's most recent challenges, in addition to the ongoing ones, include the continuous and increased efforts to meet the emerging special needs requirements of members who experience visual, hearing, and physical impairments, members and newcomers being recently discharged from hospitals and institutions, and our non-English speaking members. As we gain more experience in these endeavors we become more experienced in not only carrying the message to them but also embracing them as equal and active members of the A.A. Fellowship. Also, our longstanding committees, including H&I, CPC/PI, Grapevine and Finance, are thriving with caring and loving members serving as chairpersons and members of these committees. Area 18 conducts two business meetings, one in the Spring and one in the Fall, at rotating locations within the area. Districts bid on hosting these meetings and are responsible for the planning and execution of the Area Assembly/Convention, with the exception of the business meeting itself. In addition to these two events that include the G.S.R.s from all of the districts, we conduct an area committee meeting three times a year. Members of the Idaho Area 18 committee include the area elected officers, special committee chairpersons and the 12 D.C.M.s. Finally, two of the districts host a pre-General Service Conference meeting, or Pre-Con. Prior to the Pre-Con the area delegate divides the various agenda items among the 12 D.C.M.s, who in turn distribute them to the group G.S.R.s in their districts for research and reporting purposes. At the Pre-Con the G.S.R.s report on what they have researched to help the delegate become better informed on the Conference issues.—*Brian Morishita*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 consists of approximately the northern one-third of the state of Illinois, excluding Area 19, Chicago. With a population of more than 4.5 million and an area of more than 14,000 square miles, we are very diverse in citizenry. Working from the eastern higher populated collar counties around Chicago, to the west, going through some very rural areas with spotted cities along the way to the Mississippi River, we have 1,100 groups with over 22,000 members from 25 districts, two of which are Spanish-linguistic districts. At least one member from these two districts is involved in the translation of General Service Conference background information into Spanish and being distributed nationwide. Our districts are also very wide ranging, from the very active to those that struggle to participate. One of those districts is working to move from what was once considered a dark district. We have four assemblies and four committee meetings each year, with a Spring Conference every year. This year is our third effort to combine our Spring Assembly into the Spring Conference. We expect to vote at this year's Spring Assembly, to permanently combine the two events. A Pre-Conference Delegates Workshop, which for a while has been held as a part of the Spring Assembly, is now going into its third year as a stand alone event. It has been very well attended, with great participation. In the fall we have a one day Big Book Conference. Illinois has a State Conference, with the hosting commitment rotating every year between Areas 19, 20, and 21. Area 20 will host the National Bridging the Gap Workshop in 2013. All of these activities are bid on and hosted by the districts within our area. Our area and district serv-

ice committees are very active, with our Corrections and Treatment Committees being very visible in their efforts to reach out to the still-suffering alcoholic. The Corrections Committees from the three Illinois areas have for some time now been very actively working together to share their Experience, Strength, and Hope with each other, and to be consistent with our efforts within the Illinois Department of Corrections. I thank Area 20 for the honor and privilege to serve as their Panel 62 delegate.—*Rich Healless*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 serves more than 650 groups, 25 districts and one Spanish-speaking district. Our groups are also served by 14 area standing committees and five active inter-groups. We hold five assemblies per year, one of which is a pre-Conference assembly; a November budget meeting; and one weekend get-away assembly that focuses on service workshops and elections. We alternate years with Area 22 in hosting the state convention. Our theme this year is "Our Primary Purpose"—*Come Celebrate!* Last year the area was feeling the financial pinch as reflected by the overall economy. I am very happy to report that our Seventh Tradition donations are up and our financial situation is very sound. Through diligent Twelfth Step work by the area committees and individual groups, 11 federal, state and county correctional facilities are being served and two women's prisons are holding weekend conferences. Our Web site is up and running and we are now up to speed with group e-mail capabilities. I am also happy to report that the area-wide dedicated phone line for bridging the gap with treatment facilities has helped ensure calls don't fall through the cracks. A traveling G.S.R. school to various locales within the area has resulted in an increase of general service representatives. Also, a portion of the school relates to how spiritually and money mix. That may be why we are more financially sound than years past. As many as 80 students have shown up to attend our schools. Beginning this year our alternate delegate is taking a similar approach with D.C.M.s. We will have our traveling D.C.M. schools starting next month. I am honored and grateful for the opportunity to serve Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Gary BraVard*

Kansas: Area 25, Kansas, also known as the Sunflower State, has 81,815 square miles, with a population of 2,775,997; the largest city is Wichita, with a population of around 361,420. We are also aligned with ten other areas and six other states to form the Southwest Region. We have 29 districts, including three linguistic districts. In January and July we hold our Area assemblies. At the assemblies we have board, standing committee, and business meetings. We also hold workshops to help understand the service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous. In July of odd years we hold our elections for Area service. In April and October we hold our Area Committee meetings. At these one day meetings we set the agendas for the Area assemblies. Area 25 has 366 groups, of which 25 are Spanish-speaking. We are working on better ways to communicate with these Spanish-speaking groups at the Area level. In the metro areas of Kansas you are able to attend more than one meeting a day. To do the same in the rural areas, you must be willing to drive at least 30 minutes or more one way. We have campouts and Round Robins all over the state; we have Roundups in the Northeast and Wichita area. We have conferences in the Southeast, Northwest, and Southwest, with an annual Corrections conference and our Area 25 conference, which is held every year in September. In Area 25 our primary purpose is Service. All area activities will be aimed at assisting Kansas A.A. groups to function more effectively. Thank you Kansas for letting me be of service at this level.—*Mike Hudson*

Kentucky: Area 26 encompasses the entire Commonwealth of Kentucky, four counties in southern Indiana, two towns in south-central Ohio, and two towns in Illinois. We are served by 36 district committees, our newest being a Spanish-speaking district that is comprised of seven groups located in several cities across the Commonwealth. Currently the area operates with nine standing committees, all of which are actively working to extend the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous to the still-suffering alcoholic. Area 26 maintains a Web site and we publish a quarterly newsletter, the *Kentuckiana News*, which is available both in print and online. The roots of Alcoholics Anonymous run deep in Kentucky. On March 18, 1888, Henrietta Buckler was born in Lawrenceburg, Kentucky. You may know her better as Henrietta Seiberling, the woman who arranged that first fateful meeting between Bill and Bob on Mother's Day 1935. A few weeks later, on June 28, 1935, Bill and Bob visited the Akron City Hospital and talked with another Kentucky native, Bill D., also known as "A.A. #3." Even with the Kentucky connection, it was six years before the Louisville Group was established with the help of some folks from Indianapolis and Evansville, Indiana. In 1946, our second group took hold in Lexington. We have experienced steady growth since then. Area 26 now has 712 active, registered groups, with at least one group meeting in 105 of our 120 counties. We have 65 groups meeting in correctional facilities. Our larger metropolitan areas are served by five active local Intergroup or Central Offices. And this year we celebrated recovery at our 61st consecutive Annual State Convention. I was surprised to learn that Kentucky's Official State Beverage is milk. I don't know if we've got milk — but we do have bourbon. Over half of the world's bourbon is produced in Kentucky and we'd like to thank each and every one of you for your past contribution to our local economy. Words cannot express my gratitude for the love and support of my area. It is both an honor and privilege to serve as their Panel 62 delegate to this General Service Conference.—*Lynda Rivers*

Maine: Area 28 has 550 registered groups divided into 24 districts. The area stretches from Kittery in the south to bilingual Fort Kent and Madawaska in the north, and from the New Hampshire border cities to Eastport and Lubec downeast. In addition, there are groups in the Saint John Valley of western New Brunswick that are part of Area 28. The area is served by a strong panel of officers and fourteen standing committees that are active in carrying the message. We are also fortunate to have an area Archivist, as well as Intergroup and Al-Anon liaisons. The groups are well served by a Central Service Office in Portland and a Downeast Intergroup in Ellsworth. We hold two service assemblies a year that rotate around the state. There are five area committee meetings held in a central location. Pre- and post-Conference forums are held in early March and mid-May, respectively. The area also hosts one-day service workshops called Love and Service Days, with district, standing committees, and area officers participating. We take time out in the summer to enjoy our sobriety at our annual Round-Up in July at the Sugarloaf Ski Resort. Attendance peaks around 1,000 people. One of the noticeable characteristics of the participation in area service work is the profound commitment of those who do get involved. Area 28 is fortunate to have a strong commitment to general service.—*Linda Thompson*

Manitoba: Area 80, Manitoba, consists of approximately 250,000 square miles, so we are almost as big as Texas. The majority of our 4,000 members reside in or around the city of Winnipeg. An annual Keystone Conference is hosted by Winnipeg in November, with many international speakers; they roll out the

welcome mat again in January for the Winter Conference. Manitoba General Service holds four assemblies per year with corresponding area committee meetings. Winnipeg also hosts a Gratitude Day every March in an effort to assist General Service financially and encourage newcomers to come and share their successes. From Winnipeg it's an 8½ hour road trip to the Northern city of Thompson, a stopping-off place with a well-established A.A. group, on the way to the real remote areas who have only winter roads or access by air. Small cities and hamlets in between make up the 14 active districts. Many of the districts have eight to fourteen groups, but in the rural areas there may be as few as one or two members in a group. It has always been a challenge to meet the needs of the remote and isolated districts in our area. In the last few years Area 80 has formed a remote communities work force and, together with telecommunications, we have been witnessing the A.A. beacon beginning to light up the far north. Places that have never had A.A. groups are now finding the support they need to start and sustain their own home groups and, falling short of that, they can always access the telecommunications meeting every Thursday night at 8:00 p.m. Area 80 is looking forward to hosting a Forum in Winnipeg in 2014 and always welcomes visitors.—*Pamela Vollans-Matthews*

Maryland: Greetings from Area 29, which spans nearly all of Maryland, 350 miles from Ocean City and the Chesapeake Bay to the Appalachian Plateau. Incorporated as Maryland General Service, Inc., or MGS, Area 29 serves 15,000 A.A. members, 1,150 groups, and 47 districts, as well as ten intergroup service areas. MGS holds five assemblies and four committees each year, rotating our meeting locations throughout the area. Each area meeting starts with a new G.S.R./D.C.M. orientation session. Our 19 committees, with chairs appointed by the area chairperson, include Corrections, Finance, Grapevine, Literature, C.P.C., P.I., Treatment, Web site, Archives, Host, Registrar, Audio, Intergroup Liaison, Newsletter, Special Needs, and Workshops. An ad hoc committee is now studying redistricting to help us better serve our groups. MGS is grateful to its eight past delegates who actively participate in various ways. Each spring six panels, grouped by districts and composed of all interested A.A. members, meet and research the Conference agenda items, then report back to our April Mini-Conference. This both prepares the delegate for the Conference and informs the G.S.R.s and groups about the Conference agenda. Come summer, the panels reconvene, build on their spring work, and formulate possible agenda items for the next year, extending G.S.R.s' and groups' understanding of the Conference process. MGS hosts two annual conventions, with speaker meetings, service workshops, and a general service presentation, plus Alcahons, a banquet, and the all-important ice cream social. MGS reaches out to dark districts and help relight them upon request, and we cooperate with the Maryland Young People in A.A. Bid Committee, which works to bring an ICYPAA to Baltimore. MGS also liaisons closely with our ten intergroup associations to optimize communications and services. Area 29 is grateful for the opportunity to help ensure A.A. will still be here for the alcoholic yet to come.—*Bob Clegg*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31, Western Massachusetts, "The Golden West," is a vibrant community concerned with strengthening a solid service structure inherited from past trusted servants, so we may fulfill our primary purpose to stay sober and help another alcoholic achieve sobriety. We are more than just a land mass of the four counties in the western section of the state, or the six standing committees and four invited com-

mittees that comprise our area service structure; we are a collective body of spirits that belong to the greater good to guide this altruistic movement forward. We express this gratitude through our thoughts, our words, and our actions to the A.A. community and those that may have been affected by the alcoholic. Outreach to this third party is demonstrated by our P.I. and C.P.C. committees hosting the longest continuously running radio program in Alcoholics Anonymous. May it continue so long as God sees fit. We are still developing our Web site and until it is complete we have been blessed to have one of our two intergroup offices post important dates, messages, and links via the Western Mass Intergroup Web site. It reaches areas not serviced by their local intergroup offices, and allows us to let literature carry the message to over 25 states, several countries, and three continents. Strong Seventh Tradition contributions make the supply of literature possible to an A.A. meeting at Saint Andrews Church in Moscow. What we do affects others on the other side of the globe. An alcoholic from Area 31 was fighting in Afghanistan and found himself and a few other alcoholic soldiers reading the Big Book, sent by one of our intergroup offices, as bombs dropped and bullets flew. Our Seventh Tradition contributions affect those around the globe. Our Accessibilities Committee is rising out of its embryonic stage and learning to grapple with the hearing impaired and homebound communities. Dedicated phone lines have been established as part of this outreach. We hope they will take this helpful hand up with the same responsibility and enthusiasm these men and women of the Accessibilities Committee possess. Although we are small geographically, Area 31 carries an energetic message of experience, strength, and hope by flexing its spiritual muscle through its strong structure and enthusiasm.—*Brian O'Shea*

Michigan (Western): Area 34, Western Michigan, comprises the western half of the Lower Peninsula combined with the eastern part of the Upper Peninsula. We have 659 registered groups throughout 15 geographical districts, reaching as far north to the border of Canada, and south to the border of Indiana, just over 400 miles. We also have one Spanish linguistic district. We hold our assemblies on a monthly basis, alternating throughout our area, allowing a different district to host each month. In 2011 we decided to include more lively agendas and allow time for workshops and sharing sessions during the assemblies every other month, hoping to draw interest and inspire more people to get active in our service structure. I'm grateful to announce that in the past few months, after almost 15 years of being dark, one of our northern districts is in the process of springing back to life. Another recent achievement is our Area "Handbook," after over four years in the making. We recently approved the completion of our Area Guidelines, which is a valuable tool, most especially for those new to our area and the A.A. service structure. Area 34 is also active with the Michigan Statewide Service Committee, where we meet quarterly with our neighboring areas in Lower Michigan, Area 32 (Central), and Area 33 (Southeast). As well as participating at the annual Mock Conference, we rotate hosting the State Convention with these areas, and I am privileged to announce that this year Area 34 is hosting the 60th Michigan State Convention in conjunction with the 32nd East Central Regional Conference, in Grand Rapids, June 29th - July 1st. I would like to extend an invitation to everyone here to join us this summer in Michigan.—*Kenny Kaatz*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35, Northern Minnesota, has 577 registered groups and 16 active districts. Our area is responsible for hosting two two-day assemblies each year as well as a yearly two-day Area 35 Service Workshop. Our spring assembly

serves the major role of discussing background information related to agenda items to better prepare our delegate for the General Service Conference. We also hold four committee meetings each year and our area officers host two Zonal Forums to better reach individual groups, let them meet our area officers, and see how we may better serve their needs. A few of the new projects our area has been working on over the past rotation include participation with various transitional fairs for inmates leaving correctional facilities, the creation of a statewide meeting locator, and the formation of an area finance committee. The statewide A.A. meeting locator has been a joint effort with Area 36 (Southern Minnesota) aiming to better serve those new to the Fellowship that may not recognize area lines. This new locator uses registered groups from the FNV database and incorporates a searchable map feature for all of Minnesota. Participation with transitional fairs for inmates leaving correctional facilities has proven to be an effective and rewarding way to provide information about A.A. to incarcerated alcoholics about to be released. Our Area 35 Finance Committee has been a great addition to our area service structure and provides both oversight and direction for financial contributions. The committee performs a full review of financial transactions for each period to insure accuracy and accountability for all services provided. Area 35, like all other areas, has many opportunities for growth in relation to how effectively we carry the message and participate in this Fellowship. Notable district concerns include meeting service needs with adequate volunteers, a steadily decreasing number of closed meetings, and an ever-increasing trend to include problems other than alcohol within meetings. Such issues indicate a sincere need to better educate members about our singleness of purpose, our primary purpose, and the purpose of open meetings. Continued work by all members sharing the great news of what we receive by active participation in our Fellowship, along with strong service leadership, will help to insure that we are around so long as God finds us useful.—*Jim Kath*

Mississippi: Area 37's membership consists of 238 registered groups in 104 towns and cities located from the Gulf Coast to just south of Memphis, Tennessee. The mighty Mississippi River is our western border and the state of Alabama is our eastern border. We have 24 districts that are divided into five geographical zones. Our area committee is made from elected D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s, nine elected officers, and ten appointed standing committee chairs. Assemblies are held quarterly with pre- and post-Conference assemblies. We have a state Web site and a quarterly newsletter, which is almost entirely electronic. The area conducts service workshops that are held at various locations during the year to inform, encourage, and promote interest and participation in service work at all levels. We celebrate our sobriety in June with an annual convention that moves around the area on a scheduled rotation. We have new groups appearing and our Spanish-speaking groups are growing. The young people of Area 37 are becoming very involved in service and we welcome them and their energy. We took a fearless inventory of our area last fall, resulting in much improved communications and a much needed boost of enthusiasm for service work. I am happy to report that Area 37 is working hard to carry the message of hope to alcoholics, as well as to educate and develop our members as current and future trusted servants. My participation in A.A.'s service structure has provided many opportunities for growth and learning, and I look forward to serving with all of you at this Conference. May we do the best we can for our Fellowship and for Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Doris Sullivan*

Nebraska: Area 41 encompasses 77,421 square miles within the state of Nebraska. There are currently 626 groups and 31 districts, including a Spanish linguistic district carrying Alcoholics Anonymous's message of recovery. Area meetings are currently scheduled in January, March, September, and November, with the Area 41 Reunion usually being held in June. We recently changed the September and November meeting months to August and October. This change will allow increased flexibility in scheduling area meetings, which will improve communication between groups, districts, and area to better serve current and future members of Alcoholics Anonymous. Area 41 is continually discovering and implementing procedures, as well as increasing participation and unity. We schedule "Four-Corner Workshops" within four different corners of our State, which bridge gaps caused by vast distance from east to west (455 miles). These workshops increase availability of recovering alcoholics to area committees, improving both communication and unity. In the fall of odd numbered years we conduct an Area Inventory. This inventory has been helpful in exposing weaknesses within our structure, one of which was a lack of information for new attendees at our area meeting. This information initiated a "First Timers Orientation" meeting at the start of area meetings facilitated by a past delegate. Our service structure has changed within the last six years, adopting a General Service Conference Committee structure. This change has created challenges which have proven to be growing opportunities. Current committee activities include: Web site Committee, looking to improve the content and accessibility to the web page by adding an area ap and usable links; Special Needs and Accessibilities Committee is informing us of the importance of how accessible our meetings are and how to improve accessibility; Public Information is attempting to resolve how the Spanish-speaking community can utilize our hotline; Treatment is busy planning workshops which will focus on the dos and don'ts in treatment facilities across the Area; and the Archives Committee is making plans to submit a possible proposal to host the 2014 National Archives Convention. I want to thank Area 41 for how it prepares its trusted servants for service and for allowing me the opportunity to serve and grow.—*Kit Johnson*

New Brunswick/PEI: Area 81, which covers the provinces of Prince Edward Island and New Brunswick in Canada, has 173 groups and 11 districts, with 18 French groups (the remaining ones are in English). We have two Assembly/Roundups and two Assembly/Sharing Sessions each year and members are very active in activities that spread the A.A. message. Public Information/C.P.C. is involved in schools, hospitals, and Area 81 Corrections and Treatment Committee are involved in jails and treatment centers to help those affected. The Archive Committee has changed to digital and is busy showing our Area 81 history. We now have a Web manager for our area Web site, and the Literature and Grapevine Committees are spreading the A.A. message.—*Jim MacDonald*

New Hampshire: It is with great honor and a deep sense of gratitude that I introduce to you Area 43, the beautiful state of New Hampshire; home to the White Mountains, Hampton Beach, and Lake Winnepesaukee. We are made up of 15 districts and over 600 registered groups, meet as an area committee eight times a year, and hold four quarterly assemblies in various parts of the state. Our assemblies are designed to help the delegate hear the area's conscience on matters that we will be discussing this week, give the delegate an opportunity to report back on our deliberations, to hold elections in odd-numbered years and an area inventory in even-numbered years and, final-

ly, to present workshops related to our General Service Conference theme or matters of import to the members of Area 43. Our annual convention takes place each spring, rotating between the northern and southern tiers every two years. Keynote speakers are asked to present a workshop of interest to them and in keeping with the theme of the convention. This year at our 46th annual convention, our speakers presented the History of A.A., Safety in the Halls, and Emotional Sobriety, to name a few. We are happy to announce that in August of 2011, the Area Assembly voted to expand the functionality of our Web site so that the Fellowship will be able to register for the state convention, purchase A.A. literature and make Seventh Tradition contributions online through a secure site. Young people in New Hampshire A.A. are beginning to step up and take a more active role in both district and area services. Our inventory of 2010 highlighted a need for cooperation with and mentorship of young people in A.A. service who have skills and enthusiasm that can help our area. It is our hope that we can work together towards our common goal of helping the sick and suffering alcoholic in new and ever more creative ways, while also helping young people in service learn how we use our Traditions and Concepts to effectively work together in a spirit of cooperation. I am filled with a great sense of awe at this opportunity to serve A.A. and thank you all for being a part of this journey with me.—*Cheryl Lawson*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45's coverage includes the capital city of Trenton at the northern point and as far south as the historic seashore town of Cape May. We have 522 active groups supporting 587 meetings and serving over 7,100 members in 24 districts. We meet quarterly in a combined Assembly/Committee meeting, which rotates its location throughout the area. Area 45 has a committee devoted entirely to the Hispanic community and that language barrier. Our newly elected panel has just added an Outreach Committee, which will focus its energies on other non-English speaking communities, as well as our Armed Forces members returning home from combat assignments in Iraq and Afghanistan. In the early spring Area 45 holds its annual convention as well as a mini-conference to prepare our delegate for the General Service Conference. We take a fearless inventory of ourselves every other year and are joined with our three intergroups for an annual day of sharing in the fall. The Jelcon committee coordinates our participation with the state Al-Anon Convention, thus honoring the spirit of cooperation with that entity. Our Young People's Committee strives to keep us all "young at heart" with different social activities throughout the year. For a number of years our CTF Committee has hosted an annual inter-area conference, but sensing a change was needed, now holds several workshops within specified districts of Area 45. This was done in hopes of reaching more members who may carry our message to those who are incarcerated. Our Bridging the Gap Committee helps the newly released individuals to make the transition to A.A. meetings outside of their institution. Our C.P.C. Committee often joins with Area 44's C.P.C. Committee to bring the recovery message to statewide conferences for professionals. P.I. works diligently to provide information on what A.A. is and what it is not to the general public. Our Grapevine Committee hosts a bi-yearly Grape Fest to increase awareness of our "meeting in print." Since the initial celebration, this festivity has been well received by Area 45 in the succeeding years. Our Web site and our *Fourth Dimension Newsletter* keep us informed of local events. We in Area 45 welcome you to visit us at anytime, where "Together we have found a substantial remedy for a terrible malady" is the current theme of Area 45.—*Janet Smith-Cook*

New Mexico: New Mexico is often referred to as the missing state, and many Americans are unaware that it is located in the U.S.A. As far as land mass we are the fifth largest state, with a population just under two million. Area 46 serves 420 A.A. groups across 19 districts; two Spanish-speaking districts serve 28 groups. We are a culturally diverse area with significant Native American, Hispanic, and Anglo populations. Our major population area is metro Albuquerque where hundreds of meetings occur weekly. Some groups have attendance above 70 people. Approximately 1/3 of the groups in New Mexico reside in the Albuquerque area. In contrast, there are numerous towns, villages, and pueblos located in remote areas. They may have only one or two meetings a week and, at times, only one person in attendance keeping the door open. Area assemblies are held three times a year, with one area convention held in June. We have 12 area committees which support districts and groups. Area 46 will host the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly for the first time in 22 years this October in Albuquerque. We are using Southwest Regional resources to make SWRAASA 2012 a bilingual assembly. Additionally, we are reaching out to our Spanish-speaking groups, encouraging them to attend and volunteer, remembering that A.A. is a Language of the Heart. Area challenges: Small populations, vast traveling distances between neighboring groups, cultural and language barriers. To overcome we encourage A.A. members to get in the car and visit other groups. Area Assets: We have dedicated G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and other trusted servants willing to travel hundreds of miles to area assemblies, for service, unity, and the love of A.A.—*Alan Spencer*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Area 48, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire, or HMB (as we call it) serves over 770 registered groups and 11,000 listed members in 18 districts. We hold eight area events a year including two voting assemblies on even number years and three on odd numbered years. With the area covering a large geographical area, providing services can be challenging, often requiring extensive travel. Our area committee chairs work closely with their district counterparts to handle this challenge. In August 2011, Hurricane Irene made an uninvited guest appearance over much of our area. When she was done, she had left 18 inches of water in our storage unit, which resulted in about 30% of our archives being destroyed. The Archives Committee, with some help from other A.A. members, rallied and was able to restore what was left. In the restoration process, many of the displays were improved and the cataloging was updated. We are grateful to our A.A. members who have donated items from their collections to replace some of the damaged items. We also acknowledge our archivist at the General Service Office who provided a wealth of shared experience as we tackled the situation. Our C.P.C. Committee is full of enthusiasm, and, in cooperation with the districts, has made contact information available to many of the public schools and other entities. Our Corrections Committee has numerous facilities and a large area to provide for, and is closing in on its goal of providing a meeting to all facilities. The area is reaching out to provide more support to our growing Spanish community. We have enlisted the help of members to translate our area newsletter and make that available to our Spanish-speaking members. In 2011 HMB hosted the New York State Informational Workshop in August and held our own area convention in November. In 2012, we are privileged to host the Northeast Regional A.A. Service Assembly (NERAASA) in March and the 43rd New York State Convention in July; both in Albany. I am incredibly honored to work side by side with such dedicated members of our Fellowship and to serve HMB, Area 48, and Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole.—*Keith Domack*

New York (Western): Area 50, Western New York, is bordered on the north by Lake Erie, on the west and south by Pennsylvania, and on the east roughly halfway between Buffalo and Rochester. We have 364 registered groups and over 500 meetings in 22 districts serving nearly 6,000 members. There are eight standing committees serving the Fellowship. Our P.I. Committee hosts a booth at the Erie County Fair, where over one million attendees have the opportunity to learn about Alcoholics Anonymous. Our committees cooperate with the three active intergroups and one central office in the area, particularly in Treatment and Corrections. Our assembly will meet six times this year for business. In alternate years, there is an additional Election Assembly in September. We recently began hosting pre- and post-Conference Workshops rotating the events through different districts to encourage participation. This year the pre-Conference Workshop was held in Niagara Falls during the Cataract City Convention in March. The post-Conference Workshop will take place in mid-May. The area has recently been making changes to reflect issues brought up in inventory. An ad-hoc committee sorted through years of updates and changes, finally presenting a comprehensive set of guidelines which was accepted by the assembly. One of the highlights is that the area now funds all committee chairs to attend NERAASA (the Northeast Regional A.A. Service Assembly). Additionally, we went through a multi-year redistricting process that is increasing participation in our dark districts. Area 50, in cooperation with the other three areas in New York, participates in statewide events. These rotate through the areas and usually use the current year's Conference theme as the topic. In July, the New York State Convention will be held in Albany. The New York State Informational Workshop, held in Niagara Falls this year, takes place the third weekend in August. With our focus on helping the still sick and suffering alcoholic, it is a privilege for me to represent the dedicated servants in Western New York at the General Service Conference.—*Mike Donnelly*

Ohio (Northwest): Area 55 currently covers 17 districts in Northwest Ohio and Monroe County Michigan. Toledo is the hub of activity in Area 55, which is located near the southwestern shore of Lake Erie. Our boundaries are Monroe, Michigan to the north, Lima, Ohio to the south, Sandusky, Ohio to the east, and the Ohio/Indiana state border to the west. Our area includes over 4,500 members in 17 districts, 350 groups, and over 500 meetings a week. General Service Area 55 contains two intergroup associations. The Toledo Intergroup Committee finances the central office, along with donations from the groups and sales of Conference-approved literature only. Our area general service cooperates with the central office well. Area 55 has seven living past delegates who are frequently asked for their experience, strength, and hope. Area 55 has six standing committees. We currently hold monthly assembly meetings in downtown Toledo. Our committee responsibilities are year-round and our area meets monthly year-round. Our State Convention rotates between the four areas in Ohio, with Area 55 being the most recent host. We had over 550 registrants, which was a record for the last 10 years. The Area 55 Archives Committee is in its tenth year of a preservation project to record the history of our "long timers" and is also currently working on an Archives display to be located in our central office. We recently had our area district committee member elections and filled eight districts that were previously dark. A goal over the next two years is for the area to increase participation of all of our districts, along with a possible re-districting, which would add additional districts. As always, our goals are to foster unity between the intergroup association and general service, grow and remain responsive to change so

we may be of maximum service to those we serve and those yet to come to our Fellowship.—*Bob Swindaman*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56, Southwest Ohio, consists of 29 districts with approximately 500 active registered groups and at least 400 more meetings. Our area covers 15 counties and includes the cities of Cincinnati and Dayton. Both cities have active and effective intergroups serving the large majority of our area groups and meetings. Every year Area 56 hosts six assemblies, four committee meetings, and a Unity Day where we invite members from our intergroups and districts to share on successes and failures in helping the alcoholic via each committee's focus. We are challenged by having only six active districts. In the last year we have been successful in relighting one dark district and we have hopes of lighting another this year. We have recently seen a few starts in Spanish-speaking groups in both of our major cities. Ohio has four delegate areas with a great history of working together. Each Ohio area hosts a mini-conference in March and all of our delegates attend all four mini-conferences to more completely prepare us all for the General Service Conference. Area 56 has eight service committees, with three focused on serving the area and the remaining five actively working on carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Outreach is a coordination challenge, attempting to serve localities and institutions not reached by our local intergroups or various district committees. Here, again, our Unity Day Meeting gives all a chance to establish the communications necessary to prevent service overlaps and vacancies throughout our area. Area 56 is blessed with the continued presence and assistance of many past delegates who help me (and the area) continue to work towards our spiritual goals and to remember that every action we take is to follow our Primary Purpose and to be guided by our Steps, Traditions, and Concepts. I am truly blessed and humbled to be asked to serve my fellow alcoholics as we "trudge the Road of Happy Destiny."—*Mark Everett*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 includes over 11,000 alcoholics in recovery, belonging to 517 active groups, divided into 23 districts, and covering an area of approximately 100,000 square kilometers or slightly over 60,000 square miles. The area holds two assemblies per year, one of which is a pre-Conference assembly together with three area committee meetings in the even years and four in the odd years. As the area does not have any boarders that touch on the remote northern Canadian communities, we do provide a supportive role and participate with other Canadian areas and Alaska in an Inter-Area Remote Communities Work Group dealing with assistance to the communities in the far north. Along with the other nine areas in the Eastern Canada Region, we participated in the creation of the Canadian Eastern Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (CERAASA) which will hold the first Service Assembly in Area 87 on the last weekend of February 2013. Area 86, with its joint partner Area 83 (Eastern Ontario), has created a Unity Information Day, which has been held in the odd years from and including 2007 with the special guests for this event being Leonard Blumenthal, trustee emeritus, in 2007, Phyllis H., general manager for G.S.O. in 2009, and the Very Reverend Ward Ewing, chairman of the General Service Board, in 2011. The four areas in Ontario also meet once per year to hold an Ontario Delegates Committee Meeting prior to the Conference with the aim to assist the incoming area delegates and alternate delegates in familiarizing themselves with the Conference format. This year the area will also be hosting the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in St. Catharines, July 6–8. Everyone is welcome, the more the merrier. I want to thank you all for the priv-

ilege of serving the Fellowship and for being able to continue to be of assistance in carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Percy Graves*

Oregon: Oregon, Area 58, is comprised of 37 districts, including three linguistic Spanish-speaking districts that are very active. Thirteen of our districts are in the Portland metro-area. We have just over a thousand listed A.A. groups, and a membership count of roughly 20,000. Our area has four assemblies a year plus an annual "Orientation" day, which is essentially an area service, and D.C.M. School. Our Area Committee is comprised of the 37 D.C.M.s, 11 standing service committees, and eight elected area officers. Our assemblies have a busy agenda, running from Friday evening through Sunday afternoon, and the G.S.R.s are custodially involved in everything we do in our area, which we feel helps contribute to the unity we enjoy. We continue to tinker with our pre-Conference process that we revamped four years ago. We randomly assign districts to Conference committees to help prepare our delegate for the Conference. Each district receives the agenda and background material, and has about two months to gather feedback at the district and group levels. A large number of districts are assigned to the committee the delegate serves on. This year, we added a cartoon star next to agenda items that the general membership may find especially interesting. This helped keep the process attractive to the not-so-service-geeky folks! Oregon Area is active in our region, and participates in PRAASA (Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly) and our Pacific Regional Forums whenever and wherever they occur. We also have a long-standing history of participating in the Pacific Northwest Conference. This service-based event has been continuing since 1948. Thank you for this opportunity to tell you a little bit about our area and its members; if you are ever passing through Oregon, stop by for a visit.—*Chase Browning*

Puerto Rico: Area 77, Puerto Rico, is composed of 120 groups and is divided into nine districts. The language of the area is Spanish; we have five English-speaking groups, and some groups have meetings in English. We have an office that provides services to all groups, especially the Twelfth Step. The messages are channeled from the office and the services that are directed towards groups and districts; these services include Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and other special services. Literature is distributed from the office through the literature coordinator. The area committee meets monthly as well as district committees. The area holds an annual meeting for budget approval and every two years for service elections. The Area Committee supports several activities annually which are run by the districts on a rotational basis. These include the convention and service seminars; both are three-day-long events. There is also an event of fraternization with all members and their relatives, held during the summer. Groups and districts sponsor recovery workshops and services throughout the year. The area is working on strengthening groups and districts to carry the message to all alcoholics of the area. I thank my higher power for the opportunity that Area 77 has given me to be their delegate and the honor of participating in the 62nd General Service Conference.—*Oscar Rivera*

Québec (Northwest): I am proud to represent this beautiful area, Northwest Québec. Area 90 extends from Ottawa, Ontario for French groups in the western part of Québec, to Joliette to the East, from the Metropolitan Boulevard in Montreal in the South to the 80th parallel in the North. By the way, June 24–26, 2011, the first Alcoholics Anonymous Roundup of Arctic Eastern

Canada, was held; the theme was Survival. The 90-27 District hosted this conference in Inuktitut and English. We have a total of 366 groups in 24 active districts. We have six committees: Correctional Facilities, Public Information, Treatment Centers, Special Needs and Accessibility, La Vigne AA (French-language magazine similar to the Grapevine), *The Heritage* (a newsletter covering news from the area,) and Literature. We have four work groups: Archives, Remote Communities, Information sessions, and Web site. We hold six regional committee meetings a year, two general assembly meetings, and a welcome meeting for new servants.—*Gilles Flynn*

Québec (Southwest): I have the privilege to serve in a very dynamic and diversified area. Although the smallest province geographically, Area 87 enjoys the highest membership of over 12,700, 530 registered groups, and 28 districts (20 of them are French, seven are English, and one is Spanish). They hold over 600 meetings every week in our territory. There are about 50 meetings held in correction or treatment centers. Our area is bilingual (French and English) but our Web site also provides information in Spanish, making it trilingual. Our Area Service Office employs two excellent and competent employees. Our 14 service committees are very busy carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. We've offered monthly information seminars about the A.A. structure since 1991. We hold four assemblies and seven area committee meetings every year. The steering committee participates in three provincial meetings yearly. The four delegates from Québec are part of the La Vigne board of administrators, our French bimonthly magazine which has been printed since 1965. Area 87 will be the host of the first Canadian Eastern Region A.A. Service Assembly (CERAASA) in 2013. I thank Area 87 members for giving me the opportunity to live this spiritual experience and to serve the whole of A.A. as a delegate.—*Pierre Couture*

Rhode Island: At just over 1,000 square miles, we are the smallest state in the Union, yet boast the longest official name, which is: The State of Rhode Island and Providence Plantations. Our nickname is "the Ocean State" and our motto is "Hope." In my humble opinion, Rhode Island's most significant A.A. connection is as the birthplace and home of Rowland H., who introduced Ebbie T. to the Oxford Group, sobering him up long enough to spark Bill Wilson's journey in sobriety and ultimately providing "hope" for alcoholics worldwide. We have eight districts, seven geographical and one Spanish-speaking. There are no dark districts, although we do go through periods where some districts have limited participation in the business of the area. We have six standing committees: Archives, Grapevine, Corrections, CPC/PI, Special Needs, and Treatment. We also have two special committees. Our Roundup Committee puts on a one-day service oriented event, which includes workshops, speakers and a fabulous lunch. Our Convention Committee puts on our annual three-day "alcapalooza," held by beautiful Narragansett Bay, in Newport. Our area officers, district committee members, and voting committee chairs meet monthly and are joined by our G.S.R.s and other interested parties at quarterly area assemblies. Milestones include relocating our offices to a larger, more centrally located space, and successfully filing for and receiving 501 c 3 nonprofit status from the IRS. We have an active A.A. community with approximately 275 registered groups and close to 500 meetings. Alcoholics Anonymous is alive and well in Area 61. We are not a glum lot, so if you are in the area, drop in on any of our many meetings and join us as we trudge the road of happy destiny.—*Patricia Moody*

South Carolina: The state of South Carolina, Area 62, lists 384 active groups, of which 60% are represented by a G.S.R. at one or more of three assemblies each year. Our Area Committee also meets three times to plan the budget, update agendas, and share hugs. Thirteen chairpersons and service committee representatives from 23 districts convene during assembly weekends to coordinate activities. Corrections and Web site are the largest and most dynamic of these, but all assure that the A.A. message is available and accessible. This year, area62.org celebrates 13 years online as a paragon of digital recovery information, not only for those looking for a meeting in South Carolina, but also for opportunities and resources for general service. Electronic messaging between assemblies keeps communication channels open all year. Our Web coordinator posts minutes in a protected directory and transmits them to members' e-mail inboxes, smartphones, or tablets by request. Although available online as a PDF, the Area 62 newsletter is still issued on paper. Copies can be found in the hands of members in A.A. halls and prison cells who don't have, need, or want a computer. Unfortunately, after three years, our Spanish linguistic district foundered and went inactive. But the geographic home districts of twelve Spanish-speaking groups welcomed them back and promised to serve their needs locally. South Carolinians study the Concepts and defend the Traditions with passion, and thereby assure that still-suffering alcoholics seeking a way out can find the solution offered by Alcoholics Anonymous. Communication and participation in workshops and committees and conferences—from the upstate foothills, across the piedmont of the midlands to the coastal plain and barrier islands—generate the energy, unity, and enthusiasm to face the inevitable challenges to an organization such as ours in times like these. In service with love, or is it in love with service?—*Cyndi Foltrich*

South Dakota: Area 63, South Dakota, has four area gatherings each year. We implemented the committee system approximately six years ago and are beginning to see benefits in how our committees function and oversee the process of our area business. Like every area, Area 63 has issues of functionality. We discuss how we can better carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. We debate signing court cards, we hate when the group treasurer drinks up the prudent reserve, we wonder how to encourage more participation in service, and we attempt to educate on the relevance of the connection between the group, district, area, and General Service Office. Even with struggles, Area 63 offers a strong fellowship among those who participate in service. Area 63 is concerned about the future of A.A. and the ultimate message that A.A. offers to the still-suffering alcoholic. We struggle, at times, to understand the interaction between our group conscience and the final actions of the General Service Conference, as well as the actions of the board of trustees. Our group conscience is typically against the expansion of literature, instead voicing a desire that the literature we currently have be utilized. We discuss our singleness of purpose in dealing with alcoholism and usually we reject the idea of fracturing the message to serve smaller groups of members within A.A., seemingly aligned by culture, gender, personality traits, profession or race. We are people defined by rugged individualism. We believe in the power of personal involvement and we love both sobriety and old-fashioned Twelfth Step work. Our members believe that A.A. is "their" Fellowship and they avoid, like the plague, political lobbying tactics. We believe we serve under the direction of a loving and caring Higher Power and that our sobriety is the result of His grace rather than our cleverness. On behalf of Area 63, thank you for allowing me to share my area highlights and for allowing us to participate in the 2012 General Service Conference.—*Christopher Doyle*

Tennessee: Area 64 encompasses the state of Tennessee, plus one meeting in Alabama and three in Virginia. Our lowest elevation is 178 feet above sea level at the Mississippi River. Our highest elevation is 6,643 feet above sea level in the Great Smokey Mountains. Between these two points we have approximately 542 registered groups, located in 41 Districts, three of which are Hispanic. We hold four assemblies during the year, and usually a state convention. Our voting assembly is always held in the center of the state to allow the greatest amount of participation. Our six standing committees meet twice during each weekend assembly. Archives: We have a stand-alone archives facility located midstate and staffed to serve our history respectfully. Corrections: Our committee maintains a database that includes our participants as well as the Correctional Facilities contacts. Cooperation With the Professional Community: We use PowerPoint presentations along with traditional workshops to provide information to our members as well as the medical and legal community. Grapevine: Representatives are busy throughout our area conducting Grape-A-Thons and recycling past copies. Public Information: Our East, Central, and West state coordinators conduct workshops and respond to requests. Treatment: We support A.A. meetings in the majority of Treatment Facilities. Bridging the Gap is an ongoing endeavor with both Treatment and Corrections. At our assemblies we are fortunate to have a number of active past delegates. They are a wealth of information. I am pleased and honored to serve for an area dedicated to preserving our three legacies and the future of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Jay Decker*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66, Northwest Texas, has 210 groups carrying the message of recovery through the Big Book of Alcoholics Anonymous. These groups are served by 11 districts. Our Spanish-speaking members are served by three of those districts. Our area is boundaried by the top of the panhandle of Texas, down south to the Rio Grande River, and westward to El Paso. This encompasses 95,000 square miles, including 81 counties. The cities of Amarillo, Lubbock, San Angelo, Midland, and El Paso sport the largest populations. Our area assemblies and mini-forums are generally rotated through these cities and hosted by the districts. We usually have around 50-60 members attending our area assemblies. Some of our standing committees stay active while others are currently being re-commissioned to participation. Given the wide span of geographical coverage, Area 66 is blessed to be making efficient use of the Web site technology to tie us together. Each district has access to operate its own Web site under the NWTAA66.org umbrella. The A.A. meetings section of this Web site is kept up-to-date with all of the meetings in the area. This Web site meetings location includes a map to the meeting. Our Web site also has protected file storage areas for the committees, districts, and officers, including the delegate, to use for the convenient and efficient distribution of information as needed. Area 66, our districts, and our groups are a great place to serve Alcoholics Anonymous by carrying the message to A.A. members and those still suffering out there. We are wonderfully guided by the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, the Twelve Concepts, and the rich heritage of those dedicated and loving servants who have gone before us.—*Roger Schelling*

Texas (Southwest): Southwest Texas, Area 68, currently has 563 registered groups in 33 districts, seven of which serve our Spanish-speaking groups. Our area meets quarterly on a rotating basis for two business assemblies and two workshops. We have seven active standing committees: Archives, Bilingual, Corrections, Grapevine/LaViña, Newsletter, P.I./C.P.C. and

Treatment. Our Spanish members are able to fully participate because of our active bilingual committee. We translate all of our minutes, agendas, newsletters and flyers. To help promote understanding and cooperation with professionals, our area holds a Corrections Conference and a P.I./C.P.C. Conference on an annual basis, rotating throughout the area. Area 68 also conducts an inventory every odd numbered year at the July workshop. Our area is looking forward to hosting the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in 2014 in Corpus Christi, Texas, also known as "the Sparkling City by the Sea." We are blessed to have several past delegates who continue to serve the area and share their experience. Thank you, Area 68, for the privilege of serving you as your delegate and A.A. as a whole.—*Pam Jurica*

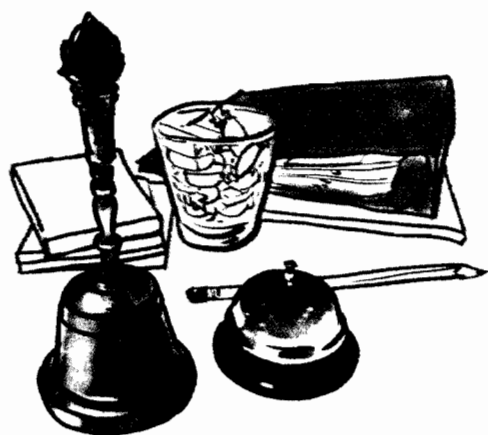
Vermont: Area 70, Vermont, has 11 districts serving 4,305 members in 260 groups. Our districts bid to host our four quarterly full area assemblies, which are rotated around the state. The afternoon assembly is preceded by a morning service structure workshop, committee meetings, and lunch. Our area committee meets seven times a year at a central location. The delegate also hosts a day-long pre-Conference sharing session where the area develops a group conscience regarding the agenda items to be discussed at the General Service Conference. Area 70 has 10 standing committees: Archives, Convention, Corrections, Finance, Grapevine/Literature, Meeting Lists, PI/CPC, Registrar, Service Structure, and Treatment. The Web site is a subcommittee of PI/CPC, and also works closely with the Meeting List Committee. One of the great strengths of Vermonters is our self-sufficiency, born of the challenge of geographical barriers to statewide travel. Our District 3, the Northeast Kingdom at the corner of the state, is divided by mountains. At the northwest corner, in Grand Isle County, four of five towns are on islands in Lake Champlain. In late August 2011, Hurricane Irene further divided the state by severely damaging more than 500 miles of state highway, including approximately 200 state bridges and nearly 700 homes. I have already been reminded, as a Panel 62 delegate, that "Rule 62" also applies and that "we are not a glum lot." Thank you for the opportunity to serve both A.A. as a whole and Area 70 Vermont.—*Michael Hansen*

Washington State (East): I am passing on warm greetings from Washington State East, Area 92. Our area is quite large, taking up to seven hours of driving time to travel from one district to another. Our area boundaries include parts of British Columbia, Canada, Northwestern Montana, the panhandle of Idaho, a piece of Oregon, and all of Eastern Washington from the Cascade mountain range. We have 26 districts with four of them being nongeographic Hispanic districts. This comprises over 4,000 members in more than 400 groups. We have two assemblies and two quarterlies each year and conduct them in English with simultaneous translation into Spanish. Additionally, we have four combined quarterly workshops for all of our standing committees. In September 2011 we hosted a Local Forum with the theme of "Carrying A.A.'s Message across Cultural and Language Boundaries." Eva S., from G.S.O., and Rod B., Pacific Regional trustee, attended and participated in the panels. Their contribution was not only appreciated, but also significantly added to the success. This was a wonderfully informative and spiritual event. Annually, we host, with Oregon Area 58, the PNC (Pacific Northwest Conference), the longest running conference in A.A. (this began in 1948). This year, on the 28th and 29th of July, we are hosting the 16th Anniversary of the La Viña Convention in Ellensburg, Washington. Additionally, we participate with Area 72, Western Washington, in the annual Washington State Hispanic Convention. Our service committees are very active in

all our districts, providing information and assistance to institutions and communities. I am excited, honored, and humbled to be serving Area 92 and especially, with all of you in this, the 62nd General Service Conference!—*Jeff Saunders*

Wisconsin (Northern/Upper Peninsula of Michigan): Area 74 is a mostly rural area including the Northern half of Wisconsin and most of the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. We have 24 districts and 599 registered groups covering an area of about 350 miles north to south and 475 miles east to west. Our area service structure includes our area officers and 12 standing committees. We have two standing committees for Corrections — one overseeing service for each state. Our Webmaster services are part of the Public Information Committee. Beginning in 2012 we are moving to a four-assembly structure, having two assemblies incorporated into our spring and fall Area Conferences. Conferences are now including area committee meetings and assemblies, bringing more service information to the members. We also conduct a one-day annual Corrections Conference jointly with Area 75, alternating locations between the areas each year. Area financial resources remain low in numbers of groups supporting the area service, and we are examining ways to be most effective with our funding. Approximately 31% of our area groups contribute financially to the area service structure. We have a committee in place for the 2013 East Central Regional Conference, which we will be hosting in Appleton, Wisconsin. I am proud to say we have a strong participation level of past delegates at our area service assemblies; our past delegates have a voice and vote at assemblies. With this year's rotation of district D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s we have several districts inactive at the Area business meetings. We will continue to offer support to attract greater service at the district and home group levels. I am proud and humbled to be serving our Area 74 to continue to support the future of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Marty Laakso*

Wyoming: Area 76 covers the state of Wyoming, the least populated and 10th largest of the 50 states. Twelve districts are represented with approximately 125 groups. We hold two business assemblies (winter and summer) and two conventions (fall and spring). Locations are rotated throughout the state. In addition, local and district events occur over the year. Information is available on our Web site www.area76wyaa.org. If you come to visit us be sure to be prepared for a lot of "windshield" time. Most towns are about 100 miles apart.—*Greg Boone*



■ Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee considered the request from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and agreed to reduce the number of presentation/discussion topics for the 2013 General Service Conference to allow scheduling for the 2013 Conference Inventory process approved by the 2011 G.S.C.
- The committee also noted that for the General Service Conferences in 2013, 2014 and 2015, there will be no solicitation for Workshop topics since the Conference Plan specifies that the time allotted for Conference Workshops during Conference week will be replaced with Inventory Group meetings to discuss Inventory questions.
- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the Pre-Conference section of the Evaluation be separated from the Sunday section of the form.

ARCHIVES'

- The committee reviewed the request for changes to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Archives Committee and took no action. It was the sense of the committee that the requested changes were not necessary.
- The committee reviewed the changes to the Archives Workbook and suggested one minor editorial change in the "Shared Experiences" section.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee develop a new section in the Archives Workbook on digitizing archival collections intended to provide guidance to local archivists and archives committees responsible for maintaining Area or District archival collections.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed the report on replacing the current "A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community" DVD with a new compilation DVD that includes existing material and reviewed the draft product of the replacement DVD.

The committee accepted the report and felt that a new compilation DVD was not needed for some of the following reasons:

- a. The list of suggested existing materials seemed limited and was already available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site.
 - b. When communicating with professionals, it is often most helpful to have material that is specific to a particular profession.
 - c. In the contemporary, ever-changing digital age, the DVD format might not be appropriate for the distribution of information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee noted that the A.A.W.S. Board has oversight of

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site Redesign Committee and requested that A.A.W.S. consider dedicating a portion of the Web site to making A.A. resources easily accessible to targeted professional populations and C.P.C. Committees.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee Kit and Workbook and made several suggestions:

- a. The sentence on page 15, which reads: "Open: Guests are welcome; if practical, mention that individual members are available to take a professional friend to a meeting" be changed to read "Open: Guests are welcome as observers; if practical, mention that individual members are available to take a professional friend to a meeting."
- b. The revised text in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section in the C.P.C. pamphlets "A.A. in Your Community," "If You Are A Professional" and "Members of the Clergy ask about Alcoholics Anonymous" replace the current text in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section on page 29 of the C.P.C. Workbook.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the work of the trustees' Committee on Corrections with regards to the Corrections Kit and Workbook, and forwarded a list of suggested changes in the Workbook to the Publications Department.

FINANCE

- The committee suggested that a review of the delegate's fee be a standing item on the Conference Finance Committee agenda.
- The committee reviewed a proposed Self-Support Kit and agreed that the F-19 Self-Support Packet is sufficient service material and suggested adding "Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S." (SMF-176) to the Self-Support Packet.
- The committee reviewed and acknowledged the 21 Self-Support Talking Points presented in the background for use by the Fellowship and offers one additional point to be included: "What is the value of your sobriety?" The committee also suggested that they be added to the Finance Section of the Web site.
- The committee suggested the following statements be added to the back of the F-42 Self-Support green card:

What is the value of your sobriety?

- Less than 44 % of groups contribute to the General Service Board.
- Costs of Services provided by G.S.O. are \$6.32 per member per year.
- Sales of A.A. literature account for 56 % of our income.
- You can easily contribute regularly online at AA.org.
- Give till it feels good.
- The committee reviewed the information presented concerning financial projections for 2013 and 2014 and trusts that the Corporate Boards and the trustees' Finance Committee will deal with the financial issues in an appropriate manner.

The committee also expressed that increasing the awareness of the need for Fellowship contributions is the more spiritual way to address the funding issue.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed with the proposal to update, proofread, and digitize the Grapevine Workbook. The revised workbook will be available on the Grapevine Web site for downloading. The workbook will no longer be printed. Note: The cost of this project is estimated to be \$5,000.

- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2013 or later:

1. Attitude of Gratitude (working title)
A collection of stories on the topic of gratitude previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
2. Voices of Long Term Sobriety II (working title)
A collection of stories by members with 30+ years of sobriety previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
3. Women's Stories in AA (working title)
Stories from women members on every topic including a special section from A.A.'s women pioneers previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
4. GLBT in AA — We are all the same or Sober & Out (working title)
A collection of stories from the Gay, Lesbian, Bisexual and Transgender A.A. community previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
5. Relationships in Sobriety (working title)
A collection of stories on the topic of relationships previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
6. Having Fun in Sobriety (working title)
Now that you're sober you've discovered that you haven't the foggiest notion on how to have fun. What now? Stories from members having fun in sobriety from stories previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
7. Daily Grapevine
365 inspirational passages as originally published in GV's thought of the day in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
8. Mid Sobriety Crisis (working title)
Not a beginner anymore and not an oldtimer? This collection of stories comes from members in the middle years (10-29) who are working the program and trudging the road to happy destiny previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
9. The Best of La Viña II
Collection of Spanish language original stories (not translations) previously published in La Viña magazine.
10. AA Inside the Walls (working title)
A collection of stories from those behind bars and/or from those carrying the message to these institutions previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.

- The committee considered incorporating the service responsibilities and duties of the service position "Grapevine Representative" in the service responsibilities and duties of the "General Service Representative" and took no action.

- The committee requested that the AA Grapevine Board incorporate into all appropriate literature the 1962 Advisory Action that: "retiring delegates become Grapevine Representatives (GvRs) in their areas, with the objective of a GvR in each group."

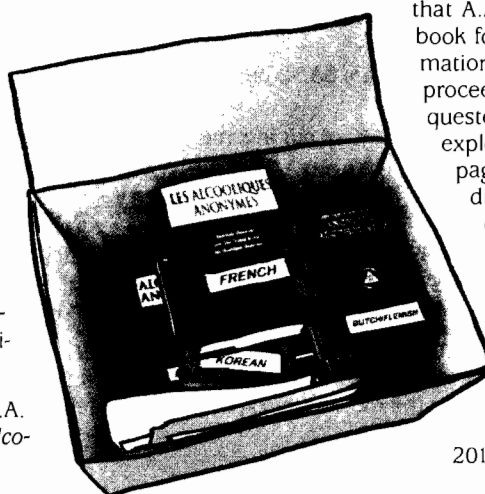
- The committee requested that groups that do not have a GvR or RLV consider incorporating these duties into the duties of the GSR.
- The committee requested that the AA Grapevine Board look into the feasibility of producing one book in ASL format.
- The committee requested that the AA Grapevine Board provide a report to the 2013 Conference Committee on the Grapevine as background, on the cost of reformatting Grapevine magazine from its current design to black/white interior, non-glossy, minimal photos and increase the font size.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed and reviewed the 2025 International Convention Site-Selection Procedures.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and shared some experiences that have helped increase member participation in recent Regional Forums in their regions. These included:
 - Delegate and Area officers' participation helped increase interest in Regional Forums.
 - Online Regional Forum registration/information on www.aa.org is convenient and easily accessible.
 - One Area started workshops on Regional Forums at local service events to provide information and create enthusiasm.
 - One host committee extended committee membership to other Areas in the region and to members from different cities throughout their own Areas.
 - One committee member suggested including an article in the Grapevine with the Regional Forum schedule or from a member about their Regional Forum experience.
 - It helps to let members know you don't have to be in General Service to attend and enjoy a Regional Forum.
 - One Area took ownership of their Regional Forum hospitality committee to create enthusiasm and generate greater participation.
 - Talk and continue to talk about Regional Forums and explain what Regional Forums are all about.
 - When there are travel challenges look for creative/alternative ways to travel.
 - Suggest combining a trip to a Regional Forum with your vacation plans.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Literature on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are sober in Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Literature, as requested, input and suggestions, and requested a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed a request to add text from the dust jacket of the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, to the dust jacket of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book and took no action.
- The committee considered a request to add the "A.A. Preamble" to the front inside pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and took no action.

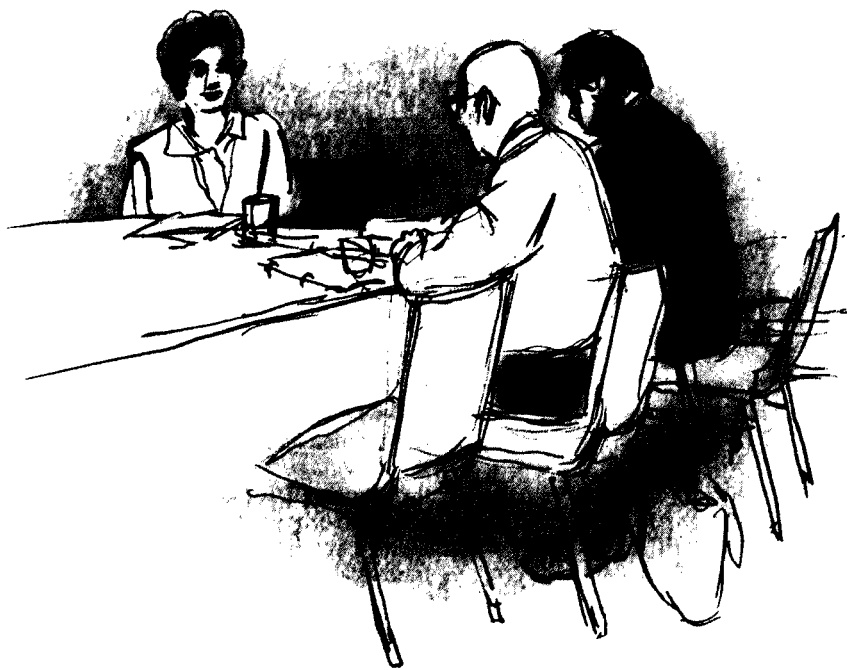


POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee considered modifying the procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference and took no action. They agreed that the policy approved by the 2011 General Service Conference sufficiently provides a process for the "Right of Appeal" as described in Concept V — the procedure allows for a "well-heard minority" to be a "chief protection against an uninformed, misinformed, hasty or angry majority," and it makes the "best possible use of minority feeling and opinion."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference review the role of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions in granting international observers admission to the General Service Conference, taking into account the concerns expressed by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions, and provide a report to the 2013 Conference Committee. The Conference committee agreed that their recommendation for approval of observers seems redundant, and this approval could appear to be a "rubber stamp" of the trustees' action, as cautioned against in Concept VII.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference review the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the General Service Conference" on an ongoing basis and forward any updates to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for their review.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the report of the Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee from the trustees' Public Information Committee, and expressed their support for the continued development of the media plan.
- Following lengthy and thoughtful discussion related to adding language referring to current media to Tradition Eleven, the committee concluded that the spirit and principle of anonymity at the public level is conveyed adequately in the Long Form of Tradition Eleven. Recognizing that suggested changes to Tradition Eleven have come to the Conference several times, the committee requested the trustees' Public Information Committee gather Area sharing on the effectiveness of the language of the Short Form of Tradition Eleven in addressing the needs of the Fellowship today and report back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee considered favorably the suggestion from the trustees' Public Information Committee that A.A. establish a presence on Facebook for the purpose of providing information about A.A. to the public. Before proceeding, however, the committee requested that the General Service Board explore all aspects of this social media page and, if feasible within our Traditions, provide the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information an implementation plan that addresses the implications of such a page, including sample content and estimates for implementation cost and maintenance.
- The committee reviewed the 2011 Annual Report from the trustees'



Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the detailed information provided and the thoughtful consideration given to all items involving the Web site.

- The committee reviewed the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "My World" public service announcement.
- The committee reviewed all of the current A.A. TV public service announcements and agreed with the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee that found them all to be relevant and useful.
- The committee assessed the need for a new A.A. TV public service announcement and agreed with the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee that none was needed at this time.
- The committee considered the proposed alternative packaging for the Public Information Kit and suggested that the Publications Department continue to explore options for alternative packaging that is durable, allows for organization and containment of the kit materials.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publications Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2012-2013 Edition, and the 2012 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A. Grapevine Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Char-

ter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.

- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the General Service Board for *The A.A. Service Manual*.

Note: The committee agreed to ask the General Service Board to reconsider two changes that had been forwarded by the General Service Board.

- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial updates for *The A.A. Service Manual* and forwarded them to the Publications Department.
- The committee considered a suggestion for revising text on "Conference Panels," on page S107, to clarify what is meant by the term "panels," and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

- The committee considered a request to add a section on the "spirit of rotation" and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed suggested changes to the Conference Charter that were requested from the General Service Board and took no action. The committee asked that the General Service Board reconsider the 2011 Advisory Action regarding the Conference Charter, and develop text that explicitly addresses the principles of participation, petition and appeal for consideration by the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee briefly discussed the A.A. Directories and noted that there were no requests for changes to the A.A. Directories.
- The committee briefly discussed the General Service Conference *Final Report* and noted that there were no requests for changes to the *Final Report*.

TREATMENT/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee expressed concerns about the French and Spanish translations of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* regarding the exact translation of the direct quote read from the translated Big Books and for background distraction in the videos. The committee asked the Publications Department to review these items and report back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Workbook and Kit and suggested minor editorial changes to the service piece "A.A. Temporary Contact/Bridging the Gap Request" and removed redundant information in the Kit. Following these minor changes the committee found the Workbook and Kit to be satisfactory for use by local committees.



FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the current \$3,000 dollar limit on annual individual contributions and recommended that the annual limit on contributions be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000.
- The committee reviewed the current \$3,000 dollar limit one time bequests and recommended that the limit on one-time bequests be increased from \$3,000 to \$25,000.
- The Conference Finance Committee reviewed the background presented and past Conference actions and recommended that La Viña become self-supporting within three years beginning January 1, 2013. If La Viña has not become self-supporting by December 31, 2015, General Service Board funding will cease.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee reviewed the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* and recommended that one line of dialog, "Uncle Sam is not gonna come in and bail us out" be removed the next time it is reprinted at a cost of approximately \$9,000.00.
- The committee recommended that the pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic With Special Needs" be expanded to include additional stories of alcoholics with mental illness collected from the Fellowship, and that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Need-Accessibilities bring a progress report or draft pamphlet to the 2013 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B Trustee candidates for the West Central and Western Canada Regions.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the report from the trustees' Committee on Nominating on the Impact of the Conference Disapproving a Recommended Slate noting that, as requested, the report solely addressed the admission of slates; the committee recognizes that the General Service Conference has additional authority related to the General Service Board not commented upon in the report.
- The committee strongly suggested that the practice of including the operating corporation board slates (A.A.W.S. and Grapevine) on the General Service Conference agenda be continued.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

CORRECTIONS

- The committee recommended that the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," be remade in order to accurately reflect current-day life in correctional facilities, while retaining the original message and intent consistent with A.A. Traditions, at a cost not to exceed \$75,000.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- Request to develop a pamphlet for the Alcoholic with Mental Illness. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- To change the question: (1) what more could be done to insure the General Service Board remains transparent and thorough in their reporting to the Fellowship concerning financial condition? 2013 Section G Question #3 **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- GSC recommends that the General Service Board form a sub-committee comprised of all stakeholders to develop a plan to address publication, distribution and finances of La Viña with the objective of self-support by 12/31/15. **(Not approved)**
- That the trustees' Committee on Literature develop a pamphlet for the alcoholic with mental illness, with a progress report to be provided to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature with suggestions for content of the pamphlet, including breadth and scope of the pamphlet. **(Not approved)**
- That the pamphlet "A.A. and The Armed Services" include the subtitle "none left behind." **(Not approved)**
- This body form an A.A.W.S. Committee to allow this motion to be heard by a committee before coming to the floor for approval. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 2011 (with comparative totals for 2010)

	General Service Board of A.A.								
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2011	Consolidated 2010
ASSETS									
Cash	\$ 1,120,504	\$ 646,261		\$ 102,884		\$ 1,224,064	\$ 209,444	\$ 3,303,157	\$ 5,895,961
Accounts and interest receivable		30,286				196,135	76,862	303,283	323,066
Intercompany balances	(1,253,690)	(1,833,100)				1,247,193	1,839,597	-	-
Inventories									
Books, pamphlets, etc.						1,465,156	253,192	1,718,348	1,708,771
Paper, prepublication costs, etc.						228,343	2,000	230,343	340,732
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)		15,653,474		1,519,632				17,173,106	13,733,317
Property, Equipment and Software (net of accumulated depreciation and amortization of 2011 - \$4,368,394; 2010 - \$4,433,144) (Note 2)			\$ 625,598			483,242	68,238	1,177,078	1,089,975
Deferred charges and deposits	22,406					83,989	56,463	162,858	148,994
Prepaid conventions	171,844							171,844	120,667
Total Assets	<u>61,064</u>	<u>14,496,921</u>	<u>625,598</u>	<u>1,622,516</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>4,928,122</u>	<u>2,505,796</u>	<u>24,240,017</u>	<u>23,361,483</u>
LIABILITIES									
Accounts and accruals payable	\$ -					\$ 444,820	\$ 92,278	\$ 537,098	\$ 842,594
Deferred income - orders and subscriptions, etc.	4,051					12,651	2,042,993	2,059,695	1,940,243
Accrued postretirement health benefits				\$ 5,524,123				5,524,123	4,277,145
Accrued pension benefits					\$ 10,293,757			10,293,757	5,930,399
Total Liabilities	<u>4,051</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>5,524,123</u>	<u>10,293,757</u>	<u>457,471</u>	<u>2,135,271</u>	<u>18,414,673</u>	<u>12,990,381</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>14,496,921</u>	<u>625,598</u>	<u>(3,901,607)</u>	<u>(10,293,757)</u>	<u>4,470,651</u>	<u>370,525</u>	<u>5,825,344</u>	<u>10,371,102</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>61,064</u>	<u>14,496,921</u>	<u>625,598</u>	<u>1,622,516</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>4,928,122</u>	<u>2,505,796</u>	<u>24,240,017</u>	<u>23,361,483</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

Exhibit B

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2011 (with comparative totals for 2010)

	General Service Board of A.A.					A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 2011	Consolidated 2010
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	Grapevine	La Viña	
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE									
Gross Sales						\$ 12,768,845	\$ 2,956,788	\$ 129,323	\$ 15,854,956
Less: Discounts						262,709	-	-	262,709
Net Sales						12,506,136	2,956,788	129,323	15,592,247
Cost of Literature Distributed									
Printing						(2,939,690)	(364,929)	(31,793)	(3,336,412)
Royalties on books						(27,687)	-	-	(27,687)
Direct shipping and warehousing						(1,577,432)	(733,974)	(26,804)	(2,204,255)
Gross Profit from Literature						7,961,327	1,857,885	70,726	9,889,938
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$ 6,264,454								6,264,454
2010 International Convention (Net of direct expenses of \$4,368,105)	-								-
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	169	\$ 128,494		\$ 3,394		486	24,300	-	156,843
Total Income	6,264,623	128,494		3,394		7,961,813	1,882,185	70,726	16,311,235
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)									
Program	5,303,603			-		2,710,727	1,240,323	140,451	9,395,104
Supporting services	3,443,536		\$ 89,371	995,979	\$ (866,414)	1,950,621	619,024	-	6,232,117
Total Expenses	8,747,139	-	89,371	995,979	(866,414)	4,661,348	1,859,347	140,451	15,627,221
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,482,516)	128,494	(89,371)	(992,585)	866,414	3,300,465	22,838	(69,725)	684,014
Change in pension liability - nonoperating	-	-	-	-	(5,229,772)	-	-	-	(5,229,772)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS									
GSB La Viña support	(69,725)	-	-	-	-	-	-	69,725	-
Other transfers	2,552,241	2,500,000	-	-		(5,052,241)	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	2,628,494	(89,371)	(992,585)	(4,363,358)	(1,751,776)	22,838	-	(4,545,758)
NET ASSETS									
Beginning of year	57,013	11,868,427	714,969	(2,909,022)	(5,930,399)	6,222,427	347,687	-	10,371,102
NET ASSETS									
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	14,496,921	625,598	(3,901,607)	(10,293,757)	4,470,651	370,525	-	5,825,344

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2011 (with comparative totals for 2010)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	International Convention	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	La Viña	Supporting Services	2011 Total	2010 Total
Salaries	\$ 699,042	\$ 917,215	\$ 183,727			\$ 159,167	\$ 1,297,652	\$ 515,500	\$ 108,225	\$ 2,364,643	\$ 6,245,171	\$ 6,124,349
Payroll taxes	54,608	69,451	13,339			10,917	100,831	41,519	8,981	176,846	476,492	472,772
Health and group insurance	107,061	137,669	26,792			21,095	200,062	101,758	9,829	562,267	1,166,533	1,064,515
Retirement expense - funding	242,540	309,721	61,245			45,954	451,827	102,284		762,010	1,975,581	1,993,115
Other program printing	252,287	49,114	81,309			15,590				-	398,300	420,899
Mailing labor	101,025	5,365	1,763							-	108,153	129,095
Postage and express	232,674	52,300	37,359			25,679	35,475	3,888		29,848	417,223	443,362
Writers' fees	10,795	33,715	6,560			5,038	650			-	56,758	35,821
Foreign literature assistance		41,692								-	41,692	93,672
Selling expenses	594						256,444	106,717	3,637	38,905	406,297	337,677
Professional fees		208					33			237,087	237,328	287,991
Contracted services	76,241	156,024	32,296			13,472	83,287	150,657	8,385	511,930	1,032,292	1,035,801
Occupancy	101,946	135,439	10,505			5,681	187,236	90,741		375,344	906,892	838,778
Telephone	19,208	20,340	1,940			5,967	14,693	25,114		73,625	160,887	148,043
Equipment maintenance	1,431	7,041	27			26	5,741			81,985	96,251	89,805
Depreciation and amortization	39,900	19,728	2,473			3,810	50,054			56,467	172,432	161,102
Stationery and office supplies	71,388	4,414	8,906			1,738	6,348	51,073		63,404	207,271	227,823
Office service and expense	7,108	10,609	31,751			11,778	13,229	51,072	242	243,717	369,506	344,536
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,481	50,168	624,930			56,831	7,165		1,152	389,440	1,131,167	1,297,637
Bad debts										7,239	7,239	40,371
Delegate fees			(243,604)								(243,604)	(315,343)
Total Operating Expenses	2,019,329	2,020,213	881,318			382,743	2,710,727	1,240,323	140,451	5,974,757	15,369,861	15,271,821
Severance benefits										38,424	38,424	91,764
Postretirement health benefits										995,979	995,979	63,711
Retirement expense adjustment										(866,414)	(866,414)	(824,875)
Capital projects depreciation										89,371	89,371	89,371
Total Expenses	2,019,329	2,020,213	881,318			382,743	2,710,727	1,240,323	140,451	6,232,117	15,627,221	14,691,792
Allocation of supporting services to activities	1,394,474	1,395,084	608,606			264,308	1,950,621	619,024	-	(6,232,117)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	3,413,803	3,415,297	1,489,924			647,051	4,661,348	1,859,347	140,451	-	15,627,221	14,691,792
Services	\$3,413,803	\$3,415,297	\$1,489,924			\$647,051					\$ 8,966,075	\$ 7,970,319
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 4,661,348				4,661,348	4,376,004
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,859,347	\$140,451		1,999,798	2,345,469
											15,627,221	14,691,792
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2010	\$2,866,276	\$2,910,354	\$1,059,115	\$300,383	\$267,676	\$566,515	\$4,376,004	\$2,218,666	\$126,803	-	\$14,691,792	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2011
 (with comparative totals for 2010)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2011</u>	<u>2010</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$(4,545,758)	\$ 2,507,832
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	68,031	(5,909)
Amortization of bond premiums	6,973	21,169
Depreciation and amortizations	267,573	250,473
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	19,783	111,923
Inventories	100,812	226,181
Deferred charges and other assets	(65,041)	599,623
Accounts and accruals payable	(305,496)	367,950
Deferred income	119,452	(2,926,848)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	1,246,978	314,711
Accrued pension benefits	4,363,358	(781,987)
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided by Operating Activities</u>	 <u>1,276,665</u>	 <u>685,118</u>
 FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(354,676)	(201,270)
Proceeds from sales of investments	6,020,183	6,008,570
Purchases of investments	(9,534,976)	(5,859,955)
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used) by Investing Activities</u>	 <u>(3,869,469)</u>	 <u>(52,655)</u>
 Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	 (2,592,804)	 632,463
Cash, beginning of year	<u>5,895,961</u>	<u>5,263,498</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>3,303,157</u></u>	<u><u>5,895,961</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

■ Report of the Independent Auditor

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT

March 21, 2012

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2011 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2010 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 21, 2011, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2011 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2011

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. bylaws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which dur-

ing 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$1,561,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND — A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions. **Note 2 Accounting Policies:** The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2011 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$3,030,367	\$ 89,371	\$2,404,768
Furniture	8 Years	741,260	6,060	730,379
Computers	3 to 5 Years	497,633	77,786	419,310
Software	5 Years	1,276,212	94,356	813,937
		<u>5,545,472</u>	<u>267,573</u>	<u>4,368,394</u>

Investments: Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

The Corporations follow Accounting Standards Codification 820, Fair Value Measurements. It establishes a framework for measuring fair value, and expands disclosures about fair value measurements. Investments are now classified into one of three categories.

Level 1 — Quoted prices are available in active markets for identical investments as of the reporting date.

Level 2 — Pricing inputs are other than quoted prices in active markets, which are either directly or indirectly observable as of the reporting date, and the fair value is determined through the use of models or other valuation methodologies.

Level 3 — Pricing inputs are unobservable for the investment and include situations where there is little, if any, market activity for the investment.

All of the securities held by the Corporations at December 31, 2011 and 2010 have been valued at either Level 1 or Level 2.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity and certificates of deposit.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to assist in reaching the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50 % of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. The fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2011, investments were comprised as follows:

	Cost	Fair Value	Level 1	Level 2
Reserve Fund				
Certificate of deposits	\$8,550,634	8,550,634	8,550,634	\$ -
U.S. Treasury	6,969,931	7,102,840	7,102,840	-
Totals	<u>15,520,565</u>	<u>15,653,474</u>		
Postretirement Medical Fund				
Bond funds	506,805	511,381	-	511,381

Equity funds				
Small Cap Index	80,469	82,806	-	82,806
Mid Cap Index	78,643	82,027	-	82,027
S&P 500 Index	642,330	666,547	-	666,547
International Index	212,649	176,871	-	176,871
	<u>1,520,896</u>	<u>1,519,632</u>		
Totals	<u>17,041,461</u>	<u>17,173,106</u>	<u>15,653,474</u>	<u>1,519,632</u>

Investment income for 2011 and 2010 is comprised of the following:

	2011	2010
Interest and dividends	\$ 248,781	\$ 308,639
Realized gains	27,130	36,623
Change in unrealized appreciation	(95,161)	(30,714)
Investment expenses	(23,907)	(21,023)
	<u>156,843</u>	<u>293,525</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including staff services, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Subsequent Events: In connection with the preparation of these consolidated financial statements, Management evaluated subsequent events after the balance sheet date of December 31, 2011 through March 21, 2012 which was the date the financial statements were able to be issued.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2 % of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65 % of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social se-

curity offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with ASC 715 which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, ASC 715 requires an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under ASC 715 is recorded as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2011:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 16,895,502
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	27,189,259
Funded status	<u>(10,293,757)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 10,293,757</u>
Accumulated benefit obligation	\$ 22,843,409
Benefit cost	812,336
Employers' contributions	1,678,750
Benefits paid	985,257
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 1,678,750
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	(866,414)
	<u>812,336</u>
Weighted — Average Assumptions used to determine benefits obligations at December 31, 2011:	
Discount rate	4.5%
Salary increases	4.5%
Expected long-term return on assets	8.0%
Weighted — Average Assumptions used to determine net periodic pension cost for year ended December 31, 2011:	
Discount rate	5.75%
Salary increases	4.5%
Expected long-term return on assets	8.5%

The expected rate of return on plan assets is determined by those assets' historical long-term investment performance, current asset allocation, and estimates of future long-term returns by asset class.

The fair value of plan assets at December 31, 2011 were composed as follows:

	Total	Level 1	Level 2
Cash and equivalents	\$ 1,308,844	\$ 1,308,844	\$ -
Domestic equity mutual funds	8,310,470	-	8,310,470
International equity mutual fund	1,571,910	-	1,571,910
Bond mutual funds	5,704,278	-	5,704,278
Totals	<u>16,895,502</u>	<u>1,308,844</u>	<u>15,586,658</u>

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2012	\$ 1,192,164
2013	1,251,704
2014	1,273,503
2015	1,377,790
2016	1,467,107
2017 - 2021	7,876,760

The employers' contributions for 2012 are expected to be \$1,780,000.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2011, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was

subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$775,450 yearly office rental leases at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 2009 through December 31, 2018.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2011 is \$5,425,000 as follows:

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2011 is \$5,425,000 as follows:

2012	\$ 775,000
2013	775,000
2014	775,000
2015	775,000
2016	775,000
2017 to 2018	<u>1,550,000</u>
	<u>5,425,000</u>

In January 2012, A.A.W.S. leased additional space for a term of January 1, 2012 through November 30, 2014. The annual rent is \$46,264 (exclusive of future operating increases). At the same time, A.A.W.S. sublet a portion of existing space for \$121,255 per year. The sublease term is from February 15, 2012 through December 31, 2015. Both the additional lease and the sublease were in connection with the relocation of A.A. Grapevine offices within the building at 475 Riverside Drive.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from G.S.O.. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 4.5% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B at December 31, 2011. The discount rate was 5.75% at December 31, 2010.

Prior to 2006 the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years.

The following table sets forth information regarding the Plan for 2011:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$5,524,123
Benefits paid	<u>\$ 190,887</u>
Benefit cost	<u>\$1,437,866</u>
Benefit cost reported by:	
Operating entities	\$ 441,887
Postretirement Medical Fund	995,979
	<u>1,437,866</u>

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2012	\$ 202,340
2013	214,480
2014	227,349
2015	240,990
2016	255,449
2017 - 2021	1,526,391

Note 6 Tax Status: The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Management has determined that the Corporations had no uncertain tax positions that would require financial statement recognition. The Corporations are no longer subject to audits by the applicable taxing jurisdictions for the periods prior to 2008.

The General Service Office 2012 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2011 Budget	2011 Actual	2012 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$12,800,000	\$12,768,845	\$13,000,000
Discounts allowed	285,000	262,709	285,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	12,515,000	12,506,136	12,715,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,000,000	2,939,692	3,115,117
Royalties	38,000	27,687	28,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	9,477,000	9,538,757	9,571,883
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,529,200	1,577,432	1,652,400
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	7,947,800	7,961,325	7,919,483
Contributions Received	6,500,000	6,264,454	6,528,000
Interest Income	1,000	655	750
<u>Total Revenue</u>	14,448,800	14,226,434	14,448,233
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	5,586,500	5,405,862	5,574,000
Payroll taxes	405,000	408,621	409,500
Insurance	979,100	983,027	1,067,100
Retirement expense	1,841,700	1,832,125	1,901,000
Other program printing	437,500	398,300	464,900
Mailing, labor, etc.	129,500	108,153	124,500
Postage & express	453,800	413,334	434,500
Writers' fees	76,550	56,758	65,350
Other literature assistance	100,000	41,692	50,000
Selling expenses	348,150	295,944	333,000
Professional fees	154,500	153,680	212,500
Contracted services	1,001,600	873,250	1,120,300
Occupancy	784,700	779,639	767,000
Telephone	111,450	125,643	88,900
Equipment maintenance	83,895	64,068	75,465
Furniture & equipment	164,700	164,275	181,600
Stationery & office expense	172,100	156,197	167,100
Office service & expense	293,775	293,827	300,175
Travel, meals, & accommodations	1,014,200	859,466	953,450
Bad debts	10,000	-5,374	10,000
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	14,148,720	13,408,487	14,300,340
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	\$300,080	\$817,947	\$147,893

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2012 BUDGET

	GRAPEVINE ENGLISH			LA VIÑA SPANISH		
	2011 Budget	2011 Actual	2012 Budget	2011 Budget	2011 Actual	2012 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	89,024	90,493	86,929	8,454	8,982	8,982
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$2,036,017	\$2,174,509	\$2,107,159	\$81,926	\$97,930	\$97,930
Single copies and back issues	42,379	43,832	38,659	10,813	8,428	8,428
Digital Magazine Subscriptions		14,961	14,329		205	205
GV Online		24,205	134,909			
Digital Archives Project subs	51,628	42,740				
Audio Grapevine	26,083	16,516	8,512			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	2,156,107	2,316,763	2,303,568	92,739	106,563	106,563
<u>Total direct costs</u>	843,586	844,352	826,475	68,277	54,223	47,085
Gross Profit on Magazine	1,312,521	1,472,411	1,477,093	24,462	52,340	59,478
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	771,583	640,026	602,500	25,733	22,761	16,067
<u>Total direct costs</u>	266,784	254,551	227,606	5,321	4,373	3,174
Gross Profit on Special Items	504,799	385,475	374,894	20,412	18,388	12,893
Total Gross Profit	1,817,320	1,857,886	1,851,987	44,874	70,728	72,371
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	360,995	355,587	369,200	69,120	69,660	69,120
Payroll taxes and benefits	147,063	148,737	141,325	13,858	14,605	33,458
Occupancy costs	75,813	81,238	56,864			
Office supplies and expenses	28,033	25,258	22,963	537	242	392
Product development & Web	87,560	40,799	75,000			
<u>Total Editorial</u>	699,464	651,619	665,352	83,515	84,507	102,970
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	367,340	375,496	354,162	30,200	38,565	40,400
Payroll taxes and benefits	214,349	227,287	241,664	8,825	4,205	19,405
Fulfillment	113,216	109,858	111,850	11,185	8,385	8,739
Occupancy costs	80,462	81,260	50,625			
Office supplies and expenses	65,947	76,887	76,326			
Selling expense-regular	140,289	103,149	136,000	19,605	3,637	3,976
- GvR program	19,600	3,568	14,000			
Postage	5,499	3,888	4,000	141		50
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	1,006,702	981,393	988,627	69,956	54,792	72,570
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Employee's Severance	39,152	38,424				
Computer Consulting	27,760	32,182	25,824			
Insurance	6,518	6,686	4,900			
Professional fees	60,000	83,648	60,000	300		
Meetings and conferences	54,000	26,945	54,000	3,500	1,152	2,500
Furniture and equipment	21,500	8,156	15,000	1,800		
Canadian exchange and other	4,000	3,701	4,000			
Bank service charges	19,000	13,979	14,000			
Bad debts	20,000	12,613	12,000	500		
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	251,930	226,334	189,724	6,100	1,152	2,500
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	1,958,096	1,859,346	1,843,703	159,571	140,451	178,040
Add: Interest earned	38,800	24,300	26,000			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>(\$101,976)</u>	<u>\$22,840</u>	<u>\$34,284</u>	<u>(\$114,697)</u>	<u>(\$69,723)</u>	<u>(\$105,669)</u>

2011 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTION PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS ⁽¹⁾	SPECIAL MEETINGS ⁽²⁾	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	451	200	44.3%	\$38,774	9,031	\$4.28	\$2,332		\$210		\$41,316.21	\$4.57
2.	Alaska	186	93	50.0	20,353	3,155	6.45	3,218		837	\$50	\$24,458.07	\$7.75
3.	Arizona	1,095	442	40.3	106,559	24,898	4.28	4,935	\$100	5,041	290	\$116,925.59	\$4.70
4.	Arkansas	259	135	52.0	26,711	4,520	5.90	921	3,000	3,966		\$34,597.49	\$7.65
	California												
5.	Southern	1,275	383	29.9	92,231	46,639	1.97	6,692		2,094	505	\$101,521.81	\$2.18
6.	N. Coastal	1,983	1,127	56.7	265,045	58,834	4.50	12,630		3,294	30	\$280,999.16	\$4.78
7.	N. Interior	964	449	46.5	80,807	28,633	2.82	9,025	3,000	3,556	19	\$96,406.96	\$3.37
8.	San Diego/Imp.	981	402	40.9	72,542	27,778	2.61	4,657	3,000	1,295	304	\$81,797.86	\$2.94
9.	Mid-South	1,931	786	40.7	169,634	59,505	2.85	10,897		5,388	1,122	\$187,040.95	\$3.14
10.	Colorado	847	426	50.3	106,566	19,571	5.44	6,817		45,626		\$159,008.66	\$8.12
11.	Connecticut	1,614	593	36.6	107,783	39,416	2.73	8,798	1,500	12,510	711	\$131,301.88	\$3.33
12.	Delaware	241	121	50.1	36,219	3,638	9.96	543		350	21	\$37,132.92	\$10.21
13.	D.C.	491	218	44.3	56,782	15,026	3.78	1,017	500	1,385		\$59,684.10	\$3.97
	Florida												
14.	North	905	427	47.1	85,515	18,547	4.60	8,125	3,000	13,921		\$110,561.39	\$5.96
15.	South/	1,931	880	45.6	165,354	40,146	4.12	12,599	6,050	30,609	137	\$214,749.85	\$5.35
16.	Georgia	730	478	65.5	106,500	18,231	5.84	8,650	1,893	3,590	357	\$120,989.61	\$6.64
17.	Hawaii	327	174	53.1	34,723	5,424	6.39	2,366		130	439	\$37,657.75	\$6.94
18.	Idaho	250	100	40.0	19,830	4,776	4.14	1,209	1,698		75	\$22,811.73	\$4.78
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,399	341	24.4	72,782	29,685	2.44	8,440	50	2,531	170	\$83,973.70	\$2.83
20.	North	1,178	472	40.1	65,100	22,761	2.85	4,743		8,949	157	\$78,949.77	\$3.47
21.	South	429	143	33.2	25,511	7,982	3.19	2,251	65	1,329	50	\$29,206.14	\$3.66
	Indiana												
22.	North	674	264	39.2	37,182	10,083	3.69	990	95	1,219	40	\$39,525.80	\$3.92
23.	South	695	296	42.6	37,897	12,617	3.00	1,061		1,342	35	\$40,335.26	\$3.20
24.	Iowa	664	312	47.0	52,668	13,519	3.89	837	25	1,118	120	\$54,767.62	\$4.05
25.	Kansas	384	176	45.8	34,919	9,689	3.59	428	200	7,759		\$43,306.70	\$4.47
26.	Kentucky	709	306	43.1	69,764	11,769	5.93	4,646		11,348		\$85,757.60	\$7.29
27.	Louisiana	544	187	34.3	43,660	11,025	3.95	927	3,000	15,430	150	\$63,166.91	\$5.73
28.	Maine	544	196	35.9	21,228	8,688	2.43	1,929	337	17,785	1,017	\$42,295.62	\$4.87
29.	Maryland	1,053	415	39.3	73,201	16,637	4.39	7,348		1,356	30	\$81,935.13	\$4.92
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,440	516	35.7	119,124	46,349	2.56	6,573	2,070	1,698	57	\$129,521.92	\$2.79
31.	West	312	145	46.4	18,646	5,595	3.32	629		20		\$19,294.93	\$3.45
	Michigan												
32.	Central	666	255	38.2	34,608	14,099	2.45	4,915	3,075	2,407	156	\$45,160.18	\$3.20
33.	Southeast	942	288	30.5	42,732	21,274	2.01	2,252		128		\$45,112.48	\$2.12
34.	West	625	205	32.7	37,588	12,819	2.92	1,377	25	2,630	160	\$41,779.65	\$3.26
	Minnesota												
35.	North	585	250	42.7	27,977	8,760	3.18	1,421	46	500		\$29,944.07	\$3.42
36.	South	1,166	432	37.0	93,922	27,763	3.38	1,393	25	6,714	74	\$102,127.18	\$3.68
37.	Mississippi	261	94	36.0	22,996	4,982	4.62	84		1,036	400	\$24,516.16	\$4.92
	Missouri												
38.	East	565	251	44.3	58,375	8,963	6.51	3,151		2,827		\$64,353.16	\$7.18
39.	West	251	113	44.9	20,605	7,230	2.85	208		249		\$21,061.98	\$2.91
40.	Montana	283	126	44.4	25,258	5,588	4.52	727		375		\$26,359.60	\$4.72
41.	Nebraska	711	271	38.0	45,043	16,183	2.77	1,092		1,116	19	\$47,269.74	\$2.92
42.	Nevada	586	210	35.8	36,724	13,937	2.62	3,642		1,115	5	\$41,486.17	\$2.98
43.	New Hampshire	626	270	43.1	37,778	11,186	3.38	1,827		3,132		\$42,737.60	\$3.82
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,349	538	39.9	115,148	33,408	3.44	7,640	100	1,722	1,100	\$125,709.13	\$3.76
45.	South	545	257	47.2	56,921	9,206	6.18	908	1,000	275	412	\$59,516.48	\$6.46
46.	New Mexico	428	186	43.4	32,469	7,353	4.41	1,651		2,790		\$36,910.50	\$5.02
	New York												
47.	Central	766	282	36.7	46,161	11,074	4.16	5,524		2,169	1,000	\$54,854.62	\$4.95
48.	H./M./B.	749	295	39.4	31,141	11,020	2.83	806	215		4,895	\$37,057.01	\$3.36
49.	Southeast	1,762	740	41.9	236,394	57,272	4.13	6,902	2,000	14,699	771	\$260,765.78	\$4.55
50.	West	366	95	25.9	16,608	5,887	2.81	166	300			\$17,073.26	\$2.90
51.	N. Carolina	1,112	555	49.8	120,864	18,719	6.45	9,719	1,300	4,441		\$136,323.85	\$7.28
52.	North Dakota	154	80	51.8	13,388	3,361	3.97	454		2,122		\$15,964.51	\$4.75
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	790	222	28.1	24,325	10,632	2.29	1,644		782	75	\$26,826.68	\$2.52
54.	Northeast	1,532	346	22.6	40,759	20,016	2.03	1,325	2,000	2,795	5	\$46,883.75	\$2.34
55.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	302	89	29.4	10,762	4,249	2.52	40		1,035		\$11,837.46	\$2.79
56.	S.W. Ohio	591	257	43.4	44,608	10,744	4.14	3,521	300	736	80	\$49,244.47	\$4.58
57.	Oklahoma	402	190	47.2	36,659	8,232	4.44	2,200		409		\$39,268.29	\$4.77
58.	Oregon	1,117	411	36.8	75,516	21,616	3.48	1,554		2,228	241	\$79,539.14	\$3.68

Pennsylvania													
59.	East	1,560	785	50.3	171,088	32,242	5.30	8,542	3,154	6,951	185	\$189,918.61	\$5.89
60.	West	910	385	42.3	56,957	12,229	4.65	1,693	618	1,926	33	\$61,226.56	\$5.01
61.	Rhode Island	282	116	41.0	22,085	5,657	3.89	668		2,691	20	\$25,463.80	\$4.50
62.	South Carolina	381	193	50.6	46,166	9,190	5.01	1,063		4,625		\$51,853.48	\$5.64
63.	South Dakota	182	69	37.9	10,622	5,069	2.09	43		533		\$11,198.24	\$2.21
64.	Tennessee	566	251	44.2	48,689	12,546	3.88	4,144		1,285		\$54,118.39	\$4.31
Texas													
65.	Northeast	502	193	38.3	92,634	19,534	4.74	6,839		4,199		\$104,772.06	\$5.36
66.	Northwest	256	75	29.2	17,309	5,554	3.11	1,110	3,000	901		\$22,320.12	\$4.02
67.	Southeast	605	296	48.9	70,941	16,425	4.31	5,809	10	1,892		\$78,653.18	\$4.79
68.	Southwest	626	274	43.7	86,145	15,154	5.67	3,366		12,863	39	\$102,412.76	\$6.76
69.	Utah	333	150	44.9	29,651	6,434	4.61	866			212	\$30,728.33	\$4.78
70.	Vermont	299	118	39.4	15,968	5,081	3.14	3,766		710		\$20,444.34	\$4.02
71.	Virginia	1,389	706	50.7	136,686	25,062	5.44	15,790	4,700	5,736	225	\$163,136.53	\$6.51
72.	Western Washington	1,416	586	41.4	118,029	30,725	3.83	9,352	2,560	8,115	20	\$138,075.02	\$4.49
73.	West Virginia	294	129	43.9	11,996	3,197	3.75	175		800	584	\$13,554.80	\$4.24
Wisconsin													
74.	N. Wis./Upper Penn. Mich.	724	262	36.2	28,672	10,810	2.64	1,748		496		\$30,915.94	\$2.86
75.	South	1,064	421	39.6	52,181	19,648	2.66	2,227	50	1,621		\$56,078.82	\$2.85
76.	Wyoming	123	59	48.0	13,812	2,198	6.27	368	200	1,391		\$15,771.15	\$7.18
77.	Puerto Rico	121	76	62.8	7,862	1,236	6.36	93		1,041		\$8,995.93	\$7.28
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	523	241	46.1	75,566	8,694	8.69	1,154		4,254	281	\$81,254.81	\$9.35
79.	B.C./Yukon	797	391	49.1	104,296	15,326	6.80	837		3,707		\$108,840.07	\$7.10
80.	Manitoba	152	46	30.3	10,399	3,707	2.81	105		99		\$10,603.09	\$2.86
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	198	79	39.8	13,498	3,270	4.13	1,037		1,123		\$15,657.32	\$4.79
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	242	111	45.9	20,001	3,198	6.25	59	72	5,907		\$26,039.01	\$8.14
Ontario													
83.	East	594	254	42.7	69,606	14,810	4.69	904		11,793	535	\$82,837.72	\$5.59
84.	Northeast	165	73	44.1	14,194	1,805	7.86	40		2,904		\$17,137.41	\$9.49
85.	Northwest	57	20	35.1	4,460	1,077	4.13	574		471		\$5,505.08	\$5.11
86.	West	600	264	44.0	77,884	11,637	6.69	3,285		12,578	283	\$94,030.93	\$8.08
Quebec ⁽³⁾													
87.	Southwest	542	488	90.0	20,024	12,261	1.62	1,332	2,961	14,618		\$38,935.20	\$3.18
88.	Southeast	201	167	83.1	1,518	2,819	0.53	1,658		24,990		\$28,165.38	\$9.99
89.	Northeast	317	266	83.8	1,836	5,893	0.30	277		29,045		\$31,158.90	\$5.29
90.	Northwest	350	288	82.2	4,594	6,242	0.73	1,262		111,766		\$117,621.46	\$18.84
91.	Saskatchewan	287	119	41.5	23,559	3,244	7.26	489		7,100		\$31,148.69	\$9.60
92.	Washington East	450	208	46.2	31,063	5,578	5.56	462		2,149		\$33,674.24	\$6.04
93.	Central Calif	1,019	396	38.9	74,970	27,407	2.73	2,495	43	6,335	9	\$83,851.46	\$3.06
	Total U.S./Canada	63,845	27,066	42.4	5,233,900.40	1,384,699	3.78	\$296,010.23	\$558,436.42	\$565,626.57	\$12,807.20	\$6,166,780.82	\$4.45
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					\$367,253.85								
Specials					\$565,626.57								
Total for U.S. & Canada					\$6,166,780.82								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
On Line and Telephone Meetings					\$1,340.68								
Correctional & Hospital facility groups					\$130.00								
Foreign, WSM, other					\$94,423.38								
Internationalists					\$300.00								
International Lawyers in AA					\$1,000.00								
Loners					\$479.00								
Birds of a Feather					\$0.00								
Grand Total					\$6,264,453.88								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2011-2010- (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC			
U.S. & Canada 2011	63,845	27,066	42.4%	\$5,233,900.40	1,384,699	\$3.78	\$4.45			
U.S. & Canada 2010	62,873	27,622	43.9%	\$5,409,316.12	1,373,681	\$3.94	\$4.54	2011	2010	
Increase (Decrease)	972	(556)	-1.5%	-\$175,415.72	11,018	(\$0.16)	(\$0.09)	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	\$6.32	\$6.29

⁽¹⁾ A Special contribution is one that comes from any number of AA entities that is not an AA Group. For example, a Conference, a Committee, an Area, a District, an Intergroup etc.

⁽²⁾ A Special Meeting is a meeting that does not want to be a group but does want to contribute to the General Service Board

⁽³⁾ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their conference Areas (per info from areas)

The Budget Highlights

2012 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office—A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation), the General Fund (Service activities) and the Grapevine Operations. It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

Income: The 2012 budget projects gross sales of \$13,000,000. Unit sales are expected to be approximately even with 2011. The 2012 revenue budget includes a provision for eBook sales although it is hard to estimate without any experience. While reviewing and recommending the 2012 budget the A.A.W.S. Board continues to consider that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long-term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately 6% higher than 2011 and approximately 4% greater than the 2011 budget. Our Publications department anticipates increases in various parts of the manufacturing process.

Royalties are budgeted at \$28,000 for 2012 even with 2011. There is only one remaining royalty recipient. Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 5% higher than the 2011 anticipating inflationary increases.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$7,919,500 or 62.3%. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$40,000 less than 2011. The 62.3% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2012 compares with 63.7% realized for 2011. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Structure in Spanish and French, as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages.

The table below reflects the Gross Profit Percentages from 2007 through the 2012 budget.

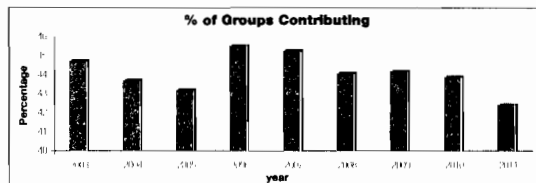
2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012 Budget
56.8%	55.9%	61.1%	64.5%	63.7	62.3%

Prudence dictates that actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream so as to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services provided.

Contributions: Contribution revenue had shown positive movement for several years. 2008 and 2009 showed reductions, and 2010 rebounded to \$6,408,421, \$58,400 greater than budgeted and \$112,300 greater than the 2009 results. 2011 turned in a disappointing \$6,265,649, a decrease of \$143,000 from last year. The decrease includes a reduction approximately \$75,000 from Countries who contribute to the World Service Meeting literature efforts. For 2012 we have budgeted an increase of approximately 4%. We are hopefully that the economy is turning around and that efforts to better communicate with the Fellowship about the needs for funds and how they are spent will show positive results.

During 2011, contributions from groups and individuals (as distinguished from those received for the World Service Meeting literature efforts) of \$6,191,061 were \$178,939 (2.8%) less than budget and \$87,842 (1%) less than 2010. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International Literature efforts amounted to \$74,588, approximately \$55,000 less than 2010. Total contributions as noted above were just over \$6,265,600.

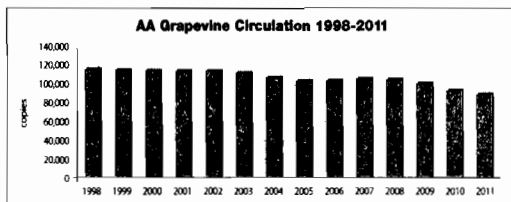
The chart produced to the right reflects the approximate percentage of the A.A. groups that choose to list with the General Service Office that have participated in the Seventh Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office.



Total Operating Revenue for 2012 is anticipated at \$14,448,233, an increase of approximately \$220,600 due to a slight increase in sales and improved contributions.

Total Operating Expenses for 2012 have been budgeted at \$14,300,340, approximately \$891,843 or 6.6% greater than 2011 expenses and approximately one percent greater than the 2011 budget. It should be remembered that the year 2012 is a year for the World Service Meeting and the bulk of the cost (approximately \$200,000) for this meeting is borne by GSO USA/Canada.

The 2012 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$147,893 and is at a level that is of concern to trusted servants at G.S.O. because profits achieved by GSO are used to maintaining the Reserve Fund. This compares with an excess of revenue of \$819,132 for 2011, \$1,255,289 for 2010, \$1,273,500 for 2009, and a loss of \$275,000 for 2008.



2012 Grapevine Budget

The 2012 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for the print magazine of 86,929. This anticipates 2,095 fewer copies than the 2011 budget and approximately 3,564 copies less than the 2011 average paid circulation of 90,493. The 2012 budget calls for approximately 4,300 GV online subscriptions. Circulation for the last 14 years is depicted in the chart.

Income: Magazine income of \$2,303,568 is expected, \$13,195 less than 2011. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$602,500, \$37,526 less than 2011.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,851,987 is budgeted for 2012. This compares with \$1,857,886 achieved for 2011 and the 2011 budget of \$1,817,320.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2012 are budgeted at \$1,843,703, \$15,643 less than the 2011 expenses of \$1,859,346 and \$114,393 less than the 2011 budget.

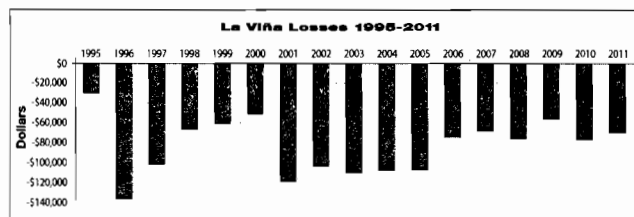
Net Income (loss): For 2012 the Grapevine anticipates a net profit of \$34,284. This compares with a 2011 budgeted loss of \$101,976 and an actual profit from operations of \$22,840.

2012 La Viña Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards were to review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The General Service Board recommended, and the 2001 Conference approved, that the La Viña magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General Service Boards General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2012 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$59,478 compared with \$52,340 achieved in 2011. Circulation for 2012 is estimated at 8,982 even with the 2011 average and slightly greater than the 2011 budget. Other Publishing Income is estimated at \$16,067, which after deducting cost of product of \$3,174 expects to contribute \$12,893 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$178,040 for 2012, \$37,589 more than 2011. The 2012 budget projects a net loss of \$105,669, \$35,946 higher than the 2011 loss of \$69,723. You may recall 2010 Conference Actions that added costs to La Viña production.

The Chart (at right) reflects the La Viña magazine losses since inception (1995). To date losses of approximately \$1,410,203 have been incurred.



■ 2012 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Roger Bédard
¹Ricardo Castro
 Mike Donnelly
²Neil Faber
 Mike Hopkins
 Mike Hudson
 Dave Murray
 Lynda Rivers

Secretary: *Eva Sanchez*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

²Maureen Fordonski
 Pam Jurica
 Kenny Kaatz
¹Keith Montgomery
 Pat Moody
 Bob O'Reilly
 Linda Thompson
 Robb Watson

Secretary: *Adrienne Brown*

Corrections

¹Debbie Apple
 Gary BraVard
 Bob Denihan
 Don Fitzpatrick
²Dennis Jaroslawski
 Jean Martin
 Brian Morishita
 Roger Schelling
 Janet Smith-Cook

Secretary: *Tracey Ober*

Finance

Deborah De Bram
 Cyndi Follrich
 Ron Foor
 Marty Laakso
 Guy Lafontaine
²Ken Monson
 Jeff Saunders
¹Chris Shea

Secretary: *Donald Meurer*

Grapevine

Bob Clegg
¹Jennifer Davidson
 Keith Domack
 Gerrie Dubien
 Rich Healless
 Alan Hennesy
 Tom Mooney
²Jim Seering
 Bob Swindaman

Secretary: *Eugene O'Brien*

Literature

Greg Boone
²Byron Ford
 Gerry Goulet
 Nancy Horan
 Cheryl Lawson
 Lela Meinke
 Oscar Rivera
 Walter Stadnycuk
¹Laura Vandivort

Secretary: *Gayle Solheim Riese*

Policy/Admissions

²Marcus Filipovich
 Gilles Flynn
 Susan Flynn
 Kit Johnson
 Art Mohr
 Brian O'Shea
¹Cecilia Reid
 Alan Spencer
 Doris Sullivan

Secretary: *Rick Walker*

Public Information

Chase Browning
 Chris Doyle
¹Cindy French
 Dick Humphrey
 Eden Lovejoy
 Fariba Murray
²Kevin Nangle
 Steve Price

Secretary: *Mary Cumings*

Report and Charter

Angie Ellison
 Mark Everett
¹Tashi Gonpo
 Percy Graves
 Kathy Gutierrez
²Scott Huyghebaert
 Tom Terry
 Jeryl Thompson

Secretary: *Jim Malone*

Treatment Facilities/ Special Needs-Accessibilities

²Jim Campbell
 Pierre Couture
 Jay Decker
 Linda McDole
 Glen Peden
¹Wayne Ross
 Terry Spear
 Pamela Vollans-Matthews

Secretary: *Mary Dargan*

Trustees

Fred Crandal
¹Randy Hale
 Michael Hansen
²Sunny Hill
 Tom Hoban
 Hugh Hyatt
 Jim Kath
 Jim MacDonald
 Ken Schmidt

Secretary: *Doug Richardson*

³Archives

Gary BraVard
 Ricardo Castro
¹Maureen Fordonski
 Brian Morishita
²Bob O'Reilly
 Oscar Rivera
 Alan Spencer
 Robb Watson

Secretary: *Michelle Mirza*

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Debbie Apple
 Neil Faber
¹Don Fitzpatrick
 Mike Hudson
²Hugh Hyatt
 Marty Laakso
 Lynda Rivers
 Pamela Vollans-Matthews

Secretaries: *Julio Espallat*
Eva Sanchez

2013 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Lynda Rivers, Kentucky	Dave Murray, Arizona
³ Archives	Brian Morishita, Idaho	Gary BraVard, S. Indiana
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Pam Jurica, SW Texas	Kenny Kaatz, W. Michigan
Corrections	Janet Smith-Cook, S. New Jersey	Brian Morishita, Idaho
Finance	Jeff Saunders, Washington East	Cyndi Follrich, South Carolina
Grapevine	Bob Clegg, Maryland	Tom Mooney, California, San Diego/Imperial
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Mike Hudson, Kansas	Marty Laakso, N. Wisconsin/Upper Penn. Michigan
Literature	Walter Stadnycuk, Alberta/NW Territories	Lela Meinke, California, Northern Interior
Policy/Admissions	Alan Spencer, New Mexico	Brian O'Shea, W. Massachusetts
Public Information	Eden Lovejoy, Alaska	Chris Doyle, South Dakota
Report and Charter	Mark Everett, SW Ohio	Jeryl Thompson, Mid-Southern California
Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities	Jay Decker, Tennessee	Pamela Vollans-Matthews, Manitoba
Trustees	Tom Hoban, Georgia	Jim Kath, N. Minnesota

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2012 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 62nd General Service Conference.

■ 2012 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

George Martin, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Donald Cusson
Joe Downey
Michele Grinberg
Nancy Haynes
Clayton Vandivort
Michelle Mirza, *secretary*

Audit

Terry Bedient, *chairperson*
Don Miller
Vic Phillips
Pam Reising
Don Meurer, *secretary*

Compensation

George Martin, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
Michele Grinberg
Roberta Lindeman
Don Meurer, *consultant*
Eugene O'Brien, *consultant*
Olga Mesonjnik, *secretary*

Conference

El Nault, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
Joe Downey
Barb Kelly
Roberta Lindeman
George Martin
Pam Reising
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment/Special Needs- Accessibilities

Rod Betonney, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Frances Brisbane
Rogelio Flores
John Fromson
Clayton Vandivort
Albin Zezula
Adrienne Brown,
secretary — C.P.C.
Mary Dargan, *secretary*
— *Treatment/Special Needs-
Accessibilities*

Corrections

Donald Cusson, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Frances Brisbane
John Fromson
Barb Kelly
El Nault
Clayton Vandivort
Tracey Ober, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Terry Bedient, *chairperson*
Donald Cusson
Roberta Lindeman
Don Massey
Don Miller
Bill Noonan
Vic Phillips
Pam Reising
Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Don Massey, *chairperson*
Rod Betonney
Corliss Burke
Rogelio Flores
John Fromson
Barb Kelly
J. Gary Lutz
Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Ken Brueggemann, *chairperson*
Rogelio Flores
Michele Grinberg
Don Massey
Don Miller
Vic Phillips
Albin Zezula
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*
— *International Conventions*
Julio Espallat, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

Roberta Lindeman, *chairperson*
Rob Betonney
Corliss Burke
Joe Downey
*Teresa Frohock
Michele Grinberg
Nancy Haynes
*Christine Hofer
J. Gary Lutz
Bill Noonan
Valerie O'Neill, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

Nominating

Vic Phillips, *chairperson*
Terry Bedient
Ken Brueggemann
Rogelio Flores
George Martin
Don Massey
El Nault
Doug Richardson, *acting secretary*

Public Information

Corliss Burke, *chairperson*,
*Tom Becherer
Terry Bedient
Frances Brisbane
Nancy Haynes
J. Gary Lutz
Bill Noonan
Albin Zezula
Mary Cumings, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

George Martin, *chairperson*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Ward Ewing
First vice-chairperson
Pam Reising
Second vice-chairperson
Michele Grinberg
Secretary
El Nault
Treasurer
Terry Bedient
Assistant secretary
Doug Richardson
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer
The new slate of officers
is given on page 9



*Denotes appointed committee members

**Ward Ewing is an ex officio member on all committees; Phyllis Halliday is an ex officio on all committees except the Audit Committee, Compensation Committee and the Nominating Committee.

■ 2012 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Ward B. Ewing, D.D. (P.O. Box 6, Ten Mile, TN 37880) was elected chairman of the board in 2009, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he served as dean and president from 1998 until his retirement in 2010. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. He has been involved as a friend of A.A. since the mid-'70s.

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected Class A trustee and treasurer in May 2008. Currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York, his career has included various executive positions, including hospital chief executive officer. He has served on a dozen nonprofit boards, currently as trustee of the New York Lawyer Assistance Trust, which oversees substance abuse programs for attorneys and judges, and as treasurer of the Federation of State Physical Health Programs. Terry is a Fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives. He chairs the Finance & Budgetary, and Audit Committees and serves on the Nominating and Public Information Committees.

Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. (53 Rustic Ave., Medford, NY 11763) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. A graduate of Columbia University School of Social Work, she received a doctorate in Organization Development from Union Graduate School and University, Cincinnati, Ohio. Frances is the author of five books and over 60 articles and has over 100 major presentations, nationally and internationally, on topics relating to alcoholism and substance abuse prevention and treatment and people of African ancestry. She is currently dean and professor, School of Social Welfare, S.U.N.Y. at Stony Brook, New York. Frances serves on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Corrections and Public Information Committees.

Corliss R. Burke, B.Ed. (11 Hayes Place, Whitehorse, Yukon Y1A 0E1) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. During her 26 years in the addiction field, Corliss has worked as a counselor, trainer, director and Deputy Minister. Throughout this time, she has always been involved with Alcoholics Anonymous, attending open A.A. meetings in many countries and working to implement the Bridging the Gap program in Alberta and in the Yukon. Currently, her consulting business focuses on addictions program design and development, as well as on counselor training. Corliss chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the International and Literature Committees.

The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores is now the Senior Judge on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara County in Santa Maria, California. He presides over various collaborative court calendars, including Drug Court and Mental Health Court, the Veterans' Treatment Court, the High-Risk DUI Court, and he

serves on the Board of Directors of the National Association of Drug Court Professionals. Judge Flores is the co-chair of the Collaborative Justice Advisory Committee for the California Judicial Council. Rogelio serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities, International, International Conventions/Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees.

John A. Fromson, M.D. (221 Winslow Rd., Waban, MA 02468) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. He is a graduate of New York Medical College and is a board certified addiction specialist. John is an associate director of postgraduate medical education, Dept. of Psychiatry, Massachusetts General Hospital, and teaches at Harvard Medical School. He is the author of many articles and lectures widely. John serves on the Corrections, International, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

Michele Grinberg, J.D. (4111 Staunton Ave., SE, Charleston, WV 25304) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. She is a 1985 graduate of West Virginia University College of Law, where she now teaches a legal writing course as an adjunct instructor. Michele is a practicing attorney with a concentration in health policy and medical staff relations. She is co-editor of *Women and the Law*. Michele serves on the Archives, Compensation, Literature and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Rod Betonney (6553 Elmcrest Dr., #13F, Salt Lake City UT 84107) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 47 delegate, Rod graduated from the Univ. of Utah with an MSW degree and currently works as a licensed clinical social worker in a substance abuse treatment program. He chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees and serves on the International and Literature Committees and is on the A.A.W.S. Board.

***Kenneth Brueggemann** (6111 Belvedere Blvd., Omaha, NE 68111-1274) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 48 delegate, Ken looks forward to the time when he can return to his area and learn the role of elder statesman. He served on both the Conference and trustees' Corrections committees, and for 28 years has worked with groups in prisons and jails. He treasures most the two years he served as a director of A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Having taught high school for 32 years, Ken now works in schools as a computer technician. He chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Compensation, Conference and Nominating Committees.

Donald Cusson (520 Joseph-Guay, Terrebonne, Quebec J6W 4S9) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 54 delegate Don is active in his district and area and is a retired business man. He chairs the

*Rotating at the close of the 2012 Conference.

Corrections Committee and serves on the Archives and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Nancy Haynes (P.O. Box 151, St. Helena, CA 94574) was elected general service trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate, Nancy served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Board. She is president and CEO of a coffee roasting company. Nancy serves on the Archives, Literature, and Public Information committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Barbara Kelly (752 Skyline Rd., RR #1, Oakwood, ON K0M 2M0) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2011. Barb was a Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Canada and remains active in her area, as well as in community affairs. Now retired, her most recent position was as mayor of Kawartha Lakes. Barb serves on the Conference, Corrections, and International Committees.

Roberta S. Lindeman (3487 Long Drive, Minden, NV 89423), a Panel 47 delegate from Nevada, was elected general service trustee in April 2010, after having served the four previous years as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Roberta brings a background of teaching, counseling, and school district administration to the board. She continues active participation in a home group and in local A.A. events. Roberta chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Compensation, Conference, and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

J. Gary Lutz (2210 13th St., Bethlehem, PA 18020) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2011. A Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Pennsylvania, J. Gary is a university professor of education, specializing in educational research methodology and currently serving as Vice Provost for Institutional Research. He serves on the International, Literature, and Public Information Committees.

George G. Martin (209 East Liberty St., Milford, MI 48381) was elected general service trustee in April 2009, having previously served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. World Services Board. An attorney, his law practice primarily involves representation of nonprofit corporations in finance and business transactions. George chairs both the Archives and Compensation Committees and serves on the Conference and Nominating Committees. He also chairs the Sharing Session and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Don Massey (3928 Uri St., Metairie, LA 70002) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2009. Don was a Panel 55 delegate from Area 27 (Louisiana) and today he is an active A.A. member who also facilitates inventories for groups, districts and other A.A. entities. An attorney, Don has served as an adjunct professor, University of New Orleans and he is an active member of various civic and legal organizations, including the Louisiana Lawyers Assistance Program, of which he is presently chairperson. He chairs the International Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Don Miller (Cheetah International, Inc., 847 Sherman St., 1st Fl., Denver, CO 80203) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. Don, a Panel 49 delegate, served on the A.A. World Service Board as a nontrustee director, 2003-2006. He is involved in project management and organizational development for new businesses. Don chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Eleanor (El) W. Nault (440 Hamilton Parkway, Easley, SC 29642-3041) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2009. A Panel 56 delegate, El remains active not only in her home group, but in many area and district service functions. El's professional background includes city and regional planning; she recently retired as a teacher/administrator of a four-year research university. El chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Corrections and Nominating Committee and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

***Victor Phillips** (5-552 Central Ave., N. Swift Current, SK S9H 0L9), was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 54 delegate, Vic attends service events in his region, and goes to several regular A.A. meetings per week wherever he travels. Vic's professional background is in finance and management. He chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Audit, Finance & Budgetary, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Pamela Reising (31829 Sheridan Dr., Beverly Hills, MI 48025) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2009. A former Panel 45 delegate, Pam is co-facilitator of her area's monthly G.S.R. orientation. Pam's background is in the criminal justice field and she teaches at a state university. She chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Audit and Retirement/Pension Committees, as well as the trustees' Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Clayton Vandivort (Box 158, 316 S. Kingshighway, Sikeston, MO 63801) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate from Eastern Missouri, Clayton is active in his area and region. He is an attorney in private practice. He serves on the Archives, Corrections, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibility Committees.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2012 Conference

Andrew Ware (3214 Cummins Way, Missoula, MT 59802) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2012. A former Panel 57 delegate, Andrew is active in his area and in corrections service. He is a university professor and chair of the Department of Physics and Astronomy.

Marty Watters (9478 Greenglade Rd., Sidney, BC V8L3T7) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2012. A former Panel 59 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Nominating Committee, Marty is active in workshops, inventories and other events around his province. He is the owner of a Landscape/Hardscape Design and Installation business.

A.A. World Services Directors

Pam Reising, <i>chairperson, regional trustee</i>	Roberta Lindeman, <i>general service trustee</i>
Andrea Barthwell, <i>director</i>	George Martin, <i>general service trustee</i>
Rod Betonney, <i>regional trustee</i>	Bill Noonan, <i>director</i>
Joe Downey, <i>director</i>	Rick Walker, <i>G.S.O. staff member</i>
Phyllis Halliday, <i>G.S.O. general manager</i>	

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Don Miller, <i>chairperson, general service trustee</i>	Michele Grinberg, <i>trustee</i>
Ami Brophy, <i>executive editor/publisher</i>	Nancy Haynes, <i>general service trustee</i>
Donald Cusson, <i>regional trustee</i>	El Nault, <i>regional trustee</i>
	Albin Zezula, <i>director</i>

General Service Office Staff

Phyllis Halliday, <i>general manager</i>	Jim Malone
Doug Richardson, <i>director of staff services</i>	Tracey Ober
Adrienne Brown	Gayle Solheim Riese
Mary Cumings	Eva Sanchez
Mary Dargan	Warren Stafford
Julio Espallat	Rick Walker
Mary Clare Lynch	

Grapevine Staff

Ami Brophy, <i>executive editor/publisher</i>	Eugene O'Brien, <i>GV controller</i>
Irene Donoso, <i>La Viña editor</i>	

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Militza Alma-Noyola, *staff assistant*
 Julie Anderson, *staff assistant*
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr/executive asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *office coordinator*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish-language editor*
 Sheila Coppin-Thorn, *staff assistant*
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *Hotel Coordinator/Workroom Manager*
 Frank Lama, *GV circulation manager*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Michelle Mirza, *archivist*
 Valerie O'Neill, *publications director*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Joselin Pichardo, *GV production editor associate*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Jason Seder, *artist, Conference Report*
 Frank Segui, *finance secretary*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*
 Robert Slotterback, *controller*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *Conference staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *office manager*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Summer Edition Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeriti

Leonard Blumenthal
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 62nd Conference includes Panel 61 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 62 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	61	Dennis Jaroslawski 1314 Stanford Rd. Dothan, AL 36503
Alaska	2	62	Eden Lovejoy 5828 Katahdin Dr. Anchorage, AK 99502
Arizona	3	62	David (Dave) Murray 6140 E. Joshua Tree Paradise Valley AZ 85253
Arkansas	4	61	Sonya (Sunny) Hill 12201 Teton Forest Dr. Little Rock, AR 72212
California Southern	5	61	Marcus Filipovich 1124 Fifth Ave. Venice, CA 90291
Central	93	61	Ken Schmidt 101 Palm Dr. Oxnard, CA 93030-4923
Northern Coastal	6	61	Ken Monson 98 Auburn Court Vacaville, CA 95688
Northern Interior	7	62	Janet (Lela) Meinke 5135 Wedgewood Way Rocklin, CA 95765
San Diego/Imperial	8	62	Tom Mooney 1880 Grove Rd. El Cajon, CA 92020
Mid-Southern	9	62	Jeryl Thompson 214 A Palmer St. Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	61	Gelong (Tashi) Gonpo Box 108 Ward, CO 80481-0108
Connecticut	11	61	Christopher (Chris) Shea 917 Merwins Lane Fairfield, CT 06824
Delaware	12	62	Richard (Dick) Humphrey 7 N. Stuyvesant Dr. Wilmington, DE 19809
District of Columbia	13	61	Ricardo Castro 3510 Greenly St. Silver Spring, MD 20906
Florida North	14	61	Cecilia Reid 728 West Ave. Cocoa, FL 32927
S. Florida/Bahamas/ V.I./Antigua/St. Maarten/ Cayman Islands	15	61	Kathy Gutierrez 8240 Linger Lodge Rd. Bradenton, FL 34202
Georgia	16	62	Tom Hoban 527 Duke Dr. Marietta, GA 30066
Hawaii	17	61	Linda McDole 454 Kuamoo St., #C Honolulu, HI 96815
Idaho	18	62	Brian Morishita 2994 Thayer Bridge Circle Idaho Falls, ID 83402-4660

State	Area no.	Panel	
Illinois			
<i>Chicago</i>	19	61	Michael (Mike) Hopkins 9057 S. Loomis Chicago, IL 60620
<i>Northern</i>	20	62	Richard (Rich) Healleless 8618 Regnier Rd. Hebron, IL 60034
<i>Southern</i>	21	61	Fariba Murray 102 Warner St. Bloomington, IL 61701
Indiana			
<i>Northern</i>	22	61	Ronald (Ron) Foor 311 Island Dr. La Porte, IN 46350
<i>Southern</i>	23	62	Gary BraVard 3540 N. Pennsylvania St. Indianapolis, IN 46205
Iowa	24	61	Maureen Fordonski 2355 38th St. Rock Island, IL 61201
Kansas	25	62	Michael (Mike) Hudson 705 W. 8th St. Scott City, KS 67871
Kentucky	26	62	Lynda Rivers Box 99942 Louisville, KY 40269
Louisiana	27	61	Randy Hale Box 51701 Lafayette, LA 70505
Maine	28	62	Linda Thompson 135 Dana Mill Rd. Woolwich, ME 04579
Maryland	29	62	Robert (Bob) Clegg 6588 Nyasa Bend New Market, MD 21774
Massachusetts			
<i>Eastern</i>	30	61	Kevin Nangle 59 Hawthorn St. Lowell, MA 01851
<i>Western</i>	31	62	Brian O'Shea 110 Roosevelt Ave. Chicopee, MA 01013
Michigan			
<i>Central</i>	32	61	Art Mohr Box 588 Howell, MI 48844
<i>Southeast</i>	33	61	Fred Crandal 417 S. Huron St. Ypsilanti, MI 48197
<i>Western</i>	34	62	Kenny Kaatz 3234 Miami Ave. Kalamazoo, MI 49048-1219
Minnesota			
<i>Northern</i>	35	62	James (Jim) Kath 608 10th Ave. NE Brainerd, MN 56401
<i>Southern</i>	36	61	Angela (Angie) Ellison 21900 Meadow Wood Ct. Jordan, MN 55352
Mississippi	37	62	Doris Sullivan 106 Redbud Dr. Leland, MS 38756
Missouri			
<i>Eastern</i>	38	61	Laura Vandivort 1205 Fairfield Ave. Sikeston, MO 63801
<i>Western</i>	39	61	Steve Price 9303 W. Farm Rd. 76 Willard, MO 65781

State	Area no.	Panel	
Montana	40	61	Terry Spear 412 N. Rodney Helena, MT 59601
Nebraska	41	62	Kit Johnson 10810 Willow Rd. Shelton, NE 68876
Nevada	42	61	Byron Ford 2091 Cotton Valley St. Henderson, NV 89052
New Hampshire	43	62	Cheryl Lawson Box 351 Sprinfield, NH 03284
New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	44	61	Richard (Wayne) Ross 542 Charlestown Rd. Hampton, NJ 08827
<i>Southern</i>	45	62	Janet Smith-Cook 109 Somerset Dr. Willingboro, NJ 08046
New Mexico	46	62	Alan Spencer 448 Pyrite Dr., NE Rio Rancho, NM 87124
New York			
<i>Central</i>	47	61	Thomas (Tom) Terry Box 162 Harford, NY 13784-0162
<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	62	Keith Domack 385 Dewitt Mills Rd. Kingston, NY 12401
<i>Southeast</i>	49	61	Susan Flynn 86 East 4th St., #9 New York, NY 10003
<i>Western</i>	50	62	Michael (Mike) Donnelly 342 Grover Cleveland Hwy. Amherst, NY 14226
North Carolina	51	61	Jennifer Davidson 1722 Orange St. Wilmington, NC 28403
North Dakota	52	61	Neil Faber Box 1058 Stanley, ND 58784
Ohio			
<i>Central/Southeast</i>	53	61	Glen Peden 2855 Pine Dr. Circleville, OH 43113
<i>Northeast</i>	54	61	Robert (Bob) Denihan Box 8 Orwell, OH 44076
<i>Northwest</i>	55	62	Bob Swindaman 1165 Craig Rd. Maumee, OH 43537
<i>Southwest</i>	56	62	Mark Everett 517 Cherry Hill Lane Lebanon, OH 45036
Oklahoma	57	61	Alan Hennesy 502 SW Sapp Circle Lawton, OK 73505
Oregon	58	62	Chase Browning 646 Griffin Oaks Dr. Central Point, OR 97502
Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	59	61	Hugh Hyatt 128 Bellwood Rd. Upper Holland, PA 19053
<i>Western</i>	60	61	Jean Martin 3825 Wiestertown Rd. Export, PA 15632

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	62	Patricia (Pat) Moody 103 Nashua St. Providence, RI 02904
South Carolina	62	62	Cyndi Follrich 9 Jenkins Port Rd. St. Helena Island, SC 29920
South Dakota	63	62	Chris Doyle 114 E. Texas St. Rapid City, SD 57701
Tennessee	64	62	Jay Decker 600 Lovers Lane Lebanon, TN 37087
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	61	Jim Campbell 1282 Antioch Dr. Rockwall, TX 75087
<i>Northwest</i>	66	62	Roger Schelling 3804 Fairgreen Court Midland, TX 79707
<i>Southeast</i>	67	61	Deborah De Bram 1131 Chantilly Lane Houston, TX 77018
<i>Southwest</i>	68	62	Pam Jurica 365 Post Oak Bend Inez, TX 77968
Utah	69	61	Keith Montgomery Box 147 Moab, UT 84532
Vermont	70	62	Michael Hansen 2467 Lakeview Dr. North Hero, VT 05474
Virginia	71	61	Cynthia (Cindy) French 3707 Jenny Lynne Falls Fairfax, VA 22030
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	62	Jeffrey (Jeff) Saunders Box 868 Leavenworth, WA 98826
<i>Western</i>	72	61	Debbie Apple 7502 96th St. E. Puyallup, WA 98371
West Virginia	73	61	Jim Seering 527 N. Highland Dr. Beckley, WV 25801
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	62	Marty Laakso 11090 E. Lund Rd. Maple, WI 54854
<i>Southern</i>	75	61	Nancy Horan 268 Hartford Sq. Hartford, WI 53027-1973
Wyoming	76	62	Gregory (Greg) Boone 7495 Hwy 789 Lander, WY 82520
Puerto Rico	77	62	Oscar Rivera Box 362113 San Juan, PR 00936-2113

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	62	Walter Stadnyczuk 11715-84 Avenue NW Edmonton, AB T6G 0W2
B.C./Yukon	79	61	Scott Huyghebaert 2169 Tranquille Rd. Kamloops, BC V2B 3M9
Manitoba	80	62	Pamela Vollans-Matthews 520 Wellington Crescent Dauphin, MB R7N 0M3
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	62	Jim MacDonald 59, Sandlewood St. Charlottetown, PEI C1E 0A5
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	61	Don Fitzpatrick Box 130 Margaree Center, NS B0E 1Z0
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	61	Robb Watson 2670 Battleford Rd., #59 Mississauga, ON L5N 2S7
<i>Northeast</i>	84	61	Geraldine (Gerrie) Dubien 646 Bartleman St., #106 Timmins, ON P4N 4X4
<i>Northwest</i>	85	61	Gerry Goulet 350 Cornwall St. Thunder Bay, ON P7B 1T3
<i>Western</i>	86	62	Percy Graves 355 Bethune Dr. North, Unit D Gravenhurst, ON P1P 1B8
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	62	Pierre Couture 1450 Nobel, Suite 20 Boucherville, PQ J4B 5H3
<i>Southeast</i>	88	61	Guy Lafontaine 2723 Rue Bernier Magog, PQ J1X 0R3
<i>Northeast</i>	89	61	*Roger Bédard 572 106 ^{eme} Avenue St-Georges-de Champlain, PQ G9T 3K3
<i>Northwest</i>	90	62	Gilles Flynn 116, Lorenz Bourcier Saint-Jérôme, PQ J7Y 4T1
Saskatchewan	91	61	Robert (Bob) O'Reilly 1016 Rorison Ave. Moose Jaw, SK S6H 6W5

*Alternate delegate was seated. Estella Falardeau, delegate, did not attend.